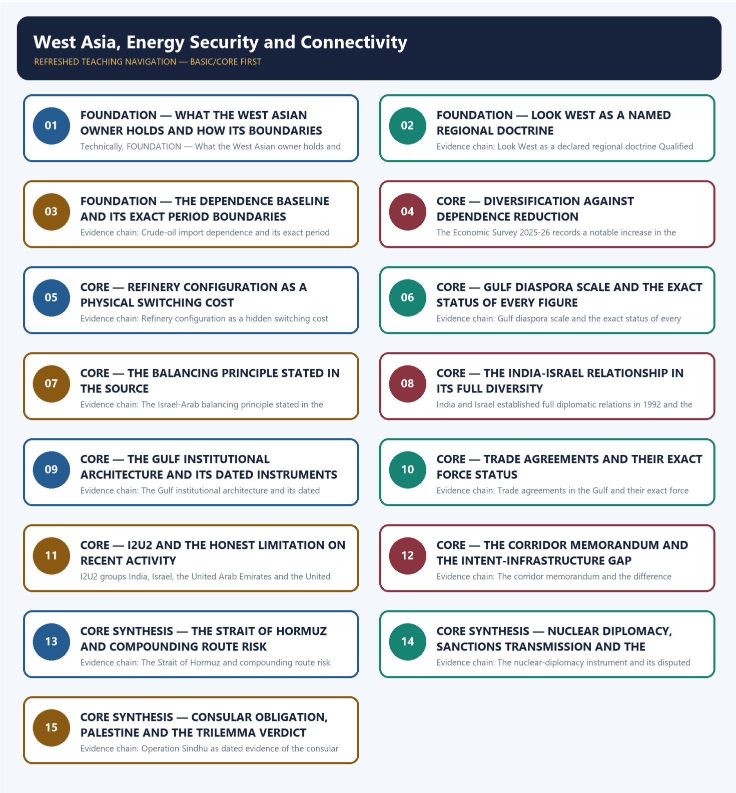
SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

West Asia, Energy Security and Connectivity - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / WORKBOOK INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

West Asia, Energy Security and Connectivity - Solved Practice Workbook

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies What this West Asian owner holds and how its boundaries are routed?

A. This topic owns India's Look West engagement with the Gulf and the Arab world, the Israel and Iran tracks, energy security as the organising interest, Gulf diaspora welfare as a foreign-policy obligation, the Palestine position and the connectivity and minilateral frameworks of I2U2 and the India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor, and its distinctive feature is that a single regional escalation can threaten energy supply, diaspora safety and connectivity viability at the same time; three verified General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2018 and 2025 and four objective demands from 2018, 2023 and 2026 are routed here, while oil-import-bill, pricing and tariff mechanics belong to the Economy owner, the minilateral classification of I2U2 belongs to topic 10, diaspora diplomacy in general belongs to topic 09, the Central Asian limb of Chabahar belongs to topic 05, and the humanitarian relief cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owners. B. The Economic Survey 2025-26 records a notable increase in the diversity of countries from which India imports crude oil, with the United States share rising to eight point one per cent from four point six per cent and the United Arab Emirates share to eleven point one per cent from nine point four per cent in April to November of the financial year 2026, while Egypt, Nigeria and Libya also rose and Russia, Saudi Arabia, Iraq and Venezuela declined; the owners insist on the analytical separation that this is diversification of sources and not reduction of aggregate dependence, because equity stakes and a wider supplier base spread single-point-of-failure risk without lowering the share of consumption that must be imported. C. Petroleum Planning and Analysis Cell data put India's crude-oil import dependence at eighty-eight point two per cent in the financial year 2024-25 and about eighty-eight point seven per cent provisional in the financial year 2025-26, while Sikri records the book-period figure at approximately seventy per cent; the owners require the current figure and its consumption-basis definition to be cited for any present-day claim and permit the book-period figure only as a historical baseline showing the direction of travel, so quoting approximately seventy per cent as a current number is treated as a factual error rather than a stylistic one. D. Tharoor records that as far as the Arab world is concerned India is proud that it has a Look West policy too, which the owners treat as an explicit parallel to the better-known Look East policy and therefore as a regionally targeted engagement doctrine rather than an undifferentiated foreign-policy stance; the examinable value of the phrase is that it establishes West Asia as a named policy theatre with its own instruments, so a candidate can open an answer by classifying the region correctly instead of treating Gulf engagement as an appendix to a general foreign-policy narrative.

Answer: A. Explanation: This topic owns India's Look West engagement with the Gulf and the Arab world, the Israel and Iran tracks, energy security as the organising interest, Gulf diaspora welfare as a foreign-policy obligation, the Palestine position and the connectivity and minilateral frameworks of I2U2 and the India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor, and its distinctive feature is that a single regional escalation can threaten energy supply, diaspora safety and connectivity viability at the same time; three verified General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2018 and 2025 and four objective demands from 2018, 2023 and 2026 are routed here, while oil-import-bill, pricing and tariff mechanics belong to the Economy owner, the minilateral classification of I2U2 belongs to topic 10, diaspora diplomacy in general belongs to topic 09, the Central Asian limb of Chabahar belongs to topic 05, and the humanitarian relief cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owners. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q2. Which card should be filed under What this West Asian owner holds and how its boundaries are routed in an International Relations answer?

A. The Economic Survey 2025-26 records a notable increase in the diversity of countries from which India imports crude oil, with the United States share rising to eight point one per cent from four point six per cent and the United Arab Emirates share to eleven point one per cent from nine point four per cent in April to November of the financial year 2026, while Egypt, Nigeria and Libya also rose and Russia, Saudi Arabia, Iraq and Venezuela declined; the owners insist on the analytical separation that this is diversification of sources and not reduction of aggregate dependence, because equity stakes and a wider supplier base spread single-point-of-failure risk without lowering the share of consumption that must be imported. B. This topic owns India's Look West engagement with the Gulf and the Arab world, the Israel and Iran tracks, energy security as the organising interest, Gulf diaspora welfare as a foreign-policy obligation, the Palestine position and the connectivity and minilateral frameworks of I2U2 and the India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor, and its distinctive feature is that a single regional escalation can threaten energy supply, diaspora safety and connectivity viability at the same time; three verified General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2018 and 2025 and four objective demands from 2018, 2023 and 2026 are routed here, while oil-import-bill, pricing and tariff mechanics belong to the Economy owner, the minilateral classification of I2U2 belongs to topic 10, diaspora diplomacy in general belongs to topic 09, the Central Asian limb of Chabahar belongs to topic 05, and the humanitarian relief cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owners. C. Tharoor notes that many Indian refineries are in fact devised to process the quality of crude oil that Iran supplies, and Sikri records the underlying policy response of making equity investments in oilfields abroad, so the owners treat configuration-specific refining capacity as a physical constraint on how quickly a supplier mix can actually change; the analytical payoff is that headline diversification percentages move slowly for engineering reasons rather than diplomatic ones, which is why a strategy answer must price switching cost instead of assuming that political intent translates immediately into a changed energy basket. D. Petroleum Planning and Analysis Cell data put India's crude-oil import dependence at eighty-eight point two per cent in the financial year 2024-25 and about eighty-eight point seven per cent provisional in the financial year 2025-26, while Sikri records the book-period figure at approximately seventy per cent; the owners require the current figure and its consumption-basis definition to be cited for any present-day claim and permit the book-period figure only as a historical baseline showing the direction of travel, so quoting approximately seventy per cent as a current number is treated as a factual error rather than a stylistic one.

Answer: B. Explanation: This topic owns India's Look West engagement with the Gulf and the Arab world, the Israel and Iran tracks, energy security as the organising interest, Gulf diaspora welfare as a foreign-policy obligation, the Palestine position and the connectivity and minilateral frameworks of I2U2 and the India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor, and its distinctive feature is that a single regional escalation can threaten energy supply, diaspora safety and connectivity viability at the same time; three verified General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2018 and 2025 and four objective demands from 2018, 2023 and 2026 are routed here, while oil-import-bill, pricing and tariff mechanics belong to the Economy owner, the minilateral classification of I2U2 belongs to topic 10, diaspora diplomacy in general belongs to topic 09, the Central Asian limb of Chabahar belongs to topic 05, and the humanitarian relief cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owners. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q3. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of What this West Asian owner holds and how its boundaries are routed?

A. Tharoor notes that many Indian refineries are in fact devised to process the quality of crude oil that Iran supplies, and Sikri records the underlying policy response of making equity investments in oilfields abroad, so the owners treat configuration-specific refining capacity as a physical constraint on how quickly a supplier mix can actually change; the analytical payoff is that headline diversification percentages move slowly for engineering reasons rather than diplomatic ones, which is why a strategy answer must price switching cost instead of assuming that political intent translates immediately into a changed energy basket. B. Sikri cites a diaspora of five million in the Gulf and Tharoor separately notes that the Arab world is home to nearly six million Indians, both period-specific, while the Ministry of External Affairs overseas-Indian population table as on January 2026 records four million three hundred and forty-four thousand and eight persons in the United Arab Emirates and two million seven hundred and fifty thousand five hundred and fifty-one in Saudi Arabia; the owners require these to be described as population-stock estimates rather than citizenship or Overseas Citizen of India counts, and they route remittance data to the Economy owner and general diaspora diplomacy to topic 09. C. This topic owns India's Look West engagement with the Gulf and the Arab world, the Israel and Iran tracks, energy security as the organising interest, Gulf diaspora welfare as a foreign-policy obligation, the Palestine position and the connectivity and minilateral frameworks of I2U2 and the India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor, and its distinctive feature is that a single regional escalation can threaten energy supply, diaspora safety and connectivity viability at the same time; three verified General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2018 and 2025 and four objective demands from 2018, 2023 and 2026 are routed here, while oil-import-bill, pricing and tariff mechanics belong to the Economy owner, the minilateral classification of I2U2 belongs to topic 10, diaspora diplomacy in general belongs to topic 09, the Central Asian limb of Chabahar belongs to topic 05, and the humanitarian relief cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owners. D. The Economic Survey 2025-26 records a notable increase in the diversity of countries from which India imports crude oil, with the United States share rising to eight point one per cent from four point six per cent and the United Arab Emirates share to eleven point one per cent from nine point four per cent in April to November of the financial year 2026, while Egypt, Nigeria and Libya also rose and Russia, Saudi Arabia, Iraq and Venezuela declined; the owners insist on the analytical separation that this is diversification of sources and not reduction of aggregate dependence, because equity stakes and a wider supplier base spread single-point-of-failure risk without lowering the share of consumption that must be imported.

Answer: C. Explanation: This topic owns India's Look West engagement with the Gulf and the Arab world, the Israel and Iran tracks, energy security as the organising interest, Gulf diaspora welfare as a foreign-policy obligation, the Palestine position and the connectivity and minilateral frameworks of I2U2 and the India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor, and its distinctive feature is that a single regional escalation can threaten energy supply, diaspora safety and connectivity viability at the same time; three verified General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2018 and 2025 and four objective demands from 2018, 2023 and 2026 are routed here, while oil-import-bill, pricing and tariff mechanics belong to the Economy owner, the minilateral classification of I2U2 belongs to topic 10, diaspora diplomacy in general belongs to topic 09, the Central Asian limb of Chabahar belongs to topic 05, and the humanitarian relief cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owners. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q4. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about What this West Asian owner holds and how its boundaries are routed?

A. Tharoor notes that many Indian refineries are in fact devised to process the quality of crude oil that Iran supplies, and Sikri records the underlying policy response of making equity investments in oilfields abroad, so the owners treat configuration-specific refining capacity as a physical constraint on how quickly a supplier mix can actually change; the analytical payoff is that headline diversification percentages move slowly for engineering reasons rather than diplomatic ones, which is why a strategy answer must price switching cost instead of assuming that political intent translates immediately into a changed energy basket. B. Sikri cites a diaspora of five million in the Gulf and Tharoor separately notes that the Arab world is home to nearly six million Indians, both period-specific, while the Ministry of External Affairs overseas-Indian population table as on January 2026 records four million three hundred and forty-four thousand and eight persons in the United Arab Emirates and two million seven hundred and fifty thousand five hundred and fifty-one in Saudi Arabia; the owners require these to be described as population-stock estimates rather than citizenship or Overseas Citizen of India counts, and they route remittance data to the Economy owner and general diaspora diplomacy to topic 09. C. Tharoor states that India values its relationship with Israel, but not at the expense of its friendships with Arab and other Muslim states, which is the explicit textual anchor for every balancing argument in this topic, and the owners sharpen it into active balancing rather than passive equidistance, because India deepens several ties simultaneously instead of avoiding commitment to any; the consequence for answer writing is that the Gulf, Israel and Iran tracks must be presented as parallel and non-exclusive rather than as a sequence of choices in which one relationship displaces another. D. This topic owns India's Look West engagement with the Gulf and the Arab world, the Israel and Iran tracks, energy security as the organising interest, Gulf diaspora welfare as a foreign-policy obligation, the Palestine position and the connectivity and minilateral frameworks of I2U2 and the India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor, and its distinctive feature is that a single regional escalation can threaten energy supply, diaspora safety and connectivity viability at the same time; three verified General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2018 and 2025 and four objective demands from 2018, 2023 and 2026 are routed here, while oil-import-bill, pricing and tariff mechanics belong to the Economy owner, the minilateral classification of I2U2 belongs to topic 10, diaspora diplomacy in general belongs to topic 09, the Central Asian limb of Chabahar belongs to topic 05, and the humanitarian relief cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owners.

Answer: D. Explanation: This topic owns India's Look West engagement with the Gulf and the Arab world, the Israel and Iran tracks, energy security as the organising interest, Gulf diaspora welfare as a foreign-policy obligation, the Palestine position and the connectivity and minilateral frameworks of I2U2 and the India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor, and its distinctive feature is that a single regional escalation can threaten energy supply, diaspora safety and connectivity viability at the same time; three verified General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2018 and 2025 and four objective demands from 2018, 2023 and 2026 are routed here, while oil-import-bill, pricing and tariff mechanics belong to the Economy owner, the minilateral classification of I2U2 belongs to topic 10, diaspora diplomacy in general belongs to topic 09, the Central Asian limb of Chabahar belongs to topic 05, and the humanitarian relief cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owners. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies Look West as a declared regional doctrine?

A. Tharoor records that as far as the Arab world is concerned India is proud that it has a Look West policy too, which the owners treat as an explicit parallel to the better-known Look East policy and therefore as a regionally targeted engagement doctrine rather than an undifferentiated foreign-policy stance; the examinable value of the phrase is that it establishes West Asia as a named policy theatre with its own instruments, so a candidate can open an answer by classifying the region correctly instead of treating Gulf engagement as an appendix to a general foreign-policy narrative. B. Tharoor notes that many Indian refineries are in fact devised to process the quality of crude oil that Iran supplies, and Sikri records the underlying policy response of making equity investments in oilfields abroad, so the owners treat configuration-specific refining capacity as a physical constraint on how quickly a supplier mix can actually change; the analytical payoff is that headline diversification percentages move slowly for engineering reasons rather than diplomatic ones, which is why a strategy answer must price switching cost instead of assuming that political intent translates immediately into a changed energy basket. C. The Economic Survey 2025-26 records a notable increase in the diversity of countries from which India imports crude oil, with the United States share rising to eight point one per cent from four point six per cent and the United Arab Emirates share to eleven point one per cent from nine point four per cent in April to November of the financial year 2026, while Egypt, Nigeria and Libya also rose and Russia, Saudi Arabia, Iraq and Venezuela declined; the owners insist on the analytical separation that this is diversification of sources and not reduction of aggregate dependence, because equity stakes and a wider supplier base spread single-point-of-failure risk without lowering the share of consumption that must be imported. D. Petroleum Planning and Analysis Cell data put India's crude-oil import dependence at eighty-eight point two per cent in the financial year 2024-25 and about eighty-eight point seven per cent provisional in the financial year 2025-26, while Sikri records the book-period figure at approximately seventy per cent; the owners require the current figure and its consumption-basis definition to be cited for any present-day claim and permit the book-period figure only as a historical baseline showing the direction of travel, so quoting approximately seventy per cent as a current number is treated as a factual error rather than a stylistic one.

Answer: A. Explanation: Tharoor records that as far as the Arab world is concerned India is proud that it has a Look West policy too, which the owners treat as an explicit parallel to the better-known Look East policy and therefore as a regionally targeted engagement doctrine rather than an undifferentiated foreign-policy stance; the examinable value of the phrase is that it establishes West Asia as a named policy theatre with its own instruments, so a candidate can open an answer by classifying the region correctly instead of treating Gulf engagement as an appendix to a general foreign-policy narrative. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q6. Which card should be filed under Look West as a declared regional doctrine in an International Relations answer?

A. The Economic Survey 2025-26 records a notable increase in the diversity of countries from which India imports crude oil, with the United States share rising to eight point one per cent from four point six per cent and the United Arab Emirates share to eleven point one per cent from nine point four per cent in April to November of the financial year 2026, while Egypt, Nigeria and Libya also rose and Russia, Saudi Arabia, Iraq and Venezuela declined; the owners insist on the analytical separation that this is diversification of sources and not reduction of aggregate dependence, because equity stakes and a wider supplier base spread single-point-of-failure risk without lowering the share of consumption that must be imported. B. Tharoor records that as far as the Arab world is concerned India is proud that it has a Look West policy too, which the owners treat as an explicit parallel to the better-known Look East policy and therefore as a regionally targeted engagement doctrine rather than an undifferentiated foreign-policy stance; the examinable value of the phrase is that it establishes West Asia as a named policy theatre with its own instruments, so a candidate can open an answer by classifying the region correctly instead of treating Gulf engagement as an appendix to a general foreign-policy narrative. C. Tharoor notes that many Indian refineries are in fact devised to process the quality of crude oil that Iran supplies, and Sikri records the underlying policy response of making equity investments in oilfields abroad, so the owners treat configuration-specific refining capacity as a physical constraint on how quickly a supplier mix can actually change; the analytical payoff is that headline diversification percentages move slowly for engineering reasons rather than diplomatic ones, which is why a strategy answer must price switching cost instead of assuming that political intent translates immediately into a changed energy basket. D. Sikri cites a diaspora of five million in the Gulf and Tharoor separately notes that the Arab world is home to nearly six million Indians, both period-specific, while the Ministry of External Affairs overseas-Indian population table as on January 2026 records four million three hundred and forty-four thousand and eight persons in the United Arab Emirates and two million seven hundred and fifty thousand five hundred and fifty-one in Saudi Arabia; the owners require these to be described as population-stock estimates rather than citizenship or Overseas Citizen of India counts, and they route remittance data to the Economy owner and general diaspora diplomacy to topic 09.

Answer: B. Explanation: Tharoor records that as far as the Arab world is concerned India is proud that it has a Look West policy too, which the owners treat as an explicit parallel to the better-known Look East policy and therefore as a regionally targeted engagement doctrine rather than an undifferentiated foreign-policy stance; the examinable value of the phrase is that it establishes West Asia as a named policy theatre with its own instruments, so a candidate can open an answer by classifying the region correctly instead of treating Gulf engagement as an appendix to a general foreign-policy narrative. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q7. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Look West as a declared regional doctrine?

A. Tharoor states that India values its relationship with Israel, but not at the expense of its friendships with Arab and other Muslim states, which is the explicit textual anchor for every balancing argument in this topic, and the owners sharpen it into active balancing rather than passive equidistance, because India deepens several ties simultaneously instead of avoiding commitment to any; the consequence for answer writing is that the Gulf, Israel and Iran tracks must be presented as parallel and non-exclusive rather than as a sequence of choices in which one relationship displaces another. B. Sikri cites a diaspora of five million in the Gulf and Tharoor separately notes that the Arab world is home to nearly six million Indians, both period-specific, while the Ministry of External Affairs overseas-Indian population table as on January 2026 records four million three hundred and forty-four thousand and eight persons in the United Arab Emirates and two million seven hundred and fifty thousand five hundred and fifty-one in Saudi Arabia; the owners require these to be described as population-stock estimates rather than citizenship or Overseas Citizen of India counts, and they route remittance data to the Economy owner and general diaspora diplomacy to topic 09. C. Tharoor records that as far as the Arab world is concerned India is proud that it has a Look West policy too, which the owners treat as an explicit parallel to the better-known Look East policy and therefore as a regionally targeted engagement doctrine rather than an undifferentiated foreign-policy stance; the examinable value of the phrase is that it establishes West Asia as a named policy theatre with its own instruments, so a candidate can open an answer by classifying the region correctly instead of treating Gulf engagement as an appendix to a general foreign-policy narrative. D. Tharoor notes that many Indian refineries are in fact devised to process the quality of crude oil that Iran supplies, and Sikri records the underlying policy response of making equity investments in oilfields abroad, so the owners treat configuration-specific refining capacity as a physical constraint on how quickly a supplier mix can actually change; the analytical payoff is that headline diversification percentages move slowly for engineering reasons rather than diplomatic ones, which is why a strategy answer must price switching cost instead of assuming that political intent translates immediately into a changed energy basket.

Answer: C. Explanation: Tharoor records that as far as the Arab world is concerned India is proud that it has a Look West policy too, which the owners treat as an explicit parallel to the better-known Look East policy and therefore as a regionally targeted engagement doctrine rather than an undifferentiated foreign-policy stance; the examinable value of the phrase is that it establishes West Asia as a named policy theatre with its own instruments, so a candidate can open an answer by classifying the region correctly instead of treating Gulf engagement as an appendix to a general foreign-policy narrative. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q8. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Look West as a declared regional doctrine?

A. India and Israel established full diplomatic relations in 1992 and the first visit by an Indian Prime Minister to Israel in July 2017 marked a major political upgrade, after which cooperation spans defence procurement, counter-terrorism and co-development with the Barak-8 air-defence system as the named joint development, the Indo-Israel Agricultural Project operating Centres of Excellence for protected cultivation, irrigation and post-harvest practices, and the India-Israel Industrial Research and Development and Technological Innovation Fund launched in 2017; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that import dependence, cost and technology-transfer depth remain relevant, that demonstration centres require local extension, affordability and scaling before they affect wider productivity, and that funded projects must be distinguished from announced cooperation. B. Tharoor states that India values its relationship with Israel, but not at the expense of its friendships with Arab and other Muslim states, which is the explicit textual anchor for every balancing argument in this topic, and the owners sharpen it into active balancing rather than passive equidistance, because India deepens several ties simultaneously instead of avoiding commitment to any; the consequence for answer writing is that the Gulf, Israel and Iran tracks must be presented as parallel and non-exclusive rather than as a sequence of choices in which one relationship displaces another. C. Sikri cites a diaspora of five million in the Gulf and Tharoor separately notes that the Arab world is home to nearly six million Indians, both period-specific, while the Ministry of External Affairs overseas-Indian population table as on January 2026 records four million three hundred and forty-four thousand and eight persons in the United Arab Emirates and two million seven hundred and fifty thousand five hundred and fifty-one in Saudi Arabia; the owners require these to be described as population-stock estimates rather than citizenship or Overseas Citizen of India counts, and they route remittance data to the Economy owner and general diaspora diplomacy to topic 09. D. Tharoor records that as far as the Arab world is concerned India is proud that it has a Look West policy too, which the owners treat as an explicit parallel to the better-known Look East policy and therefore as a regionally targeted engagement doctrine rather than an undifferentiated foreign-policy stance; the examinable value of the phrase is that it establishes West Asia as a named policy theatre with its own instruments, so a candidate can open an answer by classifying the region correctly instead of treating Gulf engagement as an appendix to a general foreign-policy narrative.

Answer: D. Explanation: Tharoor records that as far as the Arab world is concerned India is proud that it has a Look West policy too, which the owners treat as an explicit parallel to the better-known Look East policy and therefore as a regionally targeted engagement doctrine rather than an undifferentiated foreign-policy stance; the examinable value of the phrase is that it establishes West Asia as a named policy theatre with its own instruments, so a candidate can open an answer by classifying the region correctly instead of treating Gulf engagement as an appendix to a general foreign-policy narrative. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Crude-oil import dependence and its exact period boundaries?

A. Petroleum Planning and Analysis Cell data put India's crude-oil import dependence at eighty-eight point two per cent in the financial year 2024-25 and about eighty-eight point seven per cent provisional in the financial year 2025-26, while Sikri records the book-period figure at approximately seventy per cent; the owners require the current figure and its consumption-basis definition to be cited for any present-day claim and permit the book-period figure only as a historical baseline showing the direction of travel, so quoting approximately seventy per cent as a current number is treated as a factual error rather than a stylistic one. B. The Economic Survey 2025-26 records a notable increase in the diversity of countries from which India imports crude oil, with the United States share rising to eight point one per cent from four point six per cent and the United Arab Emirates share to eleven point one per cent from nine point four per cent in April to November of the financial year 2026, while Egypt, Nigeria and Libya also rose and Russia, Saudi Arabia, Iraq and Venezuela declined; the owners insist on the analytical separation that this is diversification of sources and not reduction of aggregate dependence, because equity stakes and a wider supplier base spread single-point-of-failure risk without lowering the share of consumption that must be imported. C. Sikri cites a diaspora of five million in the Gulf and Tharoor separately notes that the Arab world is home to nearly six million Indians, both period-specific, while the Ministry of External Affairs overseas-Indian population table as on January 2026 records four million three hundred and forty-four thousand and eight persons in the United Arab Emirates and two million seven hundred and fifty thousand five hundred and fifty-one in Saudi Arabia; the owners require these to be described as population-stock estimates rather than citizenship or Overseas Citizen of India counts, and they route remittance data to the Economy owner and general diaspora diplomacy to topic 09. D. Tharoor notes that many Indian refineries are in fact devised to process the quality of crude oil that Iran supplies, and Sikri records the underlying policy response of making equity investments in oilfields abroad, so the owners treat configuration-specific refining capacity as a physical constraint on how quickly a supplier mix can actually change; the analytical payoff is that headline diversification percentages move slowly for engineering reasons rather than diplomatic ones, which is why a strategy answer must price switching cost instead of assuming that political intent translates immediately into a changed energy basket.

Answer: A. Explanation: Petroleum Planning and Analysis Cell data put India's crude-oil import dependence at eighty-eight point two per cent in the financial year 2024-25 and about eighty-eight point seven per cent provisional in the financial year 2025-26, while Sikri records the book-period figure at approximately seventy per cent; the owners require the current figure and its consumption-basis definition to be cited for any present-day claim and permit the book-period figure only as a historical baseline showing the direction of travel, so quoting approximately seventy per cent as a current number is treated as a factual error rather than a stylistic one. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q10. Which card should be filed under Crude-oil import dependence and its exact period boundaries in an International Relations answer?

A. Tharoor states that India values its relationship with Israel, but not at the expense of its friendships with Arab and other Muslim states, which is the explicit textual anchor for every balancing argument in this topic, and the owners sharpen it into active balancing rather than passive equidistance, because India deepens several ties simultaneously instead of avoiding commitment to any; the consequence for answer writing is that the Gulf, Israel and Iran tracks must be presented as parallel and non-exclusive rather than as a sequence of choices in which one relationship displaces another. B. Petroleum Planning and Analysis Cell data put India's crude-oil import dependence at eighty-eight point two per cent in the financial year 2024-25 and about eighty-eight point seven per cent provisional in the financial year 2025-26, while Sikri records the book-period figure at approximately seventy per cent; the owners require the current figure and its consumption-basis definition to be cited for any present-day claim and permit the book-period figure only as a historical baseline showing the direction of travel, so quoting approximately seventy per cent as a current number is treated as a factual error rather than a stylistic one. C. Sikri cites a diaspora of five million in the Gulf and Tharoor separately notes that the Arab world is home to nearly six million Indians, both period-specific, while the Ministry of External Affairs overseas-Indian population table as on January 2026 records four million three hundred and forty-four thousand and eight persons in the United Arab Emirates and two million seven hundred and fifty thousand five hundred and fifty-one in Saudi Arabia; the owners require these to be described as population-stock estimates rather than citizenship or Overseas Citizen of India counts, and they route remittance data to the Economy owner and general diaspora diplomacy to topic 09. D. Tharoor notes that many Indian refineries are in fact devised to process the quality of crude oil that Iran supplies, and Sikri records the underlying policy response of making equity investments in oilfields abroad, so the owners treat configuration-specific refining capacity as a physical constraint on how quickly a supplier mix can actually change; the analytical payoff is that headline diversification percentages move slowly for engineering reasons rather than diplomatic ones, which is why a strategy answer must price switching cost instead of assuming that political intent translates immediately into a changed energy basket.

Answer: B. Explanation: Petroleum Planning and Analysis Cell data put India's crude-oil import dependence at eighty-eight point two per cent in the financial year 2024-25 and about eighty-eight point seven per cent provisional in the financial year 2025-26, while Sikri records the book-period figure at approximately seventy per cent; the owners require the current figure and its consumption-basis definition to be cited for any present-day claim and permit the book-period figure only as a historical baseline showing the direction of travel, so quoting approximately seventy per cent as a current number is treated as a factual error rather than a stylistic one. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q11. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Crude-oil import dependence and its exact period boundaries?

A. India and Israel established full diplomatic relations in 1992 and the first visit by an Indian Prime Minister to Israel in July 2017 marked a major political upgrade, after which cooperation spans defence procurement, counter-terrorism and co-development with the Barak-8 air-defence system as the named joint development, the Indo-Israel Agricultural Project operating Centres of Excellence for protected cultivation, irrigation and post-harvest practices, and the India-Israel Industrial Research and Development and Technological Innovation Fund launched in 2017; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that import dependence, cost and technology-transfer depth remain relevant, that demonstration centres require local extension, affordability and scaling before they affect wider productivity, and that funded projects must be distinguished from announced cooperation. B. Sikri cites a diaspora of five million in the Gulf and Tharoor separately notes that the Arab world is home to nearly six million Indians, both period-specific, while the Ministry of External Affairs overseas-Indian population table as on January 2026 records four million three hundred and forty-four thousand and eight persons in the United Arab Emirates and two million seven hundred and fifty thousand five hundred and fifty-one in Saudi Arabia; the owners require these to be described as population-stock estimates rather than citizenship or Overseas Citizen of India counts, and they route remittance data to the Economy owner and general diaspora diplomacy to topic 09. C. Petroleum Planning and Analysis Cell data put India's crude-oil import dependence at eighty-eight point two per cent in the financial year 2024-25 and about eighty-eight point seven per cent provisional in the financial year 2025-26, while Sikri records the book-period figure at approximately seventy per cent; the owners require the current figure and its consumption-basis definition to be cited for any present-day claim and permit the book-period figure only as a historical baseline showing the direction of travel, so quoting approximately seventy per cent as a current number is treated as a factual error rather than a stylistic one. D. Tharoor states that India values its relationship with Israel, but not at the expense of its friendships with Arab and other Muslim states, which is the explicit textual anchor for every balancing argument in this topic, and the owners sharpen it into active balancing rather than passive equidistance, because India deepens several ties simultaneously instead of avoiding commitment to any; the consequence for answer writing is that the Gulf, Israel and Iran tracks must be presented as parallel and non-exclusive rather than as a sequence of choices in which one relationship displaces another.

Answer: C. Explanation: Petroleum Planning and Analysis Cell data put India's crude-oil import dependence at eighty-eight point two per cent in the financial year 2024-25 and about eighty-eight point seven per cent provisional in the financial year 2025-26, while Sikri records the book-period figure at approximately seventy per cent; the owners require the current figure and its consumption-basis definition to be cited for any present-day claim and permit the book-period figure only as a historical baseline showing the direction of travel, so quoting approximately seventy per cent as a current number is treated as a factual error rather than a stylistic one. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q12. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Crude-oil import dependence and its exact period boundaries?

A. India and Israel established full diplomatic relations in 1992 and the first visit by an Indian Prime Minister to Israel in July 2017 marked a major political upgrade, after which cooperation spans defence procurement, counter-terrorism and co-development with the Barak-8 air-defence system as the named joint development, the Indo-Israel Agricultural Project operating Centres of Excellence for protected cultivation, irrigation and post-harvest practices, and the India-Israel Industrial Research and Development and Technological Innovation Fund launched in 2017; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that import dependence, cost and technology-transfer depth remain relevant, that demonstration centres require local extension, affordability and scaling before they affect wider productivity, and that funded projects must be distinguished from announced cooperation. B. The India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Action Plan for 2024-2028 was adopted at the first India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Ministerial Meeting for Strategic Dialogue at Riyadh on 9 September 2024 and is the anchor current framework for India's strategic dialogue with the Council, while the India-Saudi Arabia Strategic Partnership Council held its second meeting at Jeddah on 22 April 2025, India and Qatar signed an Agreement on Establishment of a Bilateral Strategic Partnership on 18 February 2025, and India-United Arab Emirates relations were elevated to a Comprehensive Strategic Partnership on 25 January 2017; the owners require a dated instrument to be named rather than an undated assertion of strategic partnership, because the date and the forum are what make the claim checkable. C. Tharoor states that India values its relationship with Israel, but not at the expense of its friendships with Arab and other Muslim states, which is the explicit textual anchor for every balancing argument in this topic, and the owners sharpen it into active balancing rather than passive equidistance, because India deepens several ties simultaneously instead of avoiding commitment to any; the consequence for answer writing is that the Gulf, Israel and Iran tracks must be presented as parallel and non-exclusive rather than as a sequence of choices in which one relationship displaces another. D. Petroleum Planning and Analysis Cell data put India's crude-oil import dependence at eighty-eight point two per cent in the financial year 2024-25 and about eighty-eight point seven per cent provisional in the financial year 2025-26, while Sikri records the book-period figure at approximately seventy per cent; the owners require the current figure and its consumption-basis definition to be cited for any present-day claim and permit the book-period figure only as a historical baseline showing the direction of travel, so quoting approximately seventy per cent as a current number is treated as a factual error rather than a stylistic one.

Answer: D. Explanation: Petroleum Planning and Analysis Cell data put India's crude-oil import dependence at eighty-eight point two per cent in the financial year 2024-25 and about eighty-eight point seven per cent provisional in the financial year 2025-26, while Sikri records the book-period figure at approximately seventy per cent; the owners require the current figure and its consumption-basis definition to be cited for any present-day claim and permit the book-period figure only as a historical baseline showing the direction of travel, so quoting approximately seventy per cent as a current number is treated as a factual error rather than a stylistic one. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Supplier diversification against dependence reduction?

A. The Economic Survey 2025-26 records a notable increase in the diversity of countries from which India imports crude oil, with the United States share rising to eight point one per cent from four point six per cent and the United Arab Emirates share to eleven point one per cent from nine point four per cent in April to November of the financial year 2026, while Egypt, Nigeria and Libya also rose and Russia, Saudi Arabia, Iraq and Venezuela declined; the owners insist on the analytical separation that this is diversification of sources and not reduction of aggregate dependence, because equity stakes and a wider supplier base spread single-point-of-failure risk without lowering the share of consumption that must be imported. B. Tharoor states that India values its relationship with Israel, but not at the expense of its friendships with Arab and other Muslim states, which is the explicit textual anchor for every balancing argument in this topic, and the owners sharpen it into active balancing rather than passive equidistance, because India deepens several ties simultaneously instead of avoiding commitment to any; the consequence for answer writing is that the Gulf, Israel and Iran tracks must be presented as parallel and non-exclusive rather than as a sequence of choices in which one relationship displaces another. C. Tharoor notes that many Indian refineries are in fact devised to process the quality of crude oil that Iran supplies, and Sikri records the underlying policy response of making equity investments in oilfields abroad, so the owners treat configuration-specific refining capacity as a physical constraint on how quickly a supplier mix can actually change; the analytical payoff is that headline diversification percentages move slowly for engineering reasons rather than diplomatic ones, which is why a strategy answer must price switching cost instead of assuming that political intent translates immediately into a changed energy basket. D. Sikri cites a diaspora of five million in the Gulf and Tharoor separately notes that the Arab world is home to nearly six million Indians, both period-specific, while the Ministry of External Affairs overseas-Indian population table as on January 2026 records four million three hundred and forty-four thousand and eight persons in the United Arab Emirates and two million seven hundred and fifty thousand five hundred and fifty-one in Saudi Arabia; the owners require these to be described as population-stock estimates rather than citizenship or Overseas Citizen of India counts, and they route remittance data to the Economy owner and general diaspora diplomacy to topic 09.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Economic Survey 2025-26 records a notable increase in the diversity of countries from which India imports crude oil, with the United States share rising to eight point one per cent from four point six per cent and the United Arab Emirates share to eleven point one per cent from nine point four per cent in April to November of the financial year 2026, while Egypt, Nigeria and Libya also rose and Russia, Saudi Arabia, Iraq and Venezuela declined; the owners insist on the analytical separation that this is diversification of sources and not reduction of aggregate dependence, because equity stakes and a wider supplier base spread single-point-of-failure risk without lowering the share of consumption that must be imported. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q14. Which card should be filed under Supplier diversification against dependence reduction in an International Relations answer?

A. Tharoor states that India values its relationship with Israel, but not at the expense of its friendships with Arab and other Muslim states, which is the explicit textual anchor for every balancing argument in this topic, and the owners sharpen it into active balancing rather than passive equidistance, because India deepens several ties simultaneously instead of avoiding commitment to any; the consequence for answer writing is that the Gulf, Israel and Iran tracks must be presented as parallel and non-exclusive rather than as a sequence of choices in which one relationship displaces another. B. The Economic Survey 2025-26 records a notable increase in the diversity of countries from which India imports crude oil, with the United States share rising to eight point one per cent from four point six per cent and the United Arab Emirates share to eleven point one per cent from nine point four per cent in April to November of the financial year 2026, while Egypt, Nigeria and Libya also rose and Russia, Saudi Arabia, Iraq and Venezuela declined; the owners insist on the analytical separation that this is diversification of sources and not reduction of aggregate dependence, because equity stakes and a wider supplier base spread single-point-of-failure risk without lowering the share of consumption that must be imported. C. Sikri cites a diaspora of five million in the Gulf and Tharoor separately notes that the Arab world is home to nearly six million Indians, both period-specific, while the Ministry of External Affairs overseas-Indian population table as on January 2026 records four million three hundred and forty-four thousand and eight persons in the United Arab Emirates and two million seven hundred and fifty thousand five hundred and fifty-one in Saudi Arabia; the owners require these to be described as population-stock estimates rather than citizenship or Overseas Citizen of India counts, and they route remittance data to the Economy owner and general diaspora diplomacy to topic 09. D. India and Israel established full diplomatic relations in 1992 and the first visit by an Indian Prime Minister to Israel in July 2017 marked a major political upgrade, after which cooperation spans defence procurement, counter-terrorism and co-development with the Barak-8 air-defence system as the named joint development, the Indo-Israel Agricultural Project operating Centres of Excellence for protected cultivation, irrigation and post-harvest practices, and the India-Israel Industrial Research and Development and Technological Innovation Fund launched in 2017; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that import dependence, cost and technology-transfer depth remain relevant, that demonstration centres require local extension, affordability and scaling before they affect wider productivity, and that funded projects must be distinguished from announced cooperation.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Economic Survey 2025-26 records a notable increase in the diversity of countries from which India imports crude oil, with the United States share rising to eight point one per cent from four point six per cent and the United Arab Emirates share to eleven point one per cent from nine point four per cent in April to November of the financial year 2026, while Egypt, Nigeria and Libya also rose and Russia, Saudi Arabia, Iraq and Venezuela declined; the owners insist on the analytical separation that this is diversification of sources and not reduction of aggregate dependence, because equity stakes and a wider supplier base spread single-point-of-failure risk without lowering the share of consumption that must be

imported. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q15. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Supplier diversification against dependence reduction?

A. Tharoor states that India values its relationship with Israel, but not at the expense of its friendships with Arab and other Muslim states, which is the explicit textual anchor for every balancing argument in this topic, and the owners sharpen it into active balancing rather than passive equidistance, because India deepens several ties simultaneously instead of avoiding commitment to any; the consequence for answer writing is that the Gulf, Israel and Iran tracks must be presented as parallel and non-exclusive rather than as a sequence of choices in which one relationship displaces another. B. India and Israel established full diplomatic relations in 1992 and the first visit by an Indian Prime Minister to Israel in July 2017 marked a major political upgrade, after which cooperation spans defence procurement, counter-terrorism and co-development with the Barak-8 air-defence system as the named joint development, the Indo-Israel Agricultural Project operating Centres of Excellence for protected cultivation, irrigation and post-harvest practices, and the India-Israel Industrial Research and Development and Technological Innovation Fund launched in 2017; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that import dependence, cost and technology-transfer depth remain relevant, that demonstration centres require local extension, affordability and scaling before they affect wider productivity, and that funded projects must be distinguished from announced cooperation. C. The Economic Survey 2025-26 records a notable increase in the diversity of countries from which India imports crude oil, with the United States share rising to eight point one per cent from four point six per cent and the United Arab Emirates share to eleven point one per cent from nine point four per cent in April to November of the financial year 2026, while Egypt, Nigeria and Libya also rose and Russia, Saudi Arabia, Iraq and Venezuela declined; the owners insist on the analytical separation that this is diversification of sources and not reduction of aggregate dependence, because equity stakes and a wider supplier base spread single-point-of-failure risk without lowering the share of consumption that must be imported. D. The India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Action Plan for 2024-2028 was adopted at the first India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Ministerial Meeting for Strategic Dialogue at Riyadh on 9 September 2024 and is the anchor current framework for India's strategic dialogue with the Council, while the India-Saudi Arabia Strategic Partnership Council held its second meeting at Jeddah on 22 April 2025, India and Qatar signed an Agreement on Establishment of a Bilateral Strategic Partnership on 18 February 2025, and India-United Arab Emirates relations were elevated to a Comprehensive Strategic Partnership on 25 January 2017; the owners require a dated instrument to be named rather than an undated assertion of strategic partnership, because the date and the forum are what make the claim checkable.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Economic Survey 2025-26 records a notable increase in the diversity of countries from which India imports crude oil, with the United States share rising to eight point one per cent from four point six per cent and the United Arab Emirates share to eleven point one per cent from nine point four per cent in April to November of the financial year 2026, while Egypt, Nigeria and Libya also rose and Russia, Saudi Arabia, Iraq and Venezuela declined; the owners insist on the analytical separation that this is diversification of sources and not reduction of aggregate dependence, because equity stakes and a wider supplier base spread single-point-of-failure risk without lowering the share of consumption that must be imported. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q16. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Supplier diversification against dependence reduction?

A. India and Israel established full diplomatic relations in 1992 and the first visit by an Indian Prime Minister to Israel in July 2017 marked a major political upgrade, after which cooperation spans defence procurement, counter-terrorism and co-development with the Barak-8 air-defence system as the named joint development, the Indo-Israel Agricultural Project operating Centres of Excellence for protected cultivation, irrigation and post-harvest practices, and the India-Israel Industrial Research and Development and Technological Innovation Fund launched in 2017; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that import dependence, cost and technology-transfer depth remain relevant, that demonstration centres require local extension, affordability and scaling before they affect wider productivity, and that funded projects must be distinguished from announced cooperation. B. The India-United Arab Emirates Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement has been in force since 1 May 2022 and officially reported bilateral trade was approximately one hundred billion United States dollars in the financial year 2024-25, while an India-Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement was signed on 18 December 2025 with entry into force requiring separate verification; the owners keep the tariff and trade-volume mechanics with the Economy owner and retain only the strategic-partnership significance here, and they insist that signature and entry into force are recorded as distinct evidentiary levels. C. The India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Action Plan for 2024-2028 was adopted at the first India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Ministerial Meeting for Strategic Dialogue at Riyadh on 9 September 2024 and is the anchor current framework for India's strategic dialogue with the Council, while the India-Saudi Arabia Strategic Partnership Council held its second meeting at Jeddah on 22 April 2025, India and Qatar signed an Agreement on Establishment of a Bilateral Strategic Partnership on 18 February 2025, and India-United Arab Emirates relations were elevated to a Comprehensive Strategic Partnership on 25 January 2017; the owners require a dated instrument to be named rather than an undated assertion of strategic partnership, because the date and the forum are what make the claim checkable. D. The Economic Survey 2025-26 records a notable increase in the diversity of countries from which India imports crude oil, with the United States share rising to eight point one per cent from four point six per cent and the United Arab Emirates share to eleven point one per cent from nine point four per cent in April to November of the financial year 2026, while Egypt, Nigeria and Libya also rose and Russia, Saudi Arabia, Iraq and Venezuela declined; the owners insist on the analytical separation that this is diversification of sources and not reduction of aggregate dependence, because equity stakes and a wider supplier base spread single-point-of-failure risk without lowering the share of consumption that must be imported.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Economic Survey 2025-26 records a notable increase in the diversity of countries from which India imports crude oil, with the United States share rising to eight point one per cent from four point six per cent and the United Arab Emirates share to eleven point one per cent from nine point four per cent in April to November of the financial year 2026, while Egypt, Nigeria and Libya also rose and Russia, Saudi Arabia, Iraq and Venezuela declined; the owners insist on the analytical separation that this is diversification of sources and not reduction of aggregate dependence, because equity stakes and a wider supplier base spread single-point-of-failure risk without lowering the share of consumption that must be imported. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Refinery configuration as a hidden switching cost?

A. Tharoor notes that many Indian refineries are in fact devised to process the quality of crude oil that Iran supplies, and Sikri records the underlying policy response of making equity investments in oilfields abroad, so the owners treat configuration-specific refining capacity as a physical constraint on how quickly a supplier mix can actually change; the analytical payoff is that headline diversification percentages move slowly for engineering reasons rather than diplomatic ones, which is why a strategy answer must price switching cost instead of assuming that political intent translates immediately into a changed energy basket. B. India and Israel established full diplomatic relations in 1992 and the first visit by an Indian Prime Minister to Israel in July 2017 marked a major political upgrade, after which cooperation spans defence procurement, counter-terrorism and co-development with the Barak-8 air-defence system as the named joint development, the Indo-Israel Agricultural Project operating Centres of Excellence for protected cultivation, irrigation and post-harvest practices, and the India-Israel Industrial Research and Development and Technological Innovation Fund launched in 2017; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that import dependence, cost and technology-transfer depth remain relevant, that demonstration centres require local extension, affordability and scaling before they affect wider productivity, and that funded projects must be distinguished from announced cooperation. C. Sikri cites a diaspora of five million in the Gulf and Tharoor separately notes that the Arab world is home to nearly six million Indians, both period-specific, while the Ministry of External Affairs overseas-Indian population table as on January 2026 records four million three hundred and forty-four thousand and eight persons in the United Arab Emirates and two million seven hundred and fifty thousand five hundred and fifty-one in Saudi Arabia; the owners require these to be described as population-stock estimates rather than citizenship or Overseas Citizen of India counts, and they route remittance data to the Economy owner and general diaspora diplomacy to topic 09. D. Tharoor states that India values its relationship with Israel, but not at the expense of its friendships with Arab and other Muslim states, which is the explicit textual anchor for every balancing argument in this topic, and the owners sharpen it into active balancing rather than passive equidistance, because India deepens several ties simultaneously instead of avoiding commitment to any; the consequence for answer writing is that the Gulf, Israel and Iran tracks must be presented as parallel and non-exclusive rather than as a sequence of choices in which one relationship displaces another.

Answer: A. Explanation: Tharoor notes that many Indian refineries are in fact devised to process the quality of crude oil that Iran supplies, and Sikri records the underlying policy response of making equity investments in oilfields abroad, so the owners treat configuration-specific refining capacity as a physical constraint on how quickly a supplier mix can actually change; the analytical payoff is that headline diversification percentages move slowly for engineering reasons rather than diplomatic ones, which is why a strategy answer must price switching cost instead of assuming that political intent translates immediately into a changed energy basket. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q18. Which card should be filed under Refinery configuration as a hidden switching cost in an International Relations answer?

A. Tharoor states that India values its relationship with Israel, but not at the expense of its friendships with Arab and other Muslim states, which is the explicit textual anchor for every balancing argument in this topic, and the owners sharpen it into active balancing rather than passive equidistance, because India deepens several ties simultaneously instead of avoiding commitment to any; the consequence for answer writing is that the Gulf, Israel and Iran tracks must be presented as parallel and non-exclusive rather than as a sequence of choices in which one relationship displaces another. B. Tharoor notes that many Indian refineries are in fact devised to process the quality of crude oil that Iran supplies, and Sikri records the underlying policy response of making equity investments in oilfields abroad, so the owners treat configuration-specific refining capacity as a physical constraint on how quickly a supplier mix can actually change; the analytical payoff is that headline diversification percentages move slowly for engineering reasons rather than diplomatic ones, which is why a strategy answer must price switching cost instead of assuming that political intent translates immediately into a changed energy basket. C. The India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Action Plan for 2024-2028 was adopted at the first India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Ministerial Meeting for Strategic Dialogue at Riyadh on 9 September 2024 and is the anchor current framework for India's strategic dialogue with the Council, while the India-Saudi Arabia Strategic Partnership Council held its second meeting at Jeddah on 22 April 2025, India and Qatar signed an Agreement on Establishment of a Bilateral Strategic Partnership on 18 February 2025, and India-United Arab Emirates relations were elevated to a Comprehensive Strategic Partnership on 25 January 2017; the owners require a dated instrument to be named rather than an undated assertion of strategic partnership, because the date and the forum are what make the claim checkable. D. India and Israel established full diplomatic relations in 1992 and the first visit by an Indian Prime Minister to Israel in July 2017 marked a major political upgrade, after which cooperation spans defence procurement, counter-terrorism and co-development with the Barak-8 air-defence system as the named joint development, the Indo-Israel Agricultural Project operating Centres of Excellence for protected cultivation, irrigation and post-harvest practices, and the India-Israel Industrial Research and Development and Technological Innovation Fund launched in 2017; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that import dependence, cost and technology-transfer depth remain relevant, that demonstration centres require local extension, affordability and scaling before they affect wider productivity, and that funded projects must be distinguished from announced cooperation.

Answer: B. Explanation: Tharoor notes that many Indian refineries are in fact devised to process the quality of crude oil that Iran supplies, and Sikri records the underlying policy response of making equity investments in oilfields abroad, so the owners treat configuration-specific refining capacity as a physical constraint on how quickly a supplier mix can actually change; the analytical payoff is that headline diversification percentages move slowly for engineering reasons rather than diplomatic ones, which is why a strategy answer must price switching cost instead of assuming that political intent translates immediately into a changed energy basket. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q19. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Refinery configuration as a hidden switching cost?

A. India and Israel established full diplomatic relations in 1992 and the first visit by an Indian Prime Minister to Israel in July 2017 marked a major political upgrade, after which cooperation spans defence procurement, counter-terrorism and co-development with the Barak-8 air-defence system as the named joint development, the Indo-Israel Agricultural Project operating Centres of Excellence for protected cultivation, irrigation and post-harvest practices, and the India-Israel Industrial Research and Development and Technological Innovation Fund launched in 2017; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that import dependence, cost and technology-transfer depth remain relevant, that demonstration centres require local extension, affordability and scaling before they affect wider productivity, and that funded projects must be distinguished from announced cooperation. B. The India-United Arab Emirates Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement has been in force since 1 May 2022 and officially reported bilateral trade was approximately one hundred billion United States dollars in the financial year 2024-25, while an India-Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement was signed on 18 December 2025 with entry into force requiring separate verification; the owners keep the tariff and trade-volume mechanics with the Economy owner and retain only the strategic-partnership significance here, and they insist that signature and entry into force are recorded as distinct evidentiary levels. C. Tharoor notes that many Indian refineries are in fact devised to process the quality of crude oil that Iran supplies, and Sikri records the underlying policy response of making equity investments in oilfields abroad, so the owners treat configuration-specific refining capacity as a physical constraint on how quickly a supplier mix can actually change; the analytical payoff is that headline diversification percentages move slowly for engineering reasons rather than diplomatic ones, which is why a strategy answer must price switching cost instead of assuming that political intent translates immediately into a changed energy basket. D. The India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Action Plan for 2024-2028 was adopted at the first India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Ministerial Meeting for Strategic Dialogue at Riyadh on 9 September 2024 and is the anchor current framework for India's strategic dialogue with the Council, while the India-Saudi Arabia Strategic Partnership Council held its second meeting at Jeddah on 22 April 2025, India and Qatar signed an Agreement on Establishment of a Bilateral Strategic Partnership on 18 February 2025, and India-United Arab Emirates relations were elevated to a Comprehensive Strategic Partnership on 25 January 2017; the owners require a dated instrument to be named rather than an undated assertion of strategic partnership, because the date and the forum are what make the claim checkable.

Answer: C. Explanation: Tharoor notes that many Indian refineries are in fact devised to process the quality of crude oil that Iran supplies, and Sikri records the underlying policy response of making equity investments in oilfields abroad, so the owners treat configuration-specific refining capacity as a physical constraint on how quickly a supplier mix can actually change; the analytical payoff is that headline diversification percentages move slowly for engineering reasons rather than diplomatic ones, which is why a strategy answer must price switching cost instead of assuming that political intent translates immediately into a changed energy basket. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q20. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Refinery configuration as a hidden switching cost?

A. The India-United Arab Emirates Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement has been in force since 1 May 2022 and officially reported bilateral trade was approximately one hundred billion United States dollars in the financial year 2024-25, while an India-Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement was signed on 18 December 2025 with entry into force requiring separate verification; the owners keep the tariff and trade-volume mechanics with the Economy owner and retain only the strategic-partnership significance here, and they insist that signature and entry into force are recorded as distinct evidentiary levels. B. The India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Action Plan for 2024-2028 was adopted at the first India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Ministerial Meeting for Strategic Dialogue at Riyadh on 9 September 2024 and is the anchor current framework for India's strategic dialogue with the Council, while the India-Saudi Arabia Strategic Partnership Council held its second meeting at Jeddah on 22 April 2025, India and Qatar signed an Agreement on Establishment of a Bilateral Strategic Partnership on 18 February 2025, and India-United Arab Emirates relations were elevated to a Comprehensive Strategic Partnership on 25 January 2017; the owners require a dated instrument to be named rather than an undated assertion of strategic partnership, because the date and the forum are what make the claim checkable. C. I2U2 groups India, Israel, the United Arab Emirates and the United States in a minilateral cooperation framework spanning food security, water, energy and technology, and it emerged in the environment widened by the Abraham Accords of 2020 which normalised Israel's relations with several Arab states without resolving the Palestinian question; the owners record an honest limitation that answers routinely omit, namely that no four-party I2U2 meeting or outcome in 2024 to 2026 could be verified from official sources and that the India-United States statement of 13 February 2025 recorded only an intention to convene partners, so continuous activity must not be assumed. D. Tharoor notes that many Indian refineries are in fact devised to process the quality of crude oil that Iran supplies, and Sikri records the underlying policy response of making equity investments in oilfields abroad, so the owners treat configuration-specific refining capacity as a physical constraint on how quickly a supplier mix can actually change; the analytical payoff is that headline diversification percentages move slowly for engineering reasons rather than diplomatic ones, which is why a strategy answer must price switching cost instead of assuming that political intent translates immediately into a changed energy basket.

Answer: D. Explanation: Tharoor notes that many Indian refineries are in fact devised to process the quality of crude oil that Iran supplies, and Sikri records the underlying policy response of making equity investments in oilfields abroad, so the owners treat configuration-specific refining capacity as a physical constraint on how quickly a supplier mix can actually change; the analytical payoff is that headline diversification percentages move slowly for engineering reasons rather than diplomatic ones, which is why a strategy answer must price switching cost instead of assuming that political intent translates immediately into a changed energy basket. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Gulf diaspora scale and the exact status of every figure?

A. Sikri cites a diaspora of five million in the Gulf and Tharoor separately notes that the Arab world is home to nearly six million Indians, both period-specific, while the Ministry of External Affairs overseas-Indian population table as on January 2026 records four million three hundred and forty-four thousand and eight persons in the United Arab Emirates and two million seven hundred and fifty thousand five hundred and fifty-one in Saudi Arabia; the owners require these to be described as population-stock estimates rather than citizenship or Overseas Citizen of India counts, and they route remittance data to the Economy owner and general diaspora diplomacy to topic 09. B. Tharoor states that India values its relationship with Israel, but not at the expense of its friendships with Arab and other Muslim states, which is the explicit textual anchor for every balancing argument in this topic, and the owners sharpen it into active balancing rather than passive equidistance, because India deepens several ties simultaneously instead of avoiding commitment to any; the consequence for answer writing is that the Gulf, Israel and Iran tracks must be presented as parallel and non-exclusive rather than as a sequence of choices in which one relationship displaces another. C. The India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Action Plan for 2024-2028 was adopted at the first India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Ministerial Meeting for Strategic Dialogue at Riyadh on 9 September 2024 and is the anchor current framework for India's strategic dialogue with the Council, while the India-Saudi Arabia Strategic Partnership Council held its second meeting at Jeddah on 22 April 2025, India and Qatar signed an Agreement on Establishment of a Bilateral Strategic Partnership on 18 February 2025, and India-United Arab Emirates relations were elevated to a Comprehensive Strategic Partnership on 25 January 2017; the owners require a dated instrument to be named rather than an undated assertion of strategic partnership, because the date and the forum are what make the claim checkable. D. India and Israel established full diplomatic relations in 1992 and the first visit by an Indian Prime Minister to Israel in July 2017 marked a major political upgrade, after which cooperation spans defence procurement, counter-terrorism and co-development with the Barak-8 air-defence system as the named joint development, the Indo-Israel Agricultural Project operating Centres of Excellence for protected cultivation, irrigation and post-harvest practices, and the India-Israel Industrial Research and Development and Technological Innovation Fund launched in 2017; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that import dependence, cost and technology-transfer depth remain relevant, that demonstration centres require local extension, affordability and scaling before they affect wider productivity, and that funded projects must be distinguished from announced cooperation.

Answer: A. Explanation: Sikri cites a diaspora of five million in the Gulf and Tharoor separately notes that the Arab world is home to nearly six million Indians, both period-specific, while the Ministry of External Affairs overseas-Indian population table as on January 2026 records four million three hundred and forty-four thousand and eight persons in the United Arab Emirates and two million seven hundred and fifty thousand five hundred and fifty-one in Saudi Arabia; the owners require these to be described as population-stock estimates rather than citizenship or Overseas Citizen of India counts, and they route remittance data to the

Economy owner and general diaspora diplomacy to topic 09. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q22. Which card should be filed under Gulf diaspora scale and the exact status of every figure in an International Relations answer?

A. The India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Action Plan for 2024-2028 was adopted at the first India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Ministerial Meeting for Strategic Dialogue at Riyadh on 9 September 2024 and is the anchor current framework for India's strategic dialogue with the Council, while the India-Saudi Arabia Strategic Partnership Council held its second meeting at Jeddah on 22 April 2025, India and Qatar signed an Agreement on Establishment of a Bilateral Strategic Partnership on 18 February 2025, and India-United Arab Emirates relations were elevated to a Comprehensive Strategic Partnership on 25 January 2017; the owners require a dated instrument to be named rather than an undated assertion of strategic partnership, because the date and the forum are what make the claim checkable. B. Sikri cites a diaspora of five million in the Gulf and Tharoor separately notes that the Arab world is home to nearly six million Indians, both period-specific, while the Ministry of External Affairs overseas-Indian population table as on January 2026 records four million three hundred and forty-four thousand and eight persons in the United Arab Emirates and two million seven hundred and fifty thousand five hundred and fifty-one in Saudi Arabia; the owners require these to be described as population-stock estimates rather than citizenship or Overseas Citizen of India counts, and they route remittance data to the Economy owner and general diaspora diplomacy to topic 09. C. India and Israel established full diplomatic relations in 1992 and the first visit by an Indian Prime Minister to Israel in July 2017 marked a major political upgrade, after which cooperation spans defence procurement, counter-terrorism and co-development with the Barak-8 air-defence system as the named joint development, the Indo-Israel Agricultural Project operating Centres of Excellence for protected cultivation, irrigation and post-harvest practices, and the India-Israel Industrial Research and Development and Technological Innovation Fund launched in 2017; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that import dependence, cost and technology-transfer depth remain relevant, that demonstration centres require local extension, affordability and scaling before they affect wider productivity, and that funded projects must be distinguished from announced cooperation. D. The India-United Arab Emirates Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement has been in force since 1 May 2022 and officially reported bilateral trade was approximately one hundred billion United States dollars in the financial year 2024-25, while an India-Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement was signed on 18 December 2025 with entry into force requiring separate verification; the owners keep the tariff and trade-volume mechanics with the Economy owner and retain only the strategic-partnership significance here, and they insist that signature and entry into force are recorded as distinct evidentiary levels.

Answer: B. Explanation: Sikri cites a diaspora of five million in the Gulf and Tharoor separately notes that the Arab world is home to nearly six million Indians, both period-specific, while the Ministry of External Affairs overseas-Indian population table as on January 2026 records four million three hundred and forty-four thousand and eight persons in the United Arab Emirates and two million seven hundred and fifty thousand five hundred and fifty-one in Saudi Arabia; the owners require these to be described as population-stock estimates rather than citizenship or Overseas Citizen of India counts, and they route remittance data to the Economy owner and general diaspora diplomacy to topic 09. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q23. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Gulf diaspora scale and the exact status of every figure?

A. The India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Action Plan for 2024-2028 was adopted at the first India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Ministerial Meeting for Strategic Dialogue at Riyadh on 9 September 2024 and is the anchor current framework for India's strategic dialogue with the Council, while the India-Saudi Arabia Strategic Partnership Council held its second meeting at Jeddah on 22 April 2025, India and Qatar signed an Agreement on Establishment of a Bilateral Strategic Partnership on 18 February 2025, and India-United Arab Emirates relations were elevated to a Comprehensive Strategic Partnership on 25 January 2017; the owners require a dated instrument to be named rather than an undated assertion of strategic partnership, because the date and the forum are what make the claim checkable. B. I2U2 groups India, Israel, the United Arab Emirates and the United States in a minilateral cooperation framework spanning food security, water, energy and technology, and it emerged in the environment widened by the Abraham Accords of 2020 which normalised Israel's relations with several Arab states without resolving the

Palestinian question; the owners record an honest limitation that answers routinely omit, namely that no four-party I2U2 meeting or outcome in 2024 to 2026 could be verified from official sources and that the India-United States statement of 13 February 2025 recorded only an intention to convene partners, so continuous activity must not be assumed. C. Sikri cites a diaspora of five million in the Gulf and Tharoor separately notes that the Arab world is home to nearly six million Indians, both period-specific, while the Ministry of External Affairs overseas-Indian population table as on January 2026 records four million three hundred and forty-four thousand and eight persons in the United Arab Emirates and two million seven hundred and fifty thousand five hundred and fifty-one in Saudi Arabia; the owners require these to be described as population-stock estimates rather than citizenship or Overseas Citizen of India counts, and they route remittance data to the Economy owner and general diaspora diplomacy to topic 09. D. The India-United Arab Emirates Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement has been in force since 1 May 2022 and officially reported bilateral trade was approximately one hundred billion United States dollars in the financial year 2024-25, while an India-Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement was signed on 18 December 2025 with entry into force requiring separate verification; the owners keep the tariff and trade-volume mechanics with the Economy owner and retain only the strategic-partnership significance here, and they insist that signature and entry into force are recorded as distinct evidentiary levels.

Answer: C. Explanation: Sikri cites a diaspora of five million in the Gulf and Tharoor separately notes that the Arab world is home to nearly six million Indians, both period-specific, while the Ministry of External Affairs overseas-Indian population table as on January 2026 records four million three hundred and forty-four thousand and eight persons in the United Arab Emirates and two million seven hundred and fifty thousand five hundred and fifty-one in Saudi Arabia; the owners require these to be described as population-stock estimates rather than citizenship or Overseas Citizen of India counts, and they route remittance data to the Economy owner and general diaspora diplomacy to topic 09. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q24. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Gulf diaspora scale and the exact status of every figure?

A. The India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor memorandum of understanding was signed in New Delhi on 9 September 2023 by eight parties, namely India, the United States, Saudi Arabia, the United Arab Emirates, the European Union, France, Germany and Italy, on the margins of the Group of Twenty summit, and the Ministry of External Affairs India-United Arab Emirates readout of 24 June 2024 referred to commencement of work on the corridor; the owners are categorical that a memorandum among eight parties is a framework of intent and that no completed construction or operating segment is officially established, so connectivity diplomacy and connectivity infrastructure must never be conflated. B. The India-United Arab Emirates Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement has been in force since 1 May 2022 and officially reported bilateral trade was approximately one hundred billion United States dollars in the financial year 2024-25, while an India-Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement was signed on 18 December 2025 with entry into force requiring separate verification; the owners keep the tariff and trade-volume mechanics with the Economy owner and retain only the strategic-partnership significance here, and they insist that signature and entry into force are recorded as distinct evidentiary levels. C. I2U2 groups India, Israel, the United Arab Emirates and the United States in a minilateral cooperation framework spanning food security, water, energy and technology, and it emerged in the environment widened by the Abraham Accords of 2020 which normalised Israel's relations with several Arab states without resolving the Palestinian question; the owners record an honest limitation that answers routinely omit, namely that no four-party I2U2 meeting or outcome in 2024 to 2026 could be verified from official sources and that the India-United States statement of 13 February 2025 recorded only an intention to convene partners, so continuous activity must not be assumed. D. Sikri cites a diaspora of five million in the Gulf and Tharoor separately notes that the Arab world is home to nearly six million Indians, both period-specific, while the Ministry of External Affairs overseas-Indian population table as on January 2026 records four million three hundred and forty-four thousand and eight persons in the United Arab Emirates and two million seven hundred and fifty thousand five hundred and fifty-one in Saudi Arabia; the owners require these to be described as population-stock estimates rather than citizenship or Overseas Citizen of India counts, and they route remittance data to the Economy owner and general diaspora diplomacy to topic 09.

Answer: D. Explanation: Sikri cites a diaspora of five million in the Gulf and Tharoor separately notes that the Arab world is home to nearly six million Indians, both period-specific, while the Ministry of External Affairs overseas-Indian population table as on January 2026 records four million three hundred and forty-four

thousand and eight persons in the United Arab Emirates and two million seven hundred and fifty thousand five hundred and fifty-one in Saudi Arabia; the owners require these to be described as population-stock estimates rather than citizenship or Overseas Citizen of India counts, and they route remittance data to the Economy owner and general diaspora diplomacy to topic 09. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies The Israel-Arab balancing principle stated in the source?

A. Tharoor states that India values its relationship with Israel, but not at the expense of its friendships with Arab and other Muslim states, which is the explicit textual anchor for every balancing argument in this topic, and the owners sharpen it into active balancing rather than passive equidistance, because India deepens several ties simultaneously instead of avoiding commitment to any; the consequence for answer writing is that the Gulf, Israel and Iran tracks must be presented as parallel and non-exclusive rather than as a sequence of choices in which one relationship displaces another. B. The India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Action Plan for 2024-2028 was adopted at the first India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Ministerial Meeting for Strategic Dialogue at Riyadh on 9 September 2024 and is the anchor current framework for India's strategic dialogue with the Council, while the India-Saudi Arabia Strategic Partnership Council held its second meeting at Jeddah on 22 April 2025, India and Qatar signed an Agreement on Establishment of a Bilateral Strategic Partnership on 18 February 2025, and India-United Arab Emirates relations were elevated to a Comprehensive Strategic Partnership on 25 January 2017; the owners require a dated instrument to be named rather than an undated assertion of strategic partnership, because the date and the forum are what make the claim checkable. C. India and Israel established full diplomatic relations in 1992 and the first visit by an Indian Prime Minister to Israel in July 2017 marked a major political upgrade, after which cooperation spans defence procurement, counter-terrorism and co-development with the Barak-8 air-defence system as the named joint development, the Indo-Israel Agricultural Project operating Centres of Excellence for protected cultivation, irrigation and post-harvest practices, and the India-Israel Industrial Research and Development and Technological Innovation Fund launched in 2017; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that import dependence, cost and technology-transfer depth remain relevant, that demonstration centres require local extension, affordability and scaling before they affect wider productivity, and that funded projects must be distinguished from announced cooperation. D. The India-United Arab Emirates Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement has been in force since 1 May 2022 and officially reported bilateral trade was approximately one hundred billion United States dollars in the financial year 2024-25, while an India-Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement was signed on 18 December 2025 with entry into force requiring separate verification; the owners keep the tariff and trade-volume mechanics with the Economy owner and retain only the strategic-partnership significance here, and they insist that signature and entry into force are recorded as distinct evidentiary levels.

Answer: A. Explanation: Tharoor states that India values its relationship with Israel, but not at the expense of its friendships with Arab and other Muslim states, which is the explicit textual anchor for every balancing argument in this topic, and the owners sharpen it into active balancing rather than passive equidistance, because India deepens several ties simultaneously instead of avoiding commitment to any; the consequence for answer writing is that the Gulf, Israel and Iran tracks must be presented as parallel and non-exclusive rather than as a sequence of choices in which one relationship displaces another. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q26. Which card should be filed under The Israel-Arab balancing principle stated in the source in an International Relations answer?

A. I2U2 groups India, Israel, the United Arab Emirates and the United States in a minilateral cooperation framework spanning food security, water, energy and technology, and it emerged in the environment widened by the Abraham Accords of 2020 which normalised Israel's relations with several Arab states without resolving the Palestinian question; the owners record an honest limitation that answers routinely omit, namely that no four-party I2U2 meeting or outcome in 2024 to 2026 could be verified from official sources and that the India-United States statement of 13 February 2025 recorded only an intention to convene partners, so continuous activity must not be assumed. B. Tharoor states that India values its relationship with Israel, but not at the expense of its friendships with Arab and other Muslim states, which is the explicit textual anchor for every balancing argument in this topic, and the owners sharpen it into active balancing rather than passive equidistance, because India deepens several ties simultaneously instead of avoiding commitment to any; the consequence for answer writing is that the Gulf, Israel and Iran tracks must be presented as parallel and non-exclusive rather than as a sequence of choices in which one relationship displaces another. C. The India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Action Plan for 2024-2028 was adopted at the first India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Ministerial Meeting for Strategic Dialogue at Riyadh on 9 September 2024 and is the anchor current framework for India's strategic dialogue with the Council, while the India-Saudi Arabia Strategic Partnership Council held its second meeting at Jeddah on 22 April 2025, India and Qatar signed an Agreement on Establishment of a Bilateral Strategic Partnership on 18 February 2025, and India-United Arab Emirates relations were elevated to a Comprehensive Strategic Partnership on 25 January 2017; the owners require a dated instrument to be named rather than an undated assertion of strategic partnership, because the date and the forum are what make the claim checkable. D. The India-United Arab Emirates Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement has been in force since 1 May 2022 and officially reported bilateral trade was approximately one hundred billion United States dollars in the financial year 2024-25, while an India-Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement was signed on 18 December 2025 with entry into force requiring separate verification; the owners keep the tariff and trade-volume mechanics with the Economy owner and retain only the strategic-partnership significance here, and they insist that signature and entry into force are recorded as distinct evidentiary levels.

Answer: B. Explanation: Tharoor states that India values its relationship with Israel, but not at the expense of its friendships with Arab and other Muslim states, which is the explicit textual anchor for every balancing argument in this topic, and the owners sharpen it into active balancing rather than passive equidistance, because India deepens several ties simultaneously instead of avoiding commitment to any; the consequence for answer writing is that the Gulf, Israel and Iran tracks must be presented as parallel and non-exclusive rather than as a sequence of choices in which one relationship displaces another. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q27. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The Israel-Arab balancing principle stated in the source?

A. The India-United Arab Emirates Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement has been in force since 1 May 2022 and officially reported bilateral trade was approximately one hundred billion United States dollars in the financial year 2024-25, while an India-Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement was signed on 18 December 2025 with entry into force requiring separate verification; the owners keep the tariff and trade-volume mechanics with the Economy owner and retain only the strategic-partnership significance here, and they insist that signature and entry into force are recorded as distinct evidentiary levels. B. I2U2 groups India, Israel, the United Arab Emirates and the United States in a minilateral cooperation framework spanning food security, water, energy and technology, and it emerged in the environment widened by the Abraham Accords of 2020 which normalised Israel's relations with several Arab states without resolving the Palestinian question; the owners record an honest limitation that answers routinely omit, namely that no four-party I2U2 meeting or outcome in 2024 to 2026 could be verified from official sources and that the India-United States statement of 13 February 2025 recorded only an intention to convene partners, so continuous activity must not be assumed. C. Tharoor states that India values its relationship with Israel, but not at the expense of its friendships with Arab and other Muslim states, which is the explicit textual anchor for every balancing argument in this topic, and the owners sharpen it into active balancing rather than passive equidistance, because India deepens several ties simultaneously instead of avoiding commitment to any; the consequence for answer writing is that the Gulf, Israel and Iran tracks must be presented as parallel and non-exclusive rather than as a sequence of choices in which one relationship displaces another. D. The India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor memorandum of understanding was signed in New Delhi on 9 September 2023 by eight parties, namely India, the United States, Saudi Arabia, the United Arab Emirates, the European Union, France, Germany and Italy, on the margins of the Group of Twenty summit, and the Ministry of External Affairs India-United Arab Emirates readout of 24 June 2024 referred to commencement of work on the corridor; the owners are categorical that a memorandum among eight parties is a framework of intent and that no completed construction or operating segment is officially established, so connectivity diplomacy and connectivity infrastructure must never be conflated.

Answer: C. Explanation: Tharoor states that India values its relationship with Israel, but not at the expense of its friendships with Arab and other Muslim states, which is the explicit textual anchor for every balancing argument in this topic, and the owners sharpen it into active balancing rather than passive equidistance, because India deepens several ties simultaneously instead of avoiding commitment to any; the consequence for answer writing is that the Gulf, Israel and Iran tracks must be presented as parallel and non-exclusive

rather than as a sequence of choices in which one relationship displaces another. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q28. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The Israel-Arab balancing principle stated in the source?

A. I2U2 groups India, Israel, the United Arab Emirates and the United States in a minilateral cooperation framework spanning food security, water, energy and technology, and it emerged in the environment widened by the Abraham Accords of 2020 which normalised Israel's relations with several Arab states without resolving the Palestinian question; the owners record an honest limitation that answers routinely omit, namely that no four-party I2U2 meeting or outcome in 2024 to 2026 could be verified from official sources and that the India-United States statement of 13 February 2025 recorded only an intention to convene partners, so continuous activity must not be assumed. B. The India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor memorandum of understanding was signed in New Delhi on 9 September 2023 by eight parties, namely India, the United States, Saudi Arabia, the United Arab Emirates, the European Union, France, Germany and Italy, on the margins of the Group of Twenty summit, and the Ministry of External Affairs India-United Arab Emirates readout of 24 June 2024 referred to commencement of work on the corridor; the owners are categorical that a memorandum among eight parties is a framework of intent and that no completed construction or operating segment is officially established, so connectivity diplomacy and connectivity infrastructure must never be conflated. C. The Strait of Hormuz is the narrow outlet from the Persian Gulf to the Gulf of Oman and is the principal route-risk chokepoint for Gulf energy shipments, so disruption there can transmit immediately into freight, insurance and supply insecurity for India, and the owners add the qualification that supplier diversification does not eliminate common-route exposure while strategic reserves and alternative energy reduce but do not remove the risk; the wider structural point is that West Asian risk is compounding rather than isolated, because one escalation can threaten energy-supply continuity, diaspora physical safety and connectivity-project viability at the same time. D. Tharoor states that India values its relationship with Israel, but not at the expense of its friendships with Arab and other Muslim states, which is the explicit textual anchor for every balancing argument in this topic, and the owners sharpen it into active balancing rather than passive equidistance, because India deepens several ties simultaneously instead of avoiding commitment to any; the consequence for answer writing is that the Gulf, Israel and Iran tracks must be presented as parallel and non-exclusive rather than as a sequence of choices in which one relationship displaces another.

Answer: D. Explanation: Tharoor states that India values its relationship with Israel, but not at the expense of its friendships with Arab and other Muslim states, which is the explicit textual anchor for every balancing argument in this topic, and the owners sharpen it into active balancing rather than passive equidistance, because India deepens several ties simultaneously instead of avoiding commitment to any; the consequence for answer writing is that the Gulf, Israel and Iran tracks must be presented as parallel and non-exclusive rather than as a sequence of choices in which one relationship displaces another. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies The India-Israel relationship in its full diversity?

A. India and Israel established full diplomatic relations in 1992 and the first visit by an Indian Prime Minister to Israel in July 2017 marked a major political upgrade, after which cooperation spans defence procurement, counter-terrorism and co-development with the Barak-8 air-defence system as the named joint development, the Indo-Israel Agricultural Project operating Centres of Excellence for protected cultivation, irrigation and post-harvest practices, and the India-Israel Industrial Research and Development and Technological Innovation Fund launched in 2017; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that import dependence, cost and technology-transfer depth remain relevant, that demonstration centres require local extension, affordability and scaling before they affect wider productivity, and that funded projects must be distinguished from announced cooperation. B. The India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Action Plan for 2024-2028 was adopted at the first India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Ministerial Meeting for Strategic Dialogue at Riyadh on 9 September 2024 and is the anchor current framework for India's strategic dialogue with the Council, while the India-Saudi Arabia Strategic Partnership Council held its second meeting at Jeddah on 22 April 2025, India and Qatar signed an Agreement on Establishment of a Bilateral Strategic Partnership on 18 February 2025, and India-United Arab Emirates relations were elevated to a Comprehensive Strategic Partnership on 25 January 2017; the owners require a dated instrument to be named rather than an undated assertion of strategic partnership, because the date and the forum are what make the claim checkable. C. The India-United Arab Emirates

Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement has been in force since 1 May 2022 and officially reported bilateral trade was approximately one hundred billion United States dollars in the financial year 2024-25, while an India-Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement was signed on 18 December 2025 with entry into force requiring separate verification; the owners keep the tariff and trade-volume mechanics with the Economy owner and retain only the strategic-partnership significance here, and they insist that signature and entry into force are recorded as distinct evidentiary levels. D. I2U2 groups India, Israel, the United Arab Emirates and the United States in a minilateral cooperation framework spanning food security, water, energy and technology, and it emerged in the environment widened by the Abraham Accords of 2020 which normalised Israel's relations with several Arab states without resolving the Palestinian question; the owners record an honest limitation that answers routinely omit, namely that no four-party I2U2 meeting or outcome in 2024 to 2026 could be verified from official sources and that the India-United States statement of 13 February 2025 recorded only an intention to convene partners, so continuous activity must not be assumed.

Answer: A. Explanation: India and Israel established full diplomatic relations in 1992 and the first visit by an Indian Prime Minister to Israel in July 2017 marked a major political upgrade, after which cooperation spans defence procurement, counter-terrorism and co-development with the Barak-8 air-defence system as the named joint development, the Indo-Israel Agricultural Project operating Centres of Excellence for protected cultivation, irrigation and post-harvest practices, and the India-Israel Industrial Research and Development and Technological Innovation Fund launched in 2017; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that import dependence, cost and technology-transfer depth remain relevant, that demonstration centres require local extension, affordability and scaling before they affect wider productivity, and that funded projects must be distinguished from announced cooperation. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q30. Which card should be filed under The India-Israel relationship in its full diversity in an International Relations answer?

A. The India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor memorandum of understanding was signed in New Delhi on 9 September 2023 by eight parties, namely India, the United States, Saudi Arabia, the United Arab Emirates, the European Union, France, Germany and Italy, on the margins of the Group of Twenty summit, and the Ministry of External Affairs India-United Arab Emirates readout of 24 June 2024 referred to commencement of work on the corridor; the owners are categorical that a memorandum among eight parties is a framework of intent and that no completed construction or operating segment is officially established, so connectivity diplomacy and connectivity infrastructure must never be conflated. B. India and Israel established full diplomatic relations in 1992 and the first visit by an Indian Prime Minister to Israel in July 2017 marked a major political upgrade, after which cooperation spans defence procurement, counter-terrorism and co-development with the Barak-8 air-defence system as the named joint development, the Indo-Israel Agricultural Project operating Centres of Excellence for protected cultivation, irrigation and post-harvest practices, and the India-Israel Industrial Research and Development and Technological Innovation Fund launched in 2017; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that import dependence, cost and technology-transfer depth remain relevant, that demonstration centres require local extension, affordability and scaling before they affect wider productivity, and that funded projects must be distinguished from announced cooperation. C. I2U2 groups India, Israel, the United Arab Emirates and the United States in a minilateral cooperation framework spanning food security, water, energy and technology, and it emerged in the environment widened by the Abraham Accords of 2020 which normalised Israel's relations with several Arab states without resolving the Palestinian question; the owners record an honest limitation that answers routinely omit, namely that no four-party I2U2 meeting or outcome in 2024 to 2026 could be verified from official sources and that the India-United States statement of 13 February 2025 recorded only an intention to convene partners, so continuous activity must not be assumed. D. The India-United Arab Emirates Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement has been in force since 1 May 2022 and officially reported bilateral trade was approximately one hundred billion United States dollars in the financial year 2024-25, while an India-Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement was signed on 18 December 2025 with entry into force requiring separate verification; the owners keep the tariff and trade-volume mechanics with the Economy owner and retain only the strategic-partnership significance here, and they insist that signature and entry into force are recorded as distinct evidentiary levels.

Answer: B. Explanation: India and Israel established full diplomatic relations in 1992 and the first visit by an Indian Prime Minister to Israel in July 2017 marked a major political upgrade, after which cooperation spans

defence procurement, counter-terrorism and co-development with the Barak-8 air-defence system as the named joint development, the Indo-Israel Agricultural Project operating Centres of Excellence for protected cultivation, irrigation and post-harvest practices, and the India-Israel Industrial Research and Development and Technological Innovation Fund launched in 2017; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that import dependence, cost and technology-transfer depth remain relevant, that demonstration centres require local extension, affordability and scaling before they affect wider productivity, and that funded projects must be distinguished from announced cooperation. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q31. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The India-Israel relationship in its full diversity?

A. The India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor memorandum of understanding was signed in New Delhi on 9 September 2023 by eight parties, namely India, the United States, Saudi Arabia, the United Arab Emirates, the European Union, France, Germany and Italy, on the margins of the Group of Twenty summit, and the Ministry of External Affairs India-United Arab Emirates readout of 24 June 2024 referred to commencement of work on the corridor; the owners are categorical that a memorandum among eight parties is a framework of intent and that no completed construction or operating segment is officially established, so connectivity diplomacy and connectivity infrastructure must never be conflated. B. The Strait of Hormuz is the narrow outlet from the Persian Gulf to the Gulf of Oman and is the principal route-risk chokepoint for Gulf energy shipments, so disruption there can transmit immediately into freight, insurance and supply insecurity for India, and the owners add the qualification that supplier diversification does not eliminate common-route exposure while strategic reserves and alternative energy reduce but do not remove the risk; the wider structural point is that West Asian risk is compounding rather than isolated, because one escalation can threaten energy-supply continuity, diaspora physical safety and connectivity-project viability at the same time. C. India and Israel established full diplomatic relations in 1992 and the first visit by an Indian Prime Minister to Israel in July 2017 marked a major political upgrade, after which cooperation spans defence procurement, counter-terrorism and co-development with the Barak-8 air-defence system as the named joint development, the Indo-Israel Agricultural Project operating Centres of Excellence for protected cultivation, irrigation and post-harvest practices, and the India-Israel Industrial Research and Development and Technological Innovation Fund launched in 2017; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that import dependence, cost and technology-transfer depth remain relevant, that demonstration centres require local extension, affordability and scaling before they affect wider productivity, and that funded projects must be distinguished from announced cooperation. D. I2U2 groups India, Israel, the United Arab Emirates and the United States in a minilateral cooperation framework spanning food security, water, energy and technology, and it emerged in the environment widened by the Abraham Accords of 2020 which normalised Israel's relations with several Arab states without resolving the Palestinian question; the owners record an honest limitation that answers routinely omit, namely that no four-party I2U2 meeting or outcome in 2024 to 2026 could be verified from official sources and that the India-United States statement of 13 February 2025 recorded only an intention to convene partners, so continuous activity must not be assumed.

Answer: C. Explanation: India and Israel established full diplomatic relations in 1992 and the first visit by an Indian Prime Minister to Israel in July 2017 marked a major political upgrade, after which cooperation spans defence procurement, counter-terrorism and co-development with the Barak-8 air-defence system as the named joint development, the Indo-Israel Agricultural Project operating Centres of Excellence for protected cultivation, irrigation and post-harvest practices, and the India-Israel Industrial Research and Development and Technological Innovation Fund launched in 2017; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that import dependence, cost and technology-transfer depth remain relevant, that demonstration centres require local extension, affordability and scaling before they affect wider productivity, and that funded projects must be distinguished from announced cooperation. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q32. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The India-Israel relationship in its full diversity?

A. The Strait of Hormuz is the narrow outlet from the Persian Gulf to the Gulf of Oman and is the principal route-risk chokepoint for Gulf energy shipments, so disruption there can transmit immediately into freight, insurance and supply insecurity for India, and the owners add the qualification that supplier diversification does not eliminate common-route exposure while strategic reserves and alternative energy reduce but do not remove the risk; the wider structural point is that West Asian risk is compounding rather than isolated, because one escalation can threaten energy-supply continuity, diaspora physical safety and connectivity-project viability at the same time. B. The India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor memorandum of understanding was signed in New Delhi on 9 September 2023 by eight parties, namely India, the United States, Saudi Arabia, the United Arab Emirates, the European Union, France, Germany and Italy, on the margins of the Group of Twenty summit, and the Ministry of External Affairs India-United Arab Emirates readout of 24 June 2024 referred to commencement of work on the corridor; the owners are categorical that a memorandum among eight parties is a framework of intent and that no completed construction or operating segment is officially established, so connectivity diplomacy and connectivity infrastructure must never be conflated. C. The Joint Comprehensive Plan of Action was concluded on 14 July 2015 between Iran and the E3 and European Union plus three grouping and was endorsed by United Nations Security Council resolution 2231, after which the United States announced withdrawal on 8 May 2018 and restored sanctions in stages, and the owners give an explicit status caution that the Plan must not be described as normally functioning because, following the E3 snapback action in 2025, the status of restored United Nations measures is disputed by Iran, Russia and China; the examinable consequence is that nuclear diplomacy initially widened the space for energy and connectivity ties while renewed sanctions exposed Indian oil, banking, insurance and project channels to third-country pressure. D. India and Israel established full diplomatic relations in 1992 and the first visit by an Indian Prime Minister to Israel in July 2017 marked a major political upgrade, after which cooperation spans defence procurement, counter-terrorism and co-development with the Barak-8 air-defence system as the named joint development, the Indo-Israel Agricultural Project operating Centres of Excellence for protected cultivation, irrigation and post-harvest practices, and the India-Israel Industrial Research and Development and Technological Innovation Fund launched in 2017; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that import dependence, cost and technology-transfer depth remain relevant, that demonstration centres require local extension, affordability and scaling before they affect wider productivity, and that funded projects must be distinguished from announced cooperation.

Answer: D. Explanation: India and Israel established full diplomatic relations in 1992 and the first visit by an Indian Prime Minister to Israel in July 2017 marked a major political upgrade, after which cooperation spans defence procurement, counter-terrorism and co-development with the Barak-8 air-defence system as the named joint development, the Indo-Israel Agricultural Project operating Centres of Excellence for protected cultivation, irrigation and post-harvest practices, and the India-Israel Industrial Research and Development and Technological Innovation Fund launched in 2017; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that import dependence, cost and technology-transfer depth remain relevant, that demonstration centres require local extension, affordability and scaling before they affect wider productivity, and that funded projects must be distinguished from announced cooperation. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies The Gulf institutional architecture and its dated instruments?

A. The India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Action Plan for 2024-2028 was adopted at the first India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Ministerial Meeting for Strategic Dialogue at Riyadh on 9 September 2024 and is the anchor current framework for India's strategic dialogue with the Council, while the India-Saudi Arabia Strategic Partnership Council held its second meeting at Jeddah on 22 April 2025, India and Qatar signed an Agreement on Establishment of a Bilateral Strategic Partnership on 18 February 2025, and India-United Arab Emirates relations were elevated to a Comprehensive Strategic Partnership on 25 January 2017; the owners require a dated instrument to be named rather than an undated assertion of strategic partnership, because the date and the forum are what make the claim checkable. B. The India-United Arab Emirates Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement has been in force since 1 May 2022 and officially reported bilateral trade was approximately one hundred billion United States dollars in the financial year 2024-25, while an India-Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement was signed on 18 December 2025 with entry into force requiring separate verification; the owners keep the tariff and trade-volume mechanics with the Economy owner and retain only the strategic-partnership significance here, and they insist that signature and entry into force are recorded as distinct evidentiary levels. C. I2U2 groups India, Israel, the United Arab Emirates and the United States in a minilateral cooperation framework spanning food security, water, energy and technology, and it emerged in the environment widened by the Abraham Accords of 2020 which normalised Israel's relations with several Arab states without resolving the Palestinian question; the owners record an honest limitation that answers routinely omit, namely that no four-party I2U2 meeting or outcome in 2024 to 2026 could be verified from official sources and that the India-United States statement of 13 February 2025 recorded only an intention to convene partners, so continuous activity must not be assumed. D. The India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor memorandum of understanding was signed in New Delhi on 9 September 2023 by eight parties, namely India, the United States, Saudi Arabia, the United Arab Emirates, the European Union, France, Germany and Italy, on the margins of the Group of Twenty summit, and the Ministry of External Affairs India-United Arab Emirates readout of 24 June 2024 referred to commencement of work on the corridor; the owners are categorical that a memorandum among eight parties is a framework of intent and that no completed construction or operating segment is officially established, so connectivity diplomacy and connectivity infrastructure must never be conflated.

Answer: A. Explanation: The India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Action Plan for 2024-2028 was adopted at the first India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Ministerial Meeting for Strategic Dialogue at Riyadh on 9 September 2024 and is the anchor current framework for India's strategic dialogue with the Council, while the India-Saudi Arabia Strategic Partnership Council held its second meeting at Jeddah on 22 April 2025, India and Qatar signed an Agreement on Establishment of a Bilateral Strategic Partnership on 18 February 2025, and India-United Arab Emirates relations were elevated to a Comprehensive Strategic Partnership on 25 January 2017; the owners require a dated instrument to be named rather than an undated assertion of strategic partnership, because the date and the forum are what make the claim checkable. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q34. Which card should be filed under The Gulf institutional architecture and its dated instruments in an International Relations answer?

A. I2U2 groups India, Israel, the United Arab Emirates and the United States in a minilateral cooperation framework spanning food security, water, energy and technology, and it emerged in the environment widened by the Abraham Accords of 2020 which normalised Israel's relations with several Arab states without resolving the Palestinian question; the owners record an honest limitation that answers routinely omit, namely that no four-party I2U2 meeting or outcome in 2024 to 2026 could be verified from official sources and that the India-United States statement of 13 February 2025 recorded only an intention to convene partners, so continuous activity must not be assumed. B. The India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Action Plan for 2024-2028 was adopted at the first India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Ministerial Meeting for Strategic Dialogue at Riyadh on 9 September 2024 and is the anchor current framework for India's strategic dialogue with the Council, while the India-Saudi Arabia Strategic Partnership Council held its second meeting at Jeddah on 22 April 2025, India and Qatar signed an Agreement on Establishment of a Bilateral Strategic Partnership on 18 February 2025, and India-United Arab Emirates relations were elevated to a Comprehensive Strategic Partnership on 25 January 2017; the owners require a dated instrument to be named rather than an undated assertion of strategic partnership, because the date and the forum are what make the claim checkable. C. The Strait of Hormuz is the narrow outlet from the Persian Gulf to the Gulf of Oman and is the principal route-risk chokepoint for Gulf energy shipments, so disruption there can transmit immediately into freight, insurance and supply insecurity for India, and the owners add the qualification that supplier diversification does not eliminate common-route exposure while strategic reserves and alternative energy reduce but do not remove the risk; the wider structural point is that West Asian risk is compounding rather than isolated, because one escalation can threaten energy-supply continuity, diaspora physical safety and connectivity-project viability at the same time. D. The India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor memorandum of understanding was signed in New Delhi on 9 September 2023 by eight parties, namely India, the United States, Saudi Arabia, the United Arab Emirates, the European Union, France, Germany and Italy, on the margins of the Group of Twenty summit, and the Ministry of External Affairs India-United Arab Emirates readout of 24 June 2024 referred to commencement of work on the corridor; the owners are categorical that a memorandum among eight parties is a framework of intent and that no completed construction or operating segment is officially established, so connectivity diplomacy and connectivity infrastructure must never be conflated.

Answer: B. Explanation: The India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Action Plan for 2024-2028 was adopted at the first India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Ministerial Meeting for Strategic Dialogue at Riyadh on 9 September 2024 and is the anchor current framework for India's strategic dialogue with the Council, while the India-Saudi Arabia Strategic Partnership Council held its second meeting at Jeddah on 22 April 2025, India and Qatar signed an Agreement on Establishment of a Bilateral Strategic Partnership on 18 February 2025, and India-United Arab Emirates relations were elevated to a Comprehensive Strategic Partnership on 25 January 2017; the owners require a dated instrument to be named rather than an undated assertion of strategic partnership, because the date and the forum are what make the claim checkable. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q35. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The Gulf institutional architecture and its dated instruments?

A. The India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor memorandum of understanding was signed in New Delhi on 9 September 2023 by eight parties, namely India, the United States, Saudi Arabia, the United Arab Emirates, the European Union, France, Germany and Italy, on the margins of the Group of Twenty summit, and the Ministry of External Affairs India-United Arab Emirates readout of 24 June 2024 referred to commencement of work on the corridor; the owners are categorical that a memorandum among eight parties is a framework of intent and that no completed construction or operating segment is officially established, so connectivity diplomacy and connectivity infrastructure must never be conflated. B. The Joint Comprehensive Plan of Action was concluded on 14 July 2015 between Iran and the E3 and European Union plus three grouping and was endorsed by United Nations Security Council resolution 2231, after which the United States announced withdrawal on 8 May 2018 and restored sanctions in stages, and the owners give an explicit status caution that the Plan must not be described as normally functioning because, following the E3 snapback action in 2025, the status of restored United Nations measures is disputed by Iran, Russia and China; the examinable consequence is that nuclear diplomacy initially widened the space for energy and connectivity ties while renewed sanctions exposed Indian oil, banking, insurance and project channels to third-country pressure. C. The India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Action Plan for 2024-2028 was adopted at the first India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Ministerial Meeting for Strategic Dialogue at Riyadh on 9 September 2024 and is the anchor current framework for India's strategic dialogue with the Council, while the India-Saudi Arabia Strategic Partnership Council held its second meeting at Jeddah on 22 April 2025, India and Qatar signed an Agreement on Establishment of a Bilateral Strategic Partnership on 18 February 2025, and India-United Arab Emirates relations were elevated to a Comprehensive Strategic Partnership on 25 January 2017; the owners require a dated instrument to be named rather than an undated assertion of strategic partnership, because the date and the forum are what make the claim checkable. D. The Strait of Hormuz is the narrow outlet from the Persian Gulf to the Gulf of Oman and is the principal route-risk chokepoint for Gulf energy shipments, so disruption there can transmit immediately into freight, insurance and supply insecurity for India, and the owners add the qualification that supplier diversification does not eliminate common-route exposure while strategic reserves and alternative energy reduce but do not remove the risk; the wider structural point is that West Asian risk is compounding rather than isolated, because one escalation can threaten energy-supply continuity, diaspora physical safety and connectivity-project viability at the same time.

Answer: C. Explanation: The India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Action Plan for 2024-2028 was adopted at the first India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Ministerial Meeting for Strategic Dialogue at Riyadh on 9 September 2024 and is the anchor current framework for India's strategic dialogue with the Council, while the India-Saudi Arabia Strategic Partnership Council held its second meeting at Jeddah on 22 April 2025, India and Qatar signed an Agreement on Establishment of a Bilateral Strategic Partnership on 18 February 2025, and India-United Arab Emirates relations were elevated to a Comprehensive Strategic Partnership on 25 January 2017; the owners require a dated instrument to be named rather than an undated assertion of strategic partnership, because the date and the forum are what make the claim checkable. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q36. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The Gulf institutional architecture and its dated instruments?

A. The Joint Comprehensive Plan of Action was concluded on 14 July 2015 between Iran and the E3 and European Union plus three grouping and was endorsed by United Nations Security Council resolution 2231, after which the United States announced withdrawal on 8 May 2018 and restored sanctions in stages, and the owners give an explicit status caution that the Plan must not be described as normally functioning because, following the E3 snapback action in 2025, the status of restored United Nations measures is disputed by Iran, Russia and China; the examinable consequence is that nuclear diplomacy initially widened the space for energy and connectivity ties while renewed sanctions exposed Indian oil, banking, insurance and project channels to third-country pressure. B. India ceased Iranian crude purchases after United States Significant Reduction Exceptions ended in May 2019 and substituted other suppliers, which the owners treat as the clearest single demonstration that external policy can directly change India's energy basket; the qualification is equally important, because supplier substitution reduced immediate sanctions exposure but narrowed the Iran relationship and did not reduce aggregate import dependence, so the episode is evidence of vulnerability transmission rather than of successful dependence reduction. C. The Strait of Hormuz is the narrow outlet from the Persian Gulf to the Gulf of Oman and is the principal route-risk chokepoint for Gulf energy shipments, so disruption there can transmit immediately into freight, insurance and supply insecurity for India, and the owners add the qualification that supplier diversification does not eliminate common-route exposure while strategic reserves and alternative energy reduce but do not remove the risk; the wider structural point is that West Asian risk is compounding rather than isolated, because one escalation can threaten energy-supply continuity, diaspora physical safety and connectivity-project viability at the same time. D. The India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Action Plan for 2024-2028 was adopted at the first India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Ministerial Meeting for Strategic Dialogue at Riyadh on 9 September 2024 and is the anchor current framework for India's strategic dialogue with the Council, while the India-Saudi Arabia Strategic Partnership Council held its second meeting at Jeddah on 22 April 2025, India and Qatar signed an Agreement on Establishment of a Bilateral Strategic Partnership on 18 February 2025, and India-United Arab Emirates relations were elevated to a Comprehensive Strategic Partnership on 25 January 2017; the owners require a dated instrument to be named rather than an undated assertion of strategic partnership, because the date and the forum are what make the claim checkable.

Answer: D. Explanation: The India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Action Plan for 2024-2028 was adopted at the first India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Ministerial Meeting for Strategic Dialogue at Riyadh on 9 September 2024 and is the anchor current framework for India's strategic dialogue with the Council, while the India-Saudi Arabia Strategic Partnership Council held its second meeting at Jeddah on 22 April 2025, India and Qatar signed an Agreement on Establishment of a Bilateral Strategic Partnership on 18 February 2025, and India-United Arab Emirates relations were elevated to a Comprehensive Strategic Partnership on 25 January 2017; the owners require a dated instrument to be named rather than an undated assertion of strategic partnership, because the date and the forum are what make the claim checkable. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Trade agreements in the Gulf and their exact force status?

A. The India-United Arab Emirates Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement has been in force since 1 May 2022 and officially reported bilateral trade was approximately one hundred billion United States dollars in the financial year 2024-25, while an India-Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement was signed on 18 December 2025 with entry into force requiring separate verification; the owners keep the tariff and trade-volume mechanics with the Economy owner and retain only the strategic-partnership significance here, and they insist that signature and entry into force are recorded as distinct evidentiary levels. B. The Strait of Hormuz is the narrow outlet from the Persian Gulf to the Gulf of Oman and is the principal route-risk chokepoint for Gulf energy shipments, so disruption there can transmit immediately into freight, insurance and supply insecurity for India, and the owners add the qualification that supplier diversification does not eliminate common-route exposure while strategic reserves and alternative energy reduce but do not remove the risk; the wider structural point is that West Asian risk is compounding rather than isolated, because one escalation can threaten energy-supply continuity, diaspora physical safety and connectivity-project viability at the same time. C. I2U2 groups India, Israel, the United Arab Emirates and the United States in a minilateral cooperation framework spanning food security, water, energy and technology, and it emerged in the environment widened by the Abraham Accords of 2020 which normalised Israel's relations with several Arab states without resolving the Palestinian question; the owners record an honest limitation that answers routinely omit, namely that no four-party I2U2 meeting or outcome in 2024 to 2026 could be verified from official sources and that the India-United States statement of 13 February 2025 recorded only an intention to convene partners, so continuous activity must not be assumed. D. The India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor memorandum of understanding was signed in New Delhi on 9 September 2023 by eight parties, namely India, the United States, Saudi Arabia, the United Arab Emirates, the European Union, France, Germany and Italy, on the margins of the Group of Twenty summit, and the Ministry of External Affairs India-United Arab Emirates readout of 24 June 2024 referred to commencement of work on the corridor; the owners are categorical that a memorandum among eight parties is a framework of intent and that no completed construction or operating segment is officially established, so connectivity diplomacy and connectivity infrastructure must never be conflated.

Answer: A. Explanation: The India-United Arab Emirates Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement has been in force since 1 May 2022 and officially reported bilateral trade was approximately one hundred billion United States dollars in the financial year 2024-25, while an India-Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement was signed on 18 December 2025 with entry into force requiring separate verification; the owners keep the tariff and trade-volume mechanics with the Economy owner and retain only the strategic-partnership significance here, and they insist that signature and entry into force are recorded as distinct evidentiary levels. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q38. Which card should be filed under Trade agreements in the Gulf and their exact force status in an International Relations answer?

A. The India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor memorandum of understanding was signed in New Delhi on 9 September 2023 by eight parties, namely India, the United States, Saudi Arabia, the United Arab Emirates, the European Union, France, Germany and Italy, on the margins of the Group of Twenty summit, and the Ministry of External Affairs India-United Arab Emirates readout of 24 June 2024 referred to commencement of work on the corridor; the owners are categorical that a memorandum among eight parties is a framework of intent and that no completed construction or operating segment is officially established, so connectivity diplomacy and connectivity infrastructure must never be conflated. B. The India-United Arab Emirates Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement has been in force since 1 May 2022 and officially reported bilateral trade was approximately one hundred billion United States dollars in the financial year 2024-25, while an India-Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement was signed on 18 December 2025 with entry into force requiring separate verification; the owners keep the tariff and trade-volume mechanics with the Economy owner and retain only the strategic-partnership significance here, and they insist that signature and entry into force are recorded as distinct evidentiary levels. C. The Strait of Hormuz is the narrow outlet from the Persian Gulf to the Gulf of Oman and is the principal route-risk chokepoint for Gulf energy shipments, so disruption there can transmit immediately into freight, insurance and supply insecurity for India, and the owners add the qualification that supplier diversification does not eliminate common-route exposure while strategic reserves and alternative energy reduce but do not remove the risk; the wider structural point is that West Asian risk is compounding rather than isolated, because one escalation can threaten energy-supply continuity, diaspora physical safety and connectivity-project viability at the same time. D. The Joint Comprehensive Plan of Action was concluded on 14 July 2015 between Iran and the E3 and European Union plus three grouping and was endorsed by United Nations Security Council resolution 2231, after which the United States announced withdrawal on 8 May 2018 and restored sanctions in stages, and the owners give an explicit status caution that the Plan must not be described as normally functioning because, following the E3 snapback action in 2025, the status of restored United Nations measures is disputed by Iran, Russia and China; the examinable consequence is that nuclear diplomacy initially widened the space for energy and connectivity ties while renewed sanctions exposed Indian oil, banking, insurance and project channels to third-country pressure.

Answer: B. Explanation: The India-United Arab Emirates Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement has been in force since 1 May 2022 and officially reported bilateral trade was approximately one hundred billion United States dollars in the financial year 2024-25, while an India-Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement was signed on 18 December 2025 with entry into force requiring separate verification; the owners keep the tariff and trade-volume mechanics with the Economy owner and retain only the strategic-partnership significance here, and they insist that signature and entry into force are recorded as distinct evidentiary levels. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or

analytical categories.

Q39. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Trade agreements in the Gulf and their exact force status?

A. India ceased Iranian crude purchases after United States Significant Reduction Exceptions ended in May 2019 and substituted other suppliers, which the owners treat as the clearest single demonstration that external policy can directly change India's energy basket; the qualification is equally important, because supplier substitution reduced immediate sanctions exposure but narrowed the Iran relationship and did not reduce aggregate import dependence, so the episode is evidence of vulnerability transmission rather than of successful dependence reduction. B. The Strait of Hormuz is the narrow outlet from the Persian Gulf to the Gulf of Oman and is the principal route-risk chokepoint for Gulf energy shipments, so disruption there can transmit immediately into freight, insurance and supply insecurity for India, and the owners add the qualification that supplier diversification does not eliminate common-route exposure while strategic reserves and alternative energy reduce but do not remove the risk; the wider structural point is that West Asian risk is compounding rather than isolated, because one escalation can threaten energy-supply continuity, diaspora physical safety and connectivity-project viability at the same time. C. The India-United Arab Emirates Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement has been in force since 1 May 2022 and officially reported bilateral trade was approximately one hundred billion United States dollars in the financial year 2024-25, while an India-Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement was signed on 18 December 2025 with entry into force requiring separate verification; the owners keep the tariff and trade-volume mechanics with the Economy owner and retain only the strategic-partnership significance here, and they insist that signature and entry into force are recorded as distinct evidentiary levels. D. The Joint Comprehensive Plan of Action was concluded on 14 July 2015 between Iran and the E3 and European Union plus three grouping and was endorsed by United Nations Security Council resolution 2231, after which the United States announced withdrawal on 8 May 2018 and restored sanctions in stages, and the owners give an explicit status caution that the Plan must not be described as normally functioning because, following the E3 snapback action in 2025, the status of restored United Nations measures is disputed by Iran, Russia and China; the examinable consequence is that nuclear diplomacy initially widened the space for energy and connectivity ties while renewed sanctions exposed Indian oil, banking, insurance and project channels to third-country pressure.

Answer: C. Explanation: The India-United Arab Emirates Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement has been in force since 1 May 2022 and officially reported bilateral trade was approximately one hundred billion United States dollars in the financial year 2024-25, while an India-Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement was signed on 18 December 2025 with entry into force requiring separate verification; the owners keep the tariff and trade-volume mechanics with the Economy owner and retain only the strategic-partnership significance here, and they insist that signature and entry into force are recorded as distinct evidentiary levels. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q40. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Trade agreements in the Gulf and their exact force status?

A. The Joint Comprehensive Plan of Action was concluded on 14 July 2015 between Iran and the E3 and European Union plus three grouping and was endorsed by United Nations Security Council resolution 2231, after which the United States announced withdrawal on 8 May 2018 and restored sanctions in stages, and the owners give an explicit status caution that the Plan must not be described as normally functioning because, following the E3 snapback action in 2025, the status of restored United Nations measures is disputed by Iran, Russia and China; the examinable consequence is that nuclear diplomacy initially widened the space for energy and connectivity ties while renewed sanctions exposed Indian oil, banking, insurance and project channels to third-country pressure. B. The United States exception granted in 2018 for Chabahar and Afghanistan-related connectivity was revoked with effect from 29 September 2025, and the ten-year Chabahar contract had been signed on 13 May 2024, so the owners read the sequence as showing both that India may pursue a national-interest carve-out even amid United States-Iran confrontation and that an exception is a reversible foreign executive measure rather than a permanent legal guarantee; the connectivity link serves West Asia and Central Asia simultaneously, and the Central Asian limb of the same instrument is owned by topic 05. C. India ceased Iranian crude purchases after United States Significant Reduction Exceptions ended in May 2019 and substituted other suppliers, which the owners treat as the clearest single demonstration that external policy can directly change India's energy basket; the qualification is equally important, because supplier substitution reduced immediate sanctions exposure but narrowed the Iran relationship and did not reduce aggregate import dependence, so the episode is evidence of vulnerability transmission rather than of successful dependence reduction. D. The India-United Arab Emirates Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement has been in force since 1 May 2022 and officially reported bilateral trade was approximately one hundred billion United States dollars in the financial year 2024-25, while an India-Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement was signed on 18 December 2025 with entry into force requiring separate verification; the owners keep the tariff and trade-volume mechanics with the Economy owner and retain only the strategic-partnership significance here, and they insist that signature and entry into force are recorded as distinct evidentiary levels.

Answer: D. Explanation: The India-United Arab Emirates Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement has been in force since 1 May 2022 and officially reported bilateral trade was approximately one hundred billion United States dollars in the financial year 2024-25, while an India-Oman Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement was signed on 18 December 2025 with entry into force requiring separate verification; the owners keep the tariff and trade-volume mechanics with the Economy owner and retain only the strategic-partnership significance here, and they insist that signature and entry into force are recorded as distinct evidentiary levels. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies I2U2 and the honest limitation on its recent activity?

A. I2U2 groups India, Israel, the United Arab Emirates and the United States in a minilateral cooperation framework spanning food security, water, energy and technology, and it emerged in the environment widened by the Abraham Accords of 2020 which normalised Israel's relations with several Arab states without resolving the Palestinian question; the owners record an honest limitation that answers routinely omit, namely that no four-party I2U2 meeting or outcome in 2024 to 2026 could be verified from official sources and that the India-United States statement of 13 February 2025 recorded only an intention to convene partners, so continuous activity must not be assumed. B. The Joint Comprehensive Plan of Action was concluded on 14 July 2015 between Iran and the E3 and European Union plus three grouping and was endorsed by United Nations Security Council resolution 2231, after which the United States announced withdrawal on 8 May 2018 and restored sanctions in stages, and the owners give an explicit status caution that the Plan must not be described as normally functioning because, following the E3 snapback action in 2025, the status of restored United Nations measures is disputed by Iran, Russia and China; the examinable consequence is that nuclear diplomacy initially widened the space for energy and connectivity ties while renewed sanctions exposed Indian oil, banking, insurance and project channels to third-country pressure. C. The Strait of Hormuz is the narrow outlet from the Persian Gulf to the Gulf of Oman and is the principal route-risk chokepoint for Gulf energy shipments, so disruption there can transmit immediately into freight, insurance and supply insecurity for India, and the owners add the qualification that supplier diversification does not eliminate common-route exposure while strategic reserves and alternative energy reduce but do not remove the risk; the wider structural point is that West Asian risk is compounding rather than isolated, because one escalation can threaten energy-supply continuity, diaspora physical safety and connectivity-project viability at the same time. D. The India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor memorandum of understanding was signed in New Delhi on 9 September 2023 by eight parties, namely India, the United States, Saudi Arabia, the United Arab Emirates, the European Union, France, Germany and Italy, on the margins of the Group of Twenty summit, and the Ministry of External Affairs India-United Arab Emirates readout of 24 June 2024 referred to commencement of work on the corridor; the owners are categorical that a memorandum among eight parties is a framework of intent and that no completed construction or operating segment is officially established, so connectivity diplomacy and connectivity infrastructure must never be conflated.

Answer: A. Explanation: I2U2 groups India, Israel, the United Arab Emirates and the United States in a minilateral cooperation framework spanning food security, water, energy and technology, and it emerged in the environment widened by the Abraham Accords of 2020 which normalised Israel's relations with several Arab states without resolving the Palestinian question; the owners record an honest limitation that answers routinely omit, namely that no four-party I2U2 meeting or outcome in 2024 to 2026 could be verified from official sources and that the India-United States statement of 13 February 2025 recorded only an intention to convene partners, so continuous activity must not be assumed. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q42. Which card should be filed under I2U2 and the honest limitation on its recent activity in an International Relations answer?

A. The Strait of Hormuz is the narrow outlet from the Persian Gulf to the Gulf of Oman and is the principal route-risk chokepoint for Gulf energy shipments, so disruption there can transmit immediately into freight, insurance and supply insecurity for India, and the owners add the qualification that supplier diversification does not eliminate common-route exposure while strategic reserves and alternative energy reduce but do not remove the risk; the wider structural point is that West Asian risk is compounding rather than isolated, because one escalation can threaten energy-supply continuity, diaspora physical safety and connectivity-project viability at the same time. B. I2U2 groups India, Israel, the United Arab Emirates and the United States in a minilateral cooperation framework spanning food security, water, energy and technology, and it emerged in the environment widened by the Abraham Accords of 2020 which normalised Israel's relations with several Arab states without resolving the Palestinian question; the owners record an honest limitation that answers routinely omit, namely that no four-party I2U2 meeting or outcome in 2024 to 2026 could be verified from official sources and that the India-United States statement of 13 February 2025 recorded only an intention to convene partners, so continuous activity must not be assumed. C. The Joint Comprehensive Plan of Action was concluded on 14 July 2015 between Iran and the E3 and European Union plus three grouping and was endorsed by United Nations Security Council resolution 2231, after which the United States announced withdrawal on 8 May 2018 and restored sanctions in stages, and the owners give an explicit status caution that the Plan must not be described as normally functioning because, following the E3 snapback action in 2025, the status of restored United Nations measures is disputed by Iran, Russia and China; the examinable consequence is that nuclear diplomacy initially widened the space for energy and connectivity ties while renewed sanctions exposed Indian oil, banking, insurance and project channels to third-country pressure. D. India ceased Iranian crude purchases after United States Significant Reduction Exceptions ended in May 2019 and substituted other suppliers, which the owners treat as the clearest single demonstration that external policy can directly change India's energy basket; the qualification is equally important, because supplier substitution reduced immediate sanctions exposure but narrowed the Iran relationship and did not reduce aggregate import dependence, so the episode is evidence of vulnerability transmission rather than of successful dependence reduction.

Answer: B. Explanation: I2U2 groups India, Israel, the United Arab Emirates and the United States in a minilateral cooperation framework spanning food security, water, energy and technology, and it emerged in the environment widened by the Abraham Accords of 2020 which normalised Israel's relations with several Arab states without resolving the Palestinian question; the owners record an honest limitation that answers routinely omit, namely that no four-party I2U2 meeting or outcome in 2024 to 2026 could be verified from official sources and that the India-United States statement of 13 February 2025 recorded only an intention to convene partners, so continuous activity must not be assumed. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q43. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of I2U2 and the honest limitation on its recent activity?

A. The United States exception granted in 2018 for Chabahar and Afghanistan-related connectivity was revoked with effect from 29 September 2025, and the ten-year Chabahar contract had been signed on 13 May 2024, so the owners read the sequence as showing both that India may pursue a national-interest carve-out even amid United States-Iran confrontation and that an exception is a reversible foreign executive measure rather than a permanent legal guarantee; the connectivity link serves West Asia and Central Asia simultaneously, and the Central Asian limb of the same instrument is owned by topic 05. B. The Joint Comprehensive Plan of Action was concluded on 14 July 2015 between Iran and the E3 and European Union plus three grouping and was endorsed by United Nations Security Council resolution 2231, after which the United States announced withdrawal on 8 May 2018 and restored sanctions in stages, and the owners give an explicit status caution that the Plan must not be described as normally functioning because, following the E3 snapback action in 2025, the status of restored United Nations measures is disputed by Iran, Russia and China; the examinable consequence is that nuclear diplomacy initially widened the space for energy and connectivity ties while renewed sanctions exposed Indian oil, banking, insurance and project channels to third-country pressure. C. I2U2 groups India, Israel, the United Arab Emirates and the United States in a minilateral cooperation framework spanning food security, water, energy and technology, and it emerged in the environment widened by the Abraham Accords of 2020 which normalised Israel's relations with several Arab states without resolving the Palestinian question; the owners record an honest limitation that answers routinely omit, namely that no four-party I2U2 meeting or outcome in 2024 to 2026 could be verified from official sources and that the India-United States statement of 13 February 2025 recorded only an intention to convene partners, so continuous activity must not be assumed. D. India ceased Iranian crude purchases after United States Significant Reduction Exceptions ended in May 2019 and substituted other suppliers, which the owners treat as the clearest single demonstration that external policy can directly change India's energy basket; the qualification is equally important, because supplier substitution reduced immediate sanctions exposure but narrowed the Iran relationship and did not reduce aggregate import dependence, so the episode is evidence of vulnerability transmission rather than of successful dependence reduction.

Answer: C. Explanation: I2U2 groups India, Israel, the United Arab Emirates and the United States in a minilateral cooperation framework spanning food security, water, energy and technology, and it emerged in the environment widened by the Abraham Accords of 2020 which normalised Israel's relations with several Arab states without resolving the Palestinian question; the owners record an honest limitation that answers routinely omit, namely that no four-party I2U2 meeting or outcome in 2024 to 2026 could be verified from official sources and that the India-United States statement of 13 February 2025 recorded only an intention to convene partners, so continuous activity must not be assumed. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q44. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about I2U2 and the honest limitation on its recent activity?

A. India ceased Iranian crude purchases after United States Significant Reduction Exceptions ended in May 2019 and substituted other suppliers, which the owners treat as the clearest single demonstration that external policy can directly change India's energy basket; the qualification is equally important, because supplier substitution reduced immediate sanctions exposure but narrowed the Iran relationship and did not reduce aggregate import dependence, so the episode is evidence of vulnerability transmission rather than of successful dependence reduction. B. The United States exception granted in 2018 for Chabahar and Afghanistan-related connectivity was revoked with effect from 29 September 2025, and the ten-year Chabahar contract had been signed on 13 May 2024, so the owners read the sequence as showing both that India may pursue a national-interest carve-out even amid United States-Iran confrontation and that an exception is a reversible foreign executive measure rather than a permanent legal guarantee; the connectivity link serves West Asia and Central Asia simultaneously, and the Central Asian limb of the same instrument is owned by topic 05. C. Operation Sindhu evacuated four thousand four hundred and fifteen Indian nationals from Iran and Israel by 27 June 2025, comprising three thousand five hundred and ninety-seven from Iran and eight hundred and eighteen from Israel, which the owners treat as the concrete dated demonstration that West Asia policy carries a standing consular-protection obligation rather than a hypothetical risk; the boundary is stated in the same place, because the operational relief and logistics cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owner while the host-government negotiation and consular diplomacy that enable an evacuation belong to this folder and to topic 09. D. I2U2 groups India, Israel, the United Arab Emirates and the United States in a minilateral cooperation framework spanning food security, water, energy and technology, and it emerged in the environment widened by the Abraham Accords of 2020 which normalised Israel's relations with several Arab states without resolving the Palestinian question; the owners record an honest limitation that answers routinely omit, namely that no four-party I2U2 meeting or outcome in 2024 to 2026 could be verified from official sources and that the India-United States statement of 13 February 2025 recorded only an intention to convene partners, so continuous activity must not be assumed.

Answer: D. Explanation: I2U2 groups India, Israel, the United Arab Emirates and the United States in a minilateral cooperation framework spanning food security, water, energy and technology, and it emerged in the environment widened by the Abraham Accords of 2020 which normalised Israel's relations with several Arab states without resolving the Palestinian question; the owners record an honest limitation that answers routinely omit, namely that no four-party I2U2 meeting or outcome in 2024 to 2026 could be verified from official sources and that the India-United States statement of 13 February 2025 recorded only an intention to convene partners, so continuous activity must not be assumed. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies The corridor memorandum and the difference between intent and infrastructure?

A. The India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor memorandum of understanding was signed in New Delhi on 9 September 2023 by eight parties, namely India, the United States, Saudi Arabia, the United Arab Emirates, the European Union, France, Germany and Italy, on the margins of the Group of Twenty summit, and the Ministry of External Affairs India-United Arab Emirates readout of 24 June 2024 referred to commencement of work on the corridor; the owners are categorical that a memorandum among eight parties is a framework of intent and that no completed construction or operating segment is officially established, so connectivity diplomacy and connectivity infrastructure must never be conflated. B. India ceased Iranian crude purchases after United States Significant Reduction Exceptions ended in May 2019 and substituted other suppliers, which the owners treat as the clearest single demonstration that external policy can directly change India's energy basket; the qualification is equally important, because supplier substitution reduced immediate sanctions exposure but narrowed the Iran relationship and did not reduce aggregate import dependence, so the episode is evidence of vulnerability transmission rather than of successful dependence reduction. C. The Strait of Hormuz is the narrow outlet from the Persian Gulf to the Gulf of Oman and is the principal route-risk chokepoint for Gulf energy shipments, so disruption there can transmit immediately into freight, insurance and supply insecurity for India, and the owners add the qualification that supplier diversification does not eliminate common-route exposure while strategic reserves and alternative energy reduce but do not remove the risk; the wider structural point is that West Asian risk is compounding rather than isolated, because one escalation can threaten energy-supply continuity, diaspora physical safety and connectivity-project viability at the same time. D. The Joint Comprehensive Plan of Action was concluded on 14 July 2015 between Iran and the E3 and European Union plus three grouping and was endorsed by United Nations Security Council resolution 2231, after which the United States announced withdrawal on 8 May 2018 and restored sanctions in stages, and the owners give an explicit status caution that the Plan must not be described as normally functioning because, following the E3 snapback action in 2025, the status of restored United Nations measures is disputed by Iran, Russia and China; the examinable consequence is that nuclear diplomacy initially widened the space for energy and connectivity ties while renewed sanctions exposed Indian oil, banking, insurance and project channels to third-country pressure.

Answer: A. Explanation: The India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor memorandum of understanding was signed in New Delhi on 9 September 2023 by eight parties, namely India, the United States, Saudi Arabia, the United Arab Emirates, the European Union, France, Germany and Italy, on the margins of the Group of Twenty summit, and the Ministry of External Affairs India-United Arab Emirates readout of 24 June 2024 referred to commencement of work on the corridor; the owners are categorical that a memorandum among eight parties is a framework of intent and that no completed construction or operating segment is officially established, so connectivity diplomacy and connectivity infrastructure must never be conflated. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q46. Which card should be filed under The corridor memorandum and the difference between intent and infrastructure in an International Relations answer?

A. The Joint Comprehensive Plan of Action was concluded on 14 July 2015 between Iran and the E3 and European Union plus three grouping and was endorsed by United Nations Security Council resolution 2231, after which the United States announced withdrawal on 8 May 2018 and restored sanctions in stages, and the owners give an explicit status caution that the Plan must not be described as normally functioning because, following the E3 snapback action in 2025, the status of restored United Nations measures is disputed by Iran, Russia and China; the examinable consequence is that nuclear diplomacy initially widened the space for energy and connectivity ties while renewed sanctions exposed Indian oil, banking, insurance and project channels to third-country pressure. B. The India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor memorandum of understanding was signed in New Delhi on 9 September 2023 by eight parties, namely India, the United States, Saudi Arabia, the United Arab Emirates, the European Union, France, Germany and Italy, on the margins of the Group of Twenty summit, and the Ministry of External Affairs India-United Arab Emirates readout of 24 June 2024 referred to commencement of work on the corridor; the owners are categorical that a memorandum among eight parties is a framework of intent and that no completed construction or operating segment is officially established, so connectivity diplomacy and connectivity infrastructure must never be conflated. C. India ceased Iranian crude purchases after United States Significant Reduction Exceptions ended in May 2019 and substituted other suppliers, which the owners treat as the clearest single demonstration that external policy can directly change India's energy basket; the qualification is equally important, because supplier substitution reduced immediate sanctions exposure but narrowed the Iran relationship and did not reduce aggregate import dependence, so the episode is evidence of vulnerability transmission rather than of successful dependence reduction. D. The United States exception granted in 2018 for Chabahar and Afghanistan-related connectivity was revoked with effect from 29 September 2025, and the ten-year Chabahar contract had been signed on 13 May 2024, so the owners read the sequence as showing both that India may pursue a national-interest carve-out even amid United States-Iran confrontation and that an exception is a reversible foreign executive measure rather than a permanent legal guarantee; the connectivity link serves West Asia and Central Asia simultaneously, and the Central Asian limb of the same instrument is owned by topic 05.

Answer: B. Explanation: The India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor memorandum of understanding was signed in New Delhi on 9 September 2023 by eight parties, namely India, the United States, Saudi Arabia, the United Arab Emirates, the European Union, France, Germany and Italy, on the margins of the Group of Twenty summit, and the Ministry of External Affairs India-United Arab Emirates readout of 24 June 2024 referred to commencement of work on the corridor; the owners are categorical that a memorandum among eight parties is a framework of intent and that no completed construction or operating segment is officially established, so connectivity diplomacy and connectivity infrastructure must never be conflated. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q47. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The corridor memorandum and the difference between intent and infrastructure?

A. India ceased Iranian crude purchases after United States Significant Reduction Exceptions ended in May 2019 and substituted other suppliers, which the owners treat as the clearest single demonstration that external policy can directly change India's energy basket; the qualification is equally important, because supplier substitution reduced immediate sanctions exposure but narrowed the Iran relationship and did not reduce aggregate import dependence, so the episode is evidence of vulnerability transmission rather than of successful dependence reduction. B. The United States exception granted in 2018 for Chabahar and Afghanistan-related connectivity was revoked with effect from 29 September 2025, and the ten-year Chabahar contract had been signed on 13 May 2024, so the owners read the sequence as showing both that India may pursue a national-interest carve-out even amid United States-Iran confrontation and that an exception is a reversible foreign executive measure rather than a permanent legal guarantee; the connectivity link serves West Asia and Central Asia simultaneously, and the Central Asian limb of the same instrument is owned by topic 05. C. The India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor memorandum of understanding was signed in New Delhi on 9 September 2023 by eight parties, namely India, the United States, Saudi Arabia, the United Arab Emirates, the European Union, France, Germany and Italy, on the margins of the Group of Twenty summit, and the Ministry of External Affairs India-United Arab Emirates readout of 24 June 2024 referred to commencement of work on the corridor; the owners are categorical that a memorandum among eight parties is a framework of intent and that no completed construction or operating segment is officially established, so connectivity diplomacy and connectivity infrastructure must never be conflated. D. Operation Sindhu evacuated four thousand four hundred and fifteen Indian nationals from Iran and Israel by 27 June 2025, comprising three thousand five hundred and ninety-seven from Iran and eight hundred and eighteen from Israel, which the owners treat as the concrete dated demonstration that West Asia policy carries a standing consular-protection obligation rather than a hypothetical risk; the boundary is stated in the same place, because the operational relief and logistics cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owner while the host-government negotiation and consular diplomacy that enable an evacuation belong to this folder and to topic 09.

Answer: C. Explanation: The India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor memorandum of understanding was signed in New Delhi on 9 September 2023 by eight parties, namely India, the United States, Saudi Arabia, the United Arab Emirates, the European Union, France, Germany and Italy, on the margins of the Group of Twenty summit, and the Ministry of External Affairs India-United Arab Emirates readout of 24 June 2024 referred to commencement of work on the corridor; the owners are categorical that a memorandum among eight parties is a framework of intent and that no completed construction or operating segment is officially established, so connectivity diplomacy and connectivity infrastructure must never be conflated. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q48. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The corridor memorandum and the difference between intent and infrastructure?

A. The United States exception granted in 2018 for Chabahar and Afghanistan-related connectivity was revoked with effect from 29 September 2025, and the ten-year Chabahar contract had been signed on 13 May 2024, so the owners read the sequence as showing both that India may pursue a national-interest carve-out even amid United States-Iran confrontation and that an exception is a reversible foreign executive measure rather than a permanent legal guarantee; the connectivity link serves West Asia and Central Asia simultaneously, and the Central Asian limb of the same instrument is owned by topic 05. B. Operation Sindhu evacuated four thousand four hundred and fifteen Indian nationals from Iran and Israel by 27 June 2025, comprising three thousand five hundred and ninety-seven from Iran and eight hundred and eighteen from Israel, which the owners treat as the concrete dated demonstration that West Asia policy carries a standing consular-protection obligation rather than a hypothetical risk; the boundary is stated in the same place, because the operational relief and logistics cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owner while the host-government negotiation and consular diplomacy that enable an evacuation belong to this folder and to topic 09. C. India recognised the State of Palestine in 1988 and continues to support a negotiated, sovereign, viable two-state solution alongside Israel, and after the October 2023 conflict began India condemned terrorism, called for humanitarian protection, release of hostages, dialogue and a two-state settlement while continuing relations with Israel and assistance to Palestinians; the owners require this to be presented as a single coherent position rather than as a contradiction, and they add the analytical warning that the conflict tests the corridor and minilateral frameworks by raising political, security and route-risk costs, so announced corridors and minilaterals must not be treated as insulated from regional war. D. The India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor memorandum of understanding was signed in New Delhi on 9 September 2023 by eight parties, namely India, the United States, Saudi Arabia, the United Arab Emirates, the European Union, France, Germany and Italy, on the margins of the Group of Twenty summit, and the Ministry of External Affairs India-United Arab Emirates readout of 24 June 2024 referred to commencement of work on the corridor; the owners are categorical that a memorandum among eight parties is a framework of intent and that no completed construction or operating segment is officially established, so connectivity diplomacy and connectivity infrastructure must never be conflated.

Answer: D. Explanation: The India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor memorandum of understanding was signed in New Delhi on 9 September 2023 by eight parties, namely India, the United States, Saudi Arabia, the United Arab Emirates, the European Union, France, Germany and Italy, on the margins of the Group of Twenty summit, and the Ministry of External Affairs India-United Arab Emirates readout of 24 June 2024 referred to commencement of work on the corridor; the owners are categorical that a memorandum among eight parties is a framework of intent and that no completed construction or operating segment is officially established, so connectivity diplomacy and connectivity infrastructure must never be conflated. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies The Strait of Hormuz and compounding route risk?

A. The Strait of Hormuz is the narrow outlet from the Persian Gulf to the Gulf of Oman and is the principal route-risk chokepoint for Gulf energy shipments, so disruption there can transmit immediately into freight, insurance and supply insecurity for India, and the owners add the qualification that supplier diversification does not eliminate common-route exposure while strategic reserves and alternative energy reduce but do not remove the risk; the wider structural point is that West Asian risk is compounding rather than isolated, because one escalation can threaten energy-supply continuity, diaspora physical safety and connectivity-project viability at the same time. B. The Joint Comprehensive Plan of Action was concluded on 14 July 2015 between Iran and the E3 and European Union plus three grouping and was endorsed by United Nations Security Council resolution 2231, after which the United States announced withdrawal on 8 May 2018 and restored sanctions in stages, and the owners give an explicit status caution that the Plan must not be described as normally functioning because, following the E3 snapback action in 2025, the status of restored United Nations measures is disputed by Iran, Russia and China; the examinable consequence is that nuclear diplomacy initially widened the space for energy and connectivity ties while renewed sanctions exposed Indian oil, banking, insurance and project channels to third-country pressure. C. India ceased Iranian crude purchases after United States Significant Reduction Exceptions ended in May 2019 and substituted other suppliers, which the owners treat as the clearest single demonstration that external policy can directly change India's energy basket; the qualification is equally important, because supplier substitution reduced immediate sanctions exposure but narrowed the Iran relationship and did not reduce aggregate import dependence, so the episode is evidence of vulnerability transmission rather than of successful dependence reduction. D. The United States exception granted in 2018 for Chabahar and Afghanistan-related connectivity was revoked with effect from 29 September 2025, and the ten-year Chabahar contract had been signed on 13 May 2024, so the owners read the sequence as showing both that India may pursue a national-interest carve-out even amid United States-Iran confrontation and that an exception is a reversible foreign executive measure rather than a permanent legal guarantee; the connectivity link serves West Asia and Central Asia simultaneously, and the Central Asian limb of the same instrument is owned by topic 05.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Strait of Hormuz is the narrow outlet from the Persian Gulf to the Gulf of Oman and is the principal route-risk chokepoint for Gulf energy shipments, so disruption there can transmit immediately into freight, insurance and supply insecurity for India, and the owners add the qualification that supplier diversification does not eliminate common-route exposure while strategic reserves and alternative energy reduce but do not remove the risk; the wider structural point is that West Asian risk is compounding rather than isolated, because one escalation can threaten energy-supply continuity, diaspora physical safety and connectivity-project viability at the same time. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q50. Which card should be filed under The Strait of Hormuz and compounding route risk in an International Relations answer?

A. India ceased Iranian crude purchases after United States Significant Reduction Exceptions ended in May 2019 and substituted other suppliers, which the owners treat as the clearest single demonstration that external policy can directly change India's energy basket; the qualification is equally important, because supplier substitution reduced immediate sanctions exposure but narrowed the Iran relationship and did not reduce aggregate import dependence, so the episode is evidence of vulnerability transmission rather than of successful dependence reduction. B. The Strait of Hormuz is the narrow outlet from the Persian Gulf to the Gulf of Oman and is the principal route-risk chokepoint for Gulf energy shipments, so disruption there can transmit immediately into freight, insurance and supply insecurity for India, and the owners add the qualification that supplier diversification does not eliminate common-route exposure while strategic reserves and alternative energy reduce but do not remove the risk; the wider structural point is that West Asian risk is compounding rather than isolated, because one escalation can threaten energy-supply continuity, diaspora physical safety and connectivity-project viability at the same time. C. The United States exception granted in 2018 for Chabahar and Afghanistan-related connectivity was revoked with effect from 29 September 2025, and the ten-year Chabahar contract had been signed on 13 May 2024, so the owners read the sequence as showing both that India may pursue a national-interest carve-out even amid United States-Iran confrontation and that an exception is a reversible foreign executive measure rather than a permanent legal guarantee; the connectivity link serves West Asia and Central Asia simultaneously, and the Central Asian limb of the same instrument is owned by topic 05. D. Operation Sindhu evacuated four thousand four hundred and fifteen Indian nationals from Iran and Israel by 27 June 2025, comprising three thousand five hundred and ninety-seven from Iran and eight hundred and eighteen from Israel, which the owners treat as the concrete dated demonstration that West Asia policy carries a standing consular-protection obligation rather than a hypothetical risk; the boundary is stated in the same place, because the operational relief and logistics cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owner while the host-government negotiation and consular diplomacy that enable an evacuation belong to this folder and to topic 09.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Strait of Hormuz is the narrow outlet from the Persian Gulf to the Gulf of Oman and is the principal route-risk chokepoint for Gulf energy shipments, so disruption there can transmit immediately into freight, insurance and supply insecurity for India, and the owners add the qualification that supplier diversification does not eliminate common-route exposure while strategic reserves and alternative energy reduce but do not remove the risk; the wider structural point is that West Asian risk is compounding rather than isolated, because one escalation can threaten energy-supply continuity, diaspora physical safety and connectivity-project viability at the same time. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q51. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The Strait of Hormuz and compounding route risk?

A. Operation Sindhu evacuated four thousand four hundred and fifteen Indian nationals from Iran and Israel by 27 June 2025, comprising three thousand five hundred and ninety-seven from Iran and eight hundred and eighteen from Israel, which the owners treat as the concrete dated demonstration that West Asia policy carries a standing consular-protection obligation rather than a hypothetical risk; the boundary is stated in the same place, because the operational relief and logistics cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owner while the host-government negotiation and consular diplomacy that enable an evacuation belong to this folder and to topic 09. B. India recognised the State of Palestine in 1988 and continues to support a negotiated, sovereign, viable two-state solution alongside Israel, and after the October 2023 conflict began India condemned terrorism, called for humanitarian protection, release of hostages, dialogue and a two-state settlement while continuing relations with Israel and assistance to Palestinians; the owners require this to be presented as a single coherent position rather than as a contradiction, and they add the analytical warning that the conflict tests the corridor and minilateral frameworks by raising political, security and route-risk costs, so announced corridors and minilaterals must not be treated as insulated from regional war. C. The Strait of Hormuz is the narrow outlet from the Persian Gulf to the Gulf of Oman and is the principal route-risk chokepoint for Gulf energy shipments, so disruption there can transmit immediately into freight, insurance and supply insecurity for India, and the owners add the qualification that supplier diversification does not eliminate common-route exposure while strategic reserves and alternative energy reduce but do not remove the risk; the wider structural point is that West Asian risk is compounding rather than isolated, because one escalation can threaten energy-supply continuity, diaspora physical safety and connectivity-project viability at the same time. D. The United States exception granted in 2018 for Chabahar and Afghanistan-related connectivity was revoked with effect from 29 September 2025, and the ten-year Chabahar contract had been signed on 13 May 2024, so the owners read the sequence as showing both that India may pursue a national-interest carve-out even amid United States-Iran confrontation and that an exception is a reversible foreign executive measure rather than a permanent legal guarantee; the connectivity link serves West Asia and Central Asia simultaneously, and the Central Asian limb of the same instrument is owned by topic 05.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Strait of Hormuz is the narrow outlet from the Persian Gulf to the Gulf of Oman and is the principal route-risk chokepoint for Gulf energy shipments, so disruption there can transmit immediately into freight, insurance and supply insecurity for India, and the owners add the qualification that supplier diversification does not eliminate common-route exposure while strategic reserves and alternative energy reduce but do not remove the risk; the wider structural point is that West Asian risk is compounding rather than isolated, because one escalation can threaten energy-supply continuity, diaspora physical safety and connectivity-project viability at the same time. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q52. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The Strait of Hormuz and compounding route risk?

A. India recognised the State of Palestine in 1988 and continues to support a negotiated, sovereign, viable two-state solution alongside Israel, and after the October 2023 conflict began India condemned terrorism, called for humanitarian protection, release of hostages, dialogue and a two-state settlement while continuing relations with Israel and assistance to Palestinians; the owners require this to be presented as a single coherent position rather than as a contradiction, and they add the analytical warning that the conflict tests the corridor and minilateral frameworks by raising political, security and route-risk costs, so announced corridors and minilaterals must not be treated as insulated from regional war. B. The owners argue that India's West Asia policy is best evaluated through the energy trilemma of security, affordability and sustainability rather than through energy security alone, because supplier diversification, diaspora exposure and connectivity-framework design are all shaped by the same trade-offs between reliable supply, cost and long-term transition pressure; the practical consequence for a Mains answer is that a purely security-based frame misses affordability and transition considerations that can conflict with each other, and that triangular relationship management across the Gulf, Israel and Iran requires continuous diplomatic effort rather than a one-time policy declaration. C. Operation Sindhu evacuated four thousand four hundred and fifteen Indian nationals from Iran and Israel by 27 June 2025, comprising three thousand five hundred and ninety-seven from Iran and eight hundred and eighteen from Israel, which the owners treat as the concrete dated demonstration that West Asia policy carries a standing consular-protection obligation rather than a hypothetical risk; the boundary is stated in the same place, because the operational relief and logistics cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owner while the host-government negotiation and consular diplomacy that enable an evacuation belong to this folder and to topic 09. D. The Strait of Hormuz is the narrow outlet from the Persian Gulf to the Gulf of Oman and is the principal route-risk chokepoint for Gulf energy shipments, so disruption there can transmit immediately into freight, insurance and supply insecurity for India, and the owners add the qualification that supplier diversification does not eliminate common-route exposure while strategic reserves and alternative energy reduce but do not remove the risk; the wider structural point is that West Asian risk is compounding rather than isolated, because one escalation can threaten energy-supply continuity, diaspora physical safety and connectivity-project viability at the same time.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Strait of Hormuz is the narrow outlet from the Persian Gulf to the Gulf of Oman and is the principal route-risk chokepoint for Gulf energy shipments, so disruption there can transmit immediately into freight, insurance and supply insecurity for India, and the owners add the qualification that supplier diversification does not eliminate common-route exposure while strategic reserves and alternative energy reduce but do not remove the risk; the wider structural point is that West Asian risk is compounding rather than isolated, because one escalation can threaten energy-supply continuity, diaspora physical safety and connectivity-project viability at the same time. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies The nuclear-diplomacy instrument and its disputed present status?

A. The Joint Comprehensive Plan of Action was concluded on 14 July 2015 between Iran and the E3 and European Union plus three grouping and was endorsed by United Nations Security Council resolution 2231, after which the United States announced withdrawal on 8 May 2018 and restored sanctions in stages, and the owners give an explicit status caution that the Plan must not be described as normally functioning because, following the E3 snapback action in 2025, the status of restored United Nations measures is disputed by Iran, Russia and China; the examinable consequence is that nuclear diplomacy initially widened the space for energy and connectivity ties while renewed sanctions exposed Indian oil, banking, insurance and project channels to third-country pressure. B. Operation Sindhu evacuated four thousand four hundred and fifteen Indian nationals from Iran and Israel by 27 June 2025, comprising three thousand five hundred and ninety-seven from Iran and eight hundred and eighteen from Israel, which the owners treat as the concrete dated demonstration that West Asia policy carries a standing consular-protection obligation rather than a hypothetical risk; the boundary is stated in the same place, because the operational relief and logistics cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owner while the host-government negotiation and consular diplomacy that enable an evacuation belong to this folder and to topic 09. C. India ceased Iranian crude purchases after United States Significant Reduction Exceptions ended in May 2019 and substituted other suppliers, which the owners treat as the clearest single demonstration that external policy can directly change India's energy basket; the qualification is equally important, because supplier substitution reduced immediate sanctions exposure but narrowed the Iran relationship and did not reduce aggregate import dependence, so the episode is evidence of vulnerability transmission rather than of successful dependence reduction. D. The United States exception granted in 2018 for Chabahar and Afghanistan-related connectivity was revoked with effect from 29 September 2025, and the ten-year Chabahar contract had been signed on 13 May 2024, so the owners read the sequence as showing both that India may pursue a national-interest carve-out even amid United States-Iran confrontation and that an exception is a reversible foreign executive measure rather than a permanent legal guarantee; the connectivity link serves West Asia and Central Asia simultaneously, and the Central Asian limb of the same instrument is owned by topic 05.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Joint Comprehensive Plan of Action was concluded on 14 July 2015 between Iran and the E3 and European Union plus three grouping and was endorsed by United Nations Security Council resolution 2231, after which the United States announced withdrawal on 8 May 2018 and restored sanctions in stages, and the owners give an explicit status caution that the Plan must not be described as normally functioning because, following the E3 snapback action in 2025, the status of restored United Nations measures is disputed by Iran, Russia and China; the examinable consequence is that nuclear diplomacy initially widened the space for energy and connectivity ties while renewed sanctions exposed Indian oil, banking, insurance and project channels to third-country pressure. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q54. Which card should be filed under The nuclear-diplomacy instrument and its disputed present status in an International Relations answer?

A. Operation Sindhu evacuated four thousand four hundred and fifteen Indian nationals from Iran and Israel by 27 June 2025, comprising three thousand five hundred and ninety-seven from Iran and eight hundred and eighteen from Israel, which the owners treat as the concrete dated demonstration that West Asia policy carries a standing consular-protection obligation rather than a hypothetical risk; the boundary is stated in the same place, because the operational relief and logistics cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owner while the host-government negotiation and consular diplomacy that enable an evacuation belong to this folder and to topic 09. B. The Joint Comprehensive Plan of Action was concluded on 14 July 2015 between Iran and the E3 and European Union plus three grouping and was endorsed by United Nations Security Council resolution 2231, after which the United States announced withdrawal on 8 May 2018 and restored sanctions in stages, and the owners give an explicit status caution that the Plan must not be described as normally functioning because, following the E3 snapback action in 2025, the status of restored United Nations measures is disputed by Iran, Russia and China; the examinable consequence is that nuclear diplomacy initially widened the space for energy and connectivity ties while renewed sanctions exposed Indian oil, banking, insurance and project channels to third-country pressure. C. India recognised the State of Palestine in 1988 and continues to support a negotiated, sovereign, viable two-state solution alongside Israel, and after the October 2023 conflict began India condemned terrorism, called for humanitarian protection, release of hostages, dialogue and a two-state settlement while continuing relations with Israel and assistance to Palestinians; the owners require this to be presented as a single coherent position rather than as a contradiction, and they add the analytical warning that the conflict tests the corridor and minilateral frameworks by raising political, security and route-risk costs, so announced corridors and minilaterals must not be treated as insulated from regional war. D. The United States exception granted in 2018 for Chabahar and Afghanistan-related connectivity was revoked with effect from 29 September 2025, and the ten-year Chabahar contract had been signed on 13 May 2024, so the owners read the sequence as showing both that India may pursue a national-interest carve-out even amid United States-Iran confrontation and that an exception is a reversible foreign executive measure rather than a permanent legal guarantee; the connectivity link serves West Asia and Central Asia simultaneously, and the Central Asian limb of the same instrument is owned by topic 05.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Joint Comprehensive Plan of Action was concluded on 14 July 2015 between Iran and the E3 and European Union plus three grouping and was endorsed by United Nations Security Council resolution 2231, after which the United States announced withdrawal on 8 May 2018 and restored sanctions in stages, and the owners give an explicit status caution that the Plan must not be described as normally functioning because, following the E3 snapback action in 2025, the status of restored United Nations measures is disputed by Iran, Russia and China; the examinable consequence is that nuclear diplomacy initially widened the space for energy and connectivity ties while renewed sanctions exposed Indian oil, banking, insurance and project channels to third-country pressure. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q55. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The nuclear-diplomacy instrument and its disputed present status?

A. Operation Sindhu evacuated four thousand four hundred and fifteen Indian nationals from Iran and Israel by 27 June 2025, comprising three thousand five hundred and ninety-seven from Iran and eight hundred and eighteen from Israel, which the owners treat as the concrete dated demonstration that West Asia policy carries a standing consular-protection obligation rather than a hypothetical risk; the boundary is stated in the same place, because the operational relief and logistics cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owner while the host-government negotiation and consular diplomacy that enable an evacuation belong to this folder and to topic 09. B. India recognised the State of Palestine in 1988 and continues to support a negotiated, sovereign, viable two-state solution alongside Israel, and after the October 2023 conflict began India condemned terrorism, called for humanitarian protection, release of hostages, dialogue and a two-state settlement while continuing relations with Israel and assistance to Palestinians; the owners require this to be presented as a single coherent position rather than as a contradiction, and they add the analytical warning that the conflict tests the corridor and minilateral frameworks by raising political, security and route-risk costs, so announced corridors and minilaterals must not be treated as insulated from regional war. C. The Joint Comprehensive Plan of Action was concluded on 14 July 2015 between Iran and the E3 and European Union plus three grouping and was endorsed by United Nations Security Council resolution

2231, after which the United States announced withdrawal on 8 May 2018 and restored sanctions in stages, and the owners give an explicit status caution that the Plan must not be described as normally functioning because, following the E3 snapback action in 2025, the status of restored United Nations measures is disputed by Iran, Russia and China; the examinable consequence is that nuclear diplomacy initially widened the space for energy and connectivity ties while renewed sanctions exposed Indian oil, banking, insurance and project channels to third-country pressure. D. The owners argue that India's West Asia policy is best evaluated through the energy trilemma of security, affordability and sustainability rather than through energy security alone, because supplier diversification, diaspora exposure and connectivity-framework design are all shaped by the same trade-offs between reliable supply, cost and long-term transition pressure; the practical consequence for a Mains answer is that a purely security-based frame misses affordability and transition considerations that can conflict with each other, and that triangular relationship management across the Gulf, Israel and Iran requires continuous diplomatic effort rather than a one-time policy declaration.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Joint Comprehensive Plan of Action was concluded on 14 July 2015 between Iran and the E3 and European Union plus three grouping and was endorsed by United Nations Security Council resolution 2231, after which the United States announced withdrawal on 8 May 2018 and restored sanctions in stages, and the owners give an explicit status caution that the Plan must not be described as normally functioning because, following the E3 snapback action in 2025, the status of restored United Nations measures is disputed by Iran, Russia and China; the examinable consequence is that nuclear diplomacy initially widened the space for energy and connectivity ties while renewed sanctions exposed Indian oil, banking, insurance and project channels to third-country pressure. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q56. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The nuclear-diplomacy instrument and its disputed present status?

A. The audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2018 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the depth and diversity of India's relations with Israel, a Discuss demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the printed word-limit tail was corrupted in the scan and that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, 2018 General Studies Paper II question 20 on the United States-Iran nuclear-pact controversy and India's national interest, an In what ways and How should demand of 15 marks and 250 words on the same superseding route, and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 19 on energy security and India's foreign policy in the Middle East, a Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words; four objective demands are also routed here and carried as coverage requirements only, namely 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 24 on the two-state solution in an international-affairs context, 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 37 on conflict-zone towns and their correct country matching, 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 94 on Israel, Arab states, diplomatic relations and the Arab Peace Initiative, for which the official 2018-2023 keys are not held locally, and 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 30 on the Strait of Hormuz and West Asian maritime access to the Indian Ocean, for which only a provisional 2026 Set-A key is present locally, and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for any of them. B. The owners argue that India's West Asia policy is best evaluated through the energy trilemma of security, affordability and sustainability rather than through energy security alone, because supplier diversification, diaspora exposure and connectivity-framework design are all shaped by the same trade-offs between reliable supply, cost and long-term transition pressure; the practical consequence for a Mains answer is that a purely security-based frame misses affordability and transition considerations that can conflict with each other, and that triangular relationship management across the Gulf, Israel and Iran requires continuous diplomatic effort rather than a one-time policy declaration. C. India recognised the State of Palestine in 1988 and continues to support a negotiated, sovereign, viable two-state solution alongside Israel, and after the October 2023 conflict began India condemned terrorism, called for humanitarian protection, release of hostages, dialogue and a two-state settlement while continuing relations with Israel and assistance to Palestinians; the owners require this to be presented as a single coherent position rather than as a contradiction, and they add the analytical warning that the conflict tests the corridor and minilateral frameworks by raising political, security and route-risk costs, so announced corridors and minilaterals must not be treated as insulated from regional war. D. The Joint Comprehensive Plan of Action was concluded on 14 July 2015 between Iran and the E3 and European Union plus three grouping and was endorsed by United Nations Security Council resolution 2231, after which the United States announced withdrawal on 8 May 2018 and restored sanctions in stages, and the owners give an explicit status caution that the Plan must not be described as normally functioning because, following the E3 snapback action in 2025, the status of restored United Nations measures is disputed by Iran, Russia and China; the examinable consequence is that nuclear diplomacy initially widened the space for energy and connectivity ties while renewed sanctions exposed Indian oil, banking, insurance and project channels to third-country pressure.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Joint Comprehensive Plan of Action was concluded on 14 July 2015 between Iran and the E3 and European Union plus three grouping and was endorsed by United Nations Security Council resolution 2231, after which the United States announced withdrawal on 8 May 2018 and restored sanctions in stages, and the owners give an explicit status caution that the Plan must not be described as normally functioning because, following the E3 snapback action in 2025, the status of restored United Nations measures is disputed by Iran, Russia and China; the examinable consequence is that nuclear diplomacy initially widened the space for energy and connectivity ties while renewed sanctions exposed Indian oil, banking, insurance and project channels to third-country pressure. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies The oil-sourcing transmission of another state's policy?

A. India ceased Iranian crude purchases after United States Significant Reduction Exceptions ended in May 2019 and substituted other suppliers, which the owners treat as the clearest single demonstration that external policy can directly change India's energy basket; the qualification is equally important, because supplier substitution reduced immediate sanctions exposure but narrowed the Iran relationship and did not reduce aggregate import dependence, so the episode is evidence of vulnerability transmission rather than of successful dependence reduction. B. The United States exception granted in 2018 for Chabahar and Afghanistan-related connectivity was revoked with effect from 29 September 2025, and the ten-year Chabahar contract had been signed on 13 May 2024, so the owners read the sequence as showing both that India may pursue a national-interest carve-out even amid United States-Iran confrontation and that an exception is a reversible foreign executive measure rather than a permanent legal guarantee; the connectivity link serves West Asia and Central Asia simultaneously, and the Central Asian limb of the same instrument is owned by topic 05. C. Operation Sindhu evacuated four thousand four hundred and fifteen Indian nationals from Iran and Israel by 27 June 2025, comprising three thousand five hundred and ninety-seven from Iran and eight hundred and eighteen from Israel, which the owners treat as the concrete dated demonstration that West Asia policy carries a standing consular-protection obligation rather than a hypothetical risk; the boundary is stated in the same place, because the operational relief and logistics cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owner while the host-government negotiation and consular diplomacy that enable an evacuation belong to this folder and to topic 09. D. India recognised the State of Palestine in 1988 and continues to support a negotiated, sovereign, viable two-state solution alongside Israel, and after the October 2023 conflict began India condemned terrorism, called for humanitarian protection, release of hostages, dialogue and a two-state settlement while continuing relations with Israel and assistance to Palestinians; the owners require this to be presented as a single coherent position rather than as a contradiction, and they add the analytical warning that the conflict tests the corridor and minilateral frameworks by raising political, security and route-risk costs, so announced corridors and minilaterals must not be treated as insulated from regional war.

Answer: A. Explanation: India ceased Iranian crude purchases after United States Significant Reduction Exceptions ended in May 2019 and substituted other suppliers, which the owners treat as the clearest single demonstration that external policy can directly change India's energy basket; the qualification is equally important, because supplier substitution reduced immediate sanctions exposure but narrowed the Iran relationship and did not reduce aggregate import dependence, so the episode is evidence of vulnerability transmission rather than of successful dependence reduction. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q58. Which card should be filed under The oil-sourcing transmission of another state's policy in an International Relations answer?

A. India recognised the State of Palestine in 1988 and continues to support a negotiated, sovereign, viable two-state solution alongside Israel, and after the October 2023 conflict began India condemned terrorism, called for humanitarian protection, release of hostages, dialogue and a two-state settlement while continuing relations with Israel and assistance to Palestinians; the owners require this to be presented as a single coherent position rather than as a contradiction, and they add the analytical warning that the conflict tests the corridor and minilateral frameworks by raising political, security and route-risk costs, so announced corridors and minilaterals must not be treated as insulated from regional war. B. India ceased Iranian crude purchases after United States Significant Reduction Exceptions ended in May 2019 and substituted other suppliers, which the owners treat as the clearest single demonstration that external policy can directly change India's energy basket; the qualification is equally important, because supplier substitution reduced immediate sanctions exposure but narrowed the Iran relationship and did not reduce aggregate import dependence, so the episode is evidence of vulnerability transmission rather than of successful dependence reduction. C. Operation Sindhu evacuated four thousand four hundred and fifteen Indian nationals from Iran and Israel by 27 June 2025, comprising three thousand five hundred and ninety-seven from Iran and eight hundred and eighteen from Israel, which the owners treat as the concrete dated demonstration that West Asia policy carries a standing consular-protection obligation rather than a hypothetical risk; the boundary is stated in the same place, because the operational relief and logistics cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owner while the host-government negotiation and consular diplomacy that enable an evacuation belong to this folder and to topic 09. D. The owners argue that India's West Asia policy is best evaluated through the energy trilemma of security, affordability and sustainability rather than through energy security alone, because supplier diversification, diaspora exposure and connectivity-framework design are all shaped by the same trade-offs between reliable supply, cost and long-term transition pressure; the practical consequence for a Mains answer is that a purely security-based frame misses affordability and transition considerations that can conflict with each other, and that triangular relationship management across the Gulf, Israel and Iran requires continuous diplomatic effort rather than a one-time policy declaration.

Answer: B. Explanation: India ceased Iranian crude purchases after United States Significant Reduction Exceptions ended in May 2019 and substituted other suppliers, which the owners treat as the clearest single demonstration that external policy can directly change India's energy basket; the qualification is equally important, because supplier substitution reduced immediate sanctions exposure but narrowed the Iran relationship and did not reduce aggregate import dependence, so the episode is evidence of vulnerability transmission rather than of successful dependence reduction. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q59. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The oil-sourcing transmission of another state's policy?

A. The audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2018 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the depth and diversity of India's relations with Israel, a Discuss demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the printed word-limit tail was corrupted in the scan and that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, 2018 General Studies Paper II question 20 on the United States-Iran nuclear-pact controversy and India's national interest, an In what ways and How should demand of 15 marks and 250 words on the same superseding route, and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 19 on energy security and India's foreign policy in the Middle East, a Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words; four objective demands are also routed here and carried as coverage requirements only, namely 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 24 on the two-state solution in an international-affairs context, 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 37 on conflict-zone towns and their correct country matching, 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 94 on Israel, Arab states, diplomatic relations and the Arab Peace Initiative, for which the official 2018-2023 keys are not held locally, and 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 30 on the Strait of Hormuz and West Asian maritime access to the Indian Ocean, for which only a provisional 2026 Set-A key is present locally, and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for any of them. B. The owners argue that India's West Asia policy is best evaluated through the energy trilemma of security, affordability and sustainability rather than through energy security alone, because supplier diversification, diaspora exposure and connectivity-framework design are all shaped by the same trade-offs between reliable supply, cost and long-term transition pressure; the practical consequence for a Mains answer is that a purely security-based frame misses affordability and transition considerations that can conflict with each other, and that triangular relationship management across the Gulf, Israel and Iran requires continuous diplomatic effort rather than a one-time policy declaration. C. India ceased Iranian crude purchases after United States Significant Reduction Exceptions ended in May 2019 and substituted other suppliers, which the owners treat as the clearest single demonstration that external policy can directly change India's energy basket; the qualification is equally important, because supplier substitution reduced immediate sanctions exposure but narrowed the Iran relationship and did not reduce aggregate import dependence, so the episode is evidence of vulnerability transmission rather than of successful dependence reduction. D. India recognised the State of Palestine in 1988 and continues to support a negotiated, sovereign, viable two-state solution alongside Israel, and after the October 2023 conflict began India condemned terrorism, called for humanitarian protection, release of hostages, dialogue and a two-state settlement while continuing relations with Israel and assistance to Palestinians; the owners require this to be presented as a single coherent position rather than as a contradiction, and they add the analytical warning that the conflict tests the corridor and minilateral frameworks by raising political, security and route-risk costs, so announced corridors and minilaterals must not be treated as insulated from regional war.

Answer: C. Explanation: India ceased Iranian crude purchases after United States Significant Reduction Exceptions ended in May 2019 and substituted other suppliers, which the owners treat as the clearest single demonstration that external policy can directly change India's energy basket; the qualification is equally important, because supplier substitution reduced immediate sanctions exposure but narrowed the Iran relationship and did not reduce aggregate import dependence, so the episode is evidence of vulnerability transmission rather than of successful dependence reduction. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q60. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The oil-sourcing transmission of another state's policy?

A. This topic owns India's Look West engagement with the Gulf and the Arab world, the Israel and Iran tracks, energy security as the organising interest, Gulf diaspora welfare as a foreign-policy obligation, the Palestine position and the connectivity and minilateral frameworks of I2U2 and the India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor, and its distinctive feature is that a single regional escalation can threaten energy supply, diaspora safety and connectivity viability at the same time; three verified General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2018 and 2025 and four objective demands from 2018, 2023 and 2026 are routed here, while oil-import-bill, pricing and tariff mechanics belong to the Economy owner, the minilateral classification of I2U2 belongs to topic 10, diaspora diplomacy in general belongs to topic 09, the Central Asian limb of Chabahar belongs to topic 05, and the humanitarian relief cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owners. B. The audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2018 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the depth and diversity of India's relations with Israel, a Discuss demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the printed word-limit tail was corrupted in the scan and that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, 2018 General Studies Paper II question 20 on the United States-Iran nuclear-pact controversy and India's national interest, an In what ways and How should demand of 15 marks and 250 words on the same superseding route, and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 19 on energy security and India's foreign policy in the Middle East, a Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words; four objective demands are also routed here and carried as coverage requirements only, namely 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 24 on the two-state solution in an international-affairs context, 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 37 on conflict-zone towns and their correct country matching, 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 94 on Israel, Arab states, diplomatic relations and the Arab Peace Initiative, for which the official 2018-2023 keys are not held locally, and 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 30 on the Strait of Hormuz and West Asian maritime access to the Indian Ocean, for which only a provisional 2026 Set-A key is present locally, and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for any of them. C. The owners argue that India's West Asia policy is best evaluated through the energy trilemma of security, affordability and sustainability rather than through energy security alone, because supplier diversification, diaspora exposure and connectivity-framework design are all shaped by the same trade-offs between reliable supply, cost and long-term transition pressure; the practical consequence for a Mains answer is that a purely security-based frame misses affordability and transition considerations that can conflict with each other, and that triangular relationship management across the Gulf, Israel and Iran requires continuous diplomatic effort rather than a one-time policy declaration. D. India ceased Iranian crude purchases after United States Significant Reduction Exceptions ended in May 2019 and substituted other suppliers, which the owners treat as the clearest single demonstration that external policy can directly change India's energy basket; the qualification is equally important, because supplier substitution reduced immediate sanctions exposure but narrowed the Iran relationship and did not reduce aggregate import dependence, so the episode is evidence of vulnerability transmission rather than of successful dependence reduction.

Answer: D. Explanation: India ceased Iranian crude purchases after United States Significant Reduction Exceptions ended in May 2019 and substituted other suppliers, which the owners treat as the clearest single demonstration that external policy can directly change India's energy basket; the qualification is equally important, because supplier substitution reduced immediate sanctions exposure but narrowed the Iran relationship and did not reduce aggregate import dependence, so the episode is evidence of vulnerability transmission rather than of successful dependence reduction. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies The Chabahar carve-out and its reversal?

A. The United States exception granted in 2018 for Chabahar and Afghanistan-related connectivity was revoked with effect from 29 September 2025, and the ten-year Chabahar contract had been signed on 13 May 2024, so the owners read the sequence as showing both that India may pursue a national-interest carve-out even amid United States-Iran confrontation and that an exception is a reversible foreign executive measure rather than a permanent legal guarantee; the connectivity link serves West Asia and Central Asia simultaneously, and the Central Asian limb of the same instrument is owned by topic 05. B. India recognised the State of Palestine in 1988 and continues to support a negotiated, sovereign, viable two-state solution alongside Israel, and after the October 2023 conflict began India condemned terrorism, called for humanitarian protection, release of hostages, dialogue and a two-state settlement while continuing relations with Israel and assistance to Palestinians; the owners require this to be presented as a single coherent position rather than as a contradiction, and they add the analytical warning that the conflict tests the corridor and minilateral frameworks by raising political, security and route-risk costs, so announced corridors and minilaterals must not be treated as insulated from regional war. C. Operation Sindhu evacuated four thousand four hundred and fifteen Indian nationals from Iran and Israel by 27 June 2025, comprising three thousand five hundred and ninety-seven from Iran and eight hundred and eighteen from Israel, which the owners treat as the concrete dated demonstration that West Asia policy carries a standing consular-protection obligation rather than a hypothetical risk; the boundary is stated in the same place, because the operational relief and logistics cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owner while the host-government negotiation and consular diplomacy that enable an evacuation belong to this folder and to topic 09. D. The owners argue that India's West Asia policy is best evaluated through the energy trilemma of security, affordability and sustainability rather than through energy security alone, because supplier diversification, diaspora exposure and connectivity-framework design are all shaped by the same trade-offs between reliable supply, cost and long-term transition pressure; the practical consequence for a Mains answer is that a purely security-based frame misses affordability and transition considerations that can conflict with each other, and that triangular relationship management across the Gulf, Israel and Iran requires continuous diplomatic effort rather than a one-time policy declaration.

Answer: A. Explanation: The United States exception granted in 2018 for Chabahar and Afghanistan-related connectivity was revoked with effect from 29 September 2025, and the ten-year Chabahar contract had been signed on 13 May 2024, so the owners read the sequence as showing both that India may pursue a national-interest carve-out even amid United States-Iran confrontation and that an exception is a reversible foreign executive measure rather than a permanent legal guarantee; the connectivity link serves West Asia and Central Asia simultaneously, and the Central Asian limb of the same instrument is owned by topic 05. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q62. Which card should be filed under The Chabahar carve-out and its reversal in an International Relations answer?

A. India recognised the State of Palestine in 1988 and continues to support a negotiated, sovereign, viable two-state solution alongside Israel, and after the October 2023 conflict began India condemned terrorism, called for humanitarian protection, release of hostages, dialogue and a two-state settlement while continuing relations with Israel and assistance to Palestinians; the owners require this to be presented as a single coherent position rather than as a contradiction, and they add the analytical warning that the conflict tests the corridor and minilateral frameworks by raising political, security and route-risk costs, so announced corridors and minilaterals must not be treated as insulated from regional war. B. The United States exception granted in 2018 for Chabahar and Afghanistan-related connectivity was revoked with effect from 29 September 2025, and the ten-year Chabahar contract had been signed on 13 May 2024, so the owners read the sequence as showing both that India may pursue a national-interest carve-out even amid United States-Iran confrontation and that an exception is a reversible foreign executive measure rather than a permanent legal guarantee; the connectivity link serves West Asia and Central Asia simultaneously, and the Central Asian limb of the same instrument is owned by topic 05. C. The audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2018 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the depth and diversity of India's relations with Israel, a Discuss demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the printed word-limit tail was corrupted in the scan and that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, 2018 General Studies Paper II question 20 on the United States-Iran nuclear-pact controversy and India's national interest, an In what ways and How should demand of 15 marks and 250 words on the same superseding route, and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 19 on energy security and India's foreign policy in the Middle East, a Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words; four objective demands are also routed here and carried as coverage requirements only, namely 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 24 on the two-state solution in an international-affairs context, 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 37 on conflict-zone towns and their correct country matching, 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 94 on Israel, Arab states, diplomatic relations and the Arab Peace Initiative, for which the official 2018-2023 keys are not held locally, and 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 30 on the Strait of Hormuz and West Asian maritime access to the Indian Ocean, for which only a provisional 2026 Set-A key is present locally, and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for any of them. D. The owners argue that India's West Asia policy is best evaluated through the energy trilemma of security, affordability and sustainability rather than through energy security alone, because supplier diversification, diaspora exposure and connectivity-framework design are all shaped by the same trade-offs between reliable supply, cost and long-term transition pressure; the practical consequence for a Mains answer is that a purely security-based frame misses affordability and transition considerations that can conflict with each other, and that triangular relationship management across the Gulf, Israel and Iran requires continuous diplomatic effort rather than a one-time policy declaration.

Answer: B. Explanation: The United States exception granted in 2018 for Chabahar and Afghanistan-related connectivity was revoked with effect from 29 September 2025, and the ten-year Chabahar contract had been signed on 13 May 2024, so the owners read the sequence as showing both that India may pursue a national-interest carve-out even amid United States-Iran confrontation and that an exception is a reversible foreign executive measure rather than a permanent legal guarantee; the connectivity link serves West Asia and Central Asia simultaneously, and the Central Asian limb of the same instrument is owned by topic 05. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q63. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The Chabahar carve-out and its reversal?

A. The owners argue that India's West Asia policy is best evaluated through the energy trilemma of security, affordability and sustainability rather than through energy security alone, because supplier diversification, diaspora exposure and connectivity-framework design are all shaped by the same trade-offs between reliable supply, cost and long-term transition pressure; the practical consequence for a Mains answer is that a purely security-based frame misses affordability and transition considerations that can conflict with each other, and that triangular relationship management across the Gulf, Israel and Iran requires continuous diplomatic effort rather than a one-time policy declaration. B. The audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2018 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the depth and diversity of India's relations with Israel, a Discuss demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the printed word-limit tail was corrupted in the scan and that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, 2018 General Studies Paper II question 20 on the United States-Iran nuclear-pact controversy and India's national interest, an In what ways and How should demand of 15 marks and 250 words on the same superseding route, and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 19 on energy security and India's foreign policy in the Middle East, a Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words; four objective demands are also routed here and carried as coverage requirements only, namely 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 24 on the two-state solution in an international-affairs context, 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 37 on conflict-zone towns and their correct country matching, 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 94 on Israel, Arab states, diplomatic relations and the Arab Peace Initiative, for which the official 2018-2023 keys are not held locally, and 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 30 on the Strait of Hormuz and West Asian maritime access to the Indian Ocean, for which only a provisional 2026 Set-A key is present locally, and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for any of them. C. The United States exception granted in 2018 for Chabahar and Afghanistan-related connectivity was revoked with effect from 29 September 2025, and the ten-year Chabahar contract had been signed on 13 May 2024, so the owners read the sequence as showing both that India may pursue a national-interest carve-out even amid United States-Iran confrontation and that an exception is a reversible foreign executive measure rather than a permanent legal guarantee; the connectivity link serves West Asia and Central Asia simultaneously, and the Central Asian limb of the same instrument is owned by topic 05. D. This topic owns India's Look West engagement with the Gulf and the Arab world, the Israel and Iran tracks, energy security as the organising interest, Gulf diaspora welfare as a foreign-policy obligation, the Palestine position and the connectivity and minilateral frameworks of I2U2 and the India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor, and its distinctive feature is that a single regional escalation can threaten energy supply, diaspora safety and connectivity viability at the same time; three verified General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2018 and 2025 and four objective demands from 2018, 2023 and 2026 are routed here, while oil-import-bill, pricing and tariff mechanics belong to the Economy owner, the minilateral classification of I2U2 belongs to topic 10, diaspora diplomacy in general belongs to topic 09, the Central Asian limb of Chabahar belongs to topic 05, and the humanitarian relief cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owners.

Answer: C. Explanation: The United States exception granted in 2018 for Chabahar and Afghanistan-related connectivity was revoked with effect from 29 September 2025, and the ten-year Chabahar contract had been signed on 13 May 2024, so the owners read the sequence as showing both that India may pursue a national-interest carve-out even amid United States-Iran confrontation and that an exception is a reversible foreign executive measure rather than a permanent legal guarantee; the connectivity link serves West Asia and Central Asia simultaneously, and the Central Asian limb of the same instrument is owned by topic 05. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q64. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The Chabahar carve-out and its reversal?

A. This topic owns India's Look West engagement with the Gulf and the Arab world, the Israel and Iran tracks, energy security as the organising interest, Gulf diaspora welfare as a foreign-policy obligation, the Palestine position and the connectivity and minilateral frameworks of I2U2 and the India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor, and its distinctive feature is that a single regional escalation can threaten energy supply, diaspora safety and connectivity viability at the same time; three verified General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2018 and 2025 and four objective demands from 2018, 2023 and 2026 are routed here, while oil-import-bill, pricing and tariff mechanics belong to the Economy owner, the minilateral classification of I2U2 belongs to topic 10, diaspora diplomacy in general belongs to topic 09, the Central Asian limb of Chabahar belongs to topic 05, and the humanitarian relief cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owners. B. Tharoor records that as far as the Arab world is concerned India is proud that it has a Look West policy too, which the owners treat as an explicit parallel to the better-known Look East policy and therefore as a regionally targeted engagement doctrine rather than an undifferentiated foreign-policy stance; the examinable value of the phrase is that it establishes West Asia as a named policy theatre with its own instruments, so a candidate can open an answer by classifying the region correctly instead of treating Gulf engagement as an appendix to a general foreign-policy narrative. C. The audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2018 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the depth and diversity of India's relations with Israel, a Discuss demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the printed word-limit tail was corrupted in the scan and that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, 2018 General Studies Paper II question 20 on the United States-Iran nuclear-pact controversy and India's national interest, an In what ways and How should demand of 15 marks and 250 words on the same superseding route, and 2025

General Studies Paper II question 19 on energy security and India's foreign policy in the Middle East, a Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words; four objective demands are also routed here and carried as coverage requirements only, namely 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 24 on the two-state solution in an international-affairs context, 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 37 on conflict-zone towns and their correct country matching, 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 94 on Israel, Arab states, diplomatic relations and the Arab Peace Initiative, for which the official 2018-2023 keys are not held locally, and 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 30 on the Strait of Hormuz and West Asian maritime access to the Indian Ocean, for which only a provisional 2026 Set-A key is present locally, and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for any of them. D. The United States exception granted in 2018 for Chabahar and Afghanistan-related connectivity was revoked with effect from 29 September 2025, and the ten-year Chabahar contract had been signed on 13 May 2024, so the owners read the sequence as showing both that India may pursue a national-interest carve-out even amid United States-Iran confrontation and that an exception is a reversible foreign executive measure rather than a permanent legal guarantee; the connectivity link serves West Asia and Central Asia simultaneously, and the Central Asian limb of the same instrument is owned by topic 05.

Answer: D. Explanation: The United States exception granted in 2018 for Chabahar and Afghanistan-related connectivity was revoked with effect from 29 September 2025, and the ten-year Chabahar contract had been signed on 13 May 2024, so the owners read the sequence as showing both that India may pursue a national-interest carve-out even amid United States-Iran confrontation and that an exception is a reversible foreign executive measure rather than a permanent legal guarantee; the connectivity link serves West Asia and Central Asia simultaneously, and the Central Asian limb of the same instrument is owned by topic 05. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Operation Sindhu as dated evidence of the consular obligation?

A. Operation Sindhu evacuated four thousand four hundred and fifteen Indian nationals from Iran and Israel by 27 June 2025, comprising three thousand five hundred and ninety-seven from Iran and eight hundred and eighteen from Israel, which the owners treat as the concrete dated demonstration that West Asia policy carries a standing consular-protection obligation rather than a hypothetical risk; the boundary is stated in the same place, because the operational relief and logistics cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owner while the host-government negotiation and consular diplomacy that enable an evacuation belong to this folder and to topic 09. B. The owners argue that India's West Asia policy is best evaluated through the energy trilemma of security, affordability and sustainability rather than through energy security alone, because supplier diversification, diaspora exposure and connectivity-framework design are all shaped by the same trade-offs between reliable supply, cost and long-term transition pressure; the practical consequence for a Mains answer is that a purely security-based frame misses affordability and transition considerations that can conflict with each other, and that triangular relationship management across the Gulf, Israel and Iran requires continuous diplomatic effort rather than a one-time policy declaration. C. India recognised the State of Palestine in 1988 and continues to support a negotiated, sovereign, viable two-state solution alongside Israel, and after the October 2023 conflict began India condemned terrorism, called for humanitarian protection, release of hostages, dialogue and a two-state settlement while continuing relations with Israel and assistance to Palestinians; the owners require this to be presented as a single coherent position rather than as a contradiction, and they add the analytical warning that the conflict tests the corridor and minilateral frameworks by raising political, security and route-risk costs, so announced corridors and minilaterals must not be treated as insulated from regional war. D. The audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2018 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the depth and diversity of India's relations with Israel, a Discuss demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the printed word-limit tail was corrupted in the scan and that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, 2018 General Studies Paper II question 20 on the United States-Iran nuclear-pact controversy and India's national interest, an In what ways and How should demand of 15 marks and 250 words on the same superseding route, and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 19 on energy security and India's foreign policy in the Middle East, a Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words; four objective demands are also routed here and carried as coverage requirements only, namely 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 24 on the two-state solution in an international-affairs context, 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 37 on conflict-zone towns and their correct country matching, 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 94 on Israel, Arab states, diplomatic relations and the Arab Peace Initiative, for which the official

2018-2023 keys are not held locally, and 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 30 on the Strait of Hormuz and West Asian maritime access to the Indian Ocean, for which only a provisional 2026 Set-A key is present locally, and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for any of them.

Answer: A. Explanation: Operation Sindhu evacuated four thousand four hundred and fifteen Indian nationals from Iran and Israel by 27 June 2025, comprising three thousand five hundred and ninety-seven from Iran and eight hundred and eighteen from Israel, which the owners treat as the concrete dated demonstration that West Asia policy carries a standing consular-protection obligation rather than a hypothetical risk; the boundary is stated in the same place, because the operational relief and logistics cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owner while the host-government negotiation and consular diplomacy that enable an evacuation belong to this folder and to topic 09. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q66. Which card should be filed under Operation Sindhu as dated evidence of the consular obligation in an International Relations answer?

A. This topic owns India's Look West engagement with the Gulf and the Arab world, the Israel and Iran tracks, energy security as the organising interest, Gulf diaspora welfare as a foreign-policy obligation, the Palestine position and the connectivity and minilateral frameworks of I2U2 and the India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor, and its distinctive feature is that a single regional escalation can threaten energy supply, diaspora safety and connectivity viability at the same time; three verified General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2018 and 2025 and four objective demands from 2018, 2023 and 2026 are routed here, while oil-import-bill, pricing and tariff mechanics belong to the Economy owner, the minilateral classification of I2U2 belongs to topic 10, diaspora diplomacy in general belongs to topic 09, the Central Asian limb of Chabahar belongs to topic 05, and the humanitarian relief cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owners. B. Operation Sindhu evacuated four thousand four hundred and fifteen Indian nationals from Iran and Israel by 27 June 2025, comprising three thousand five hundred and ninety-seven from Iran and eight hundred and eighteen from Israel, which the owners treat as the concrete dated demonstration that West Asia policy carries a standing consular-protection obligation rather than a hypothetical risk; the boundary is stated in the same place, because the operational relief and logistics cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owner while the host-government negotiation and consular diplomacy that enable an evacuation belong to this folder and to topic 09. C. The audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2018 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the depth and diversity of India's relations with Israel, a Discuss demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the printed word-limit tail was corrupted in the scan and that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, 2018 General Studies Paper II question 20 on the United States-Iran nuclear-pact controversy and India's national interest, an In what ways and How should demand of 15 marks and 250 words on the same superseding route, and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 19 on energy security and India's foreign policy in the Middle East, a Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words; four objective demands are also routed here and carried as coverage requirements only, namely 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 24 on the two-state solution in an international-affairs context, 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 37 on conflict-zone towns and their correct country matching, 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 94 on Israel, Arab states, diplomatic relations and the Arab Peace Initiative, for which the official 2018-2023 keys are not held locally, and 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 30 on the Strait of Hormuz and West Asian maritime access to the Indian Ocean, for which only a provisional 2026 Set-A key is present locally, and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for any of them. D. The owners argue that India's West Asia policy is best evaluated through the energy trilemma of security, affordability and sustainability rather than through energy security alone, because supplier diversification, diaspora exposure and connectivity-framework design are all shaped by the same trade-offs between reliable supply, cost and long-term transition pressure; the practical consequence for a Mains answer is that a purely security-based frame misses affordability and transition considerations that can conflict with each other, and that triangular relationship management across the Gulf, Israel and Iran requires continuous diplomatic effort rather than a one-time policy declaration.

Answer: B. Explanation: Operation Sindhu evacuated four thousand four hundred and fifteen Indian nationals from Iran and Israel by 27 June 2025, comprising three thousand five hundred and ninety-seven from Iran and eight hundred and eighteen from Israel, which the owners treat as the concrete dated demonstration that West Asia policy carries a standing consular-protection obligation rather than a hypothetical risk; the boundary is stated in the same place, because the operational relief and logistics cycle belongs to the

Disaster Management owner while the host-government negotiation and consular diplomacy that enable an evacuation belong to this folder and to topic 09. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q67. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Operation Sindhu as dated evidence of the consular obligation?

A. Tharoor records that as far as the Arab world is concerned India is proud that it has a Look West policy too, which the owners treat as an explicit parallel to the better-known Look East policy and therefore as a regionally targeted engagement doctrine rather than an undifferentiated foreign-policy stance; the examinable value of the phrase is that it establishes West Asia as a named policy theatre with its own instruments, so a candidate can open an answer by classifying the region correctly instead of treating Gulf engagement as an appendix to a general foreign-policy narrative. B. The audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2018 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the depth and diversity of India's relations with Israel, a Discuss demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the printed word-limit tail was corrupted in the scan and that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, 2018 General Studies Paper II question 20 on the United States-Iran nuclear-pact controversy and India's national interest, an In what ways and How should demand of 15 marks and 250 words on the same superseding route, and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 19 on energy security and India's foreign policy in the Middle East, a Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words; four objective demands are also routed here and carried as coverage requirements only, namely 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 24 on the two-state solution in an international-affairs context, 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 37 on conflict-zone towns and their correct country matching, 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 94 on Israel, Arab states, diplomatic relations and the Arab Peace Initiative, for which the official 2018-2023 keys are not held locally, and 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 30 on the Strait of Hormuz and West Asian maritime access to the Indian Ocean, for which only a provisional 2026 Set-A key is present locally, and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for any of them. C. Operation Sindhu evacuated four thousand four hundred and fifteen Indian nationals from Iran and Israel by 27 June 2025, comprising three thousand five hundred and ninety-seven from Iran and eight hundred and eighteen from Israel, which the owners treat as the concrete dated demonstration that West Asia policy carries a standing consular-protection obligation rather than a hypothetical risk; the boundary is stated in the same place, because the operational relief and logistics cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owner while the host-government negotiation and consular diplomacy that enable an evacuation belong to this folder and to topic 09. D. This topic owns India's Look West engagement with the Gulf and the Arab world, the Israel and Iran tracks, energy security as the organising interest, Gulf diaspora welfare as a foreign-policy obligation, the Palestine position and the connectivity and minilateral frameworks of I2U2 and the India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor, and its distinctive feature is that a single regional escalation can threaten energy supply, diaspora safety and connectivity viability at the same time; three verified General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2018 and 2025 and four objective demands from 2018, 2023 and 2026 are routed here, while oil-import-bill, pricing and tariff mechanics belong to the Economy owner, the minilateral classification of I2U2 belongs to topic 10, diaspora diplomacy in general belongs to topic 09, the Central Asian limb of Chabahar belongs to topic 05, and the humanitarian relief cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owners.

Answer: C. Explanation: Operation Sindhu evacuated four thousand four hundred and fifteen Indian nationals from Iran and Israel by 27 June 2025, comprising three thousand five hundred and ninety-seven from Iran and eight hundred and eighteen from Israel, which the owners treat as the concrete dated demonstration that West Asia policy carries a standing consular-protection obligation rather than a hypothetical risk; the boundary is stated in the same place, because the operational relief and logistics cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owner while the host-government negotiation and consular diplomacy that enable an evacuation belong to this folder and to topic 09. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q68. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Operation Sindhu as dated evidence of the consular obligation?

A. This topic owns India's Look West engagement with the Gulf and the Arab world, the Israel and Iran tracks, energy security as the organising interest, Gulf diaspora welfare as a foreign-policy obligation, the Palestine position and the connectivity and minilateral frameworks of I2U2 and the India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor, and its distinctive feature is that a single regional escalation can threaten energy supply, diaspora safety and connectivity viability at the same time; three verified General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2018 and 2025 and four objective demands from 2018, 2023 and 2026 are routed here, while oil-import-bill, pricing and tariff mechanics belong to the Economy owner, the minilateral classification of I2U2 belongs to topic 10, diaspora diplomacy in general belongs to topic 09, the Central Asian limb of Chabahar belongs to topic 05, and the humanitarian relief cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owners. B. Petroleum Planning and Analysis Cell data put India's crude-oil import dependence at eighty-eight point two per cent in the financial year 2024-25 and about eighty-eight point seven per cent provisional in the financial year 2025-26, while Sikri records the book-period figure at approximately seventy per cent; the owners require the current figure and its consumption-basis definition to be cited for any present-day claim and permit the book-period figure only as a historical baseline showing the direction of travel, so quoting approximately seventy per cent as a current number is treated as a factual error rather than a stylistic one. C. Tharoor records that as far as the Arab world is concerned India is proud that it has a Look West policy too, which the owners treat as an explicit parallel to the better-known Look East policy and therefore as a regionally targeted engagement doctrine rather than an undifferentiated foreign-policy stance; the examinable value of the phrase is that it establishes West Asia as a named policy theatre with its own instruments, so a candidate can open an answer by classifying the region correctly instead of treating Gulf engagement as an appendix to a general foreign-policy narrative. D. Operation Sindhu evacuated four thousand four hundred and fifteen Indian nationals from Iran and Israel by 27 June 2025, comprising three thousand five hundred and ninety-seven from Iran and eight hundred and eighteen from Israel, which the owners treat as the concrete dated demonstration that West Asia policy carries a standing consular-protection obligation rather than a hypothetical risk; the boundary is stated in the same place, because the operational relief and logistics cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owner while the host-government negotiation and consular diplomacy that enable an evacuation belong to this folder and to topic 09.

Answer: D. Explanation: Operation Sindhu evacuated four thousand four hundred and fifteen Indian nationals from Iran and Israel by 27 June 2025, comprising three thousand five hundred and ninety-seven from Iran and eight hundred and eighteen from Israel, which the owners treat as the concrete dated demonstration that West Asia policy carries a standing consular-protection obligation rather than a hypothetical risk; the boundary is stated in the same place, because the operational relief and logistics cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owner while the host-government negotiation and consular diplomacy that enable an evacuation belong to this folder and to topic 09. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies India's Palestine position and the balance it must hold?

A. India recognised the State of Palestine in 1988 and continues to support a negotiated, sovereign, viable two-state solution alongside Israel, and after the October 2023 conflict began India condemned terrorism, called for humanitarian protection, release of hostages, dialogue and a two-state settlement while continuing relations with Israel and assistance to Palestinians; the owners require this to be presented as a single coherent position rather than as a contradiction, and they add the analytical warning that the conflict tests the corridor and minilateral frameworks by raising political, security and route-risk costs, so announced corridors and minilaterals must not be treated as insulated from regional war. B. This topic owns India's Look West engagement with the Gulf and the Arab world, the Israel and Iran tracks, energy security as the organising interest, Gulf diaspora welfare as a foreign-policy obligation, the Palestine position and the connectivity and minilateral frameworks of I2U2 and the India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor, and its distinctive feature is that a single regional escalation can threaten energy supply, diaspora safety and connectivity viability at the same time; three verified General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2018 and 2025 and four objective demands from 2018, 2023 and 2026 are routed here, while oil-import-bill, pricing and tariff mechanics belong to the Economy owner, the minilateral classification of I2U2 belongs to topic 10, diaspora diplomacy in general belongs to topic 09, the Central Asian limb of Chabahar belongs to topic 05, and the humanitarian relief cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owners. C. The owners argue that India's West Asia policy is best evaluated through the energy trilemma of security, affordability and sustainability rather than through energy security alone, because supplier diversification, diaspora exposure and connectivity-framework design are all shaped by the same trade-offs between reliable supply, cost and long-term transition pressure; the practical consequence for a Mains answer is that a purely security-based frame misses affordability and transition considerations that can conflict with each other, and that triangular relationship management across the Gulf, Israel and Iran requires continuous diplomatic effort rather than a one-time policy declaration. D. The audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2018 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the depth and diversity of India's relations with Israel, a Discuss demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the printed word-limit tail was corrupted in the scan and that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, 2018 General Studies Paper II question 20 on the United States-Iran nuclear-pact controversy and India's national interest, an In what ways and How should demand of 15 marks and 250 words on the same superseding route, and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 19 on energy security and India's foreign policy in the Middle East, a Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words; four objective demands are also routed here and carried as coverage requirements only, namely 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 24 on the two-state solution in an international-affairs context, 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 37 on conflict-zone towns and their correct country matching, 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 94 on Israel, Arab states, diplomatic relations and the Arab Peace Initiative, for which the official 2018-2023 keys are not held locally, and 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 30 on the Strait of Hormuz and West Asian maritime access to the Indian Ocean, for which only a provisional 2026 Set-A key is present locally, and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for any of them.

Answer: A. Explanation: India recognised the State of Palestine in 1988 and continues to support a negotiated, sovereign, viable two-state solution alongside Israel, and after the October 2023 conflict began India condemned terrorism, called for humanitarian protection, release of hostages, dialogue and a two-state settlement while continuing relations with Israel and assistance to Palestinians; the owners require this to be presented as a single coherent position rather than as a contradiction, and they add the analytical warning that the conflict tests the corridor and minilateral frameworks by raising political, security and route-risk costs, so announced corridors and minilaterals must not be treated as insulated from regional war. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q70. Which card should be filed under India's Palestine position and the balance it must hold in an International Relations answer?

A. Tharoor records that as far as the Arab world is concerned India is proud that it has a Look West policy too, which the owners treat as an explicit parallel to the better-known Look East policy and therefore as a regionally targeted engagement doctrine rather than an undifferentiated foreign-policy stance; the examinable value of the phrase is that it establishes West Asia as a named policy theatre with its own instruments, so a candidate can open an answer by classifying the region correctly instead of treating Gulf engagement as an appendix to a general foreign-policy narrative. B. India recognised the State of Palestine in 1988 and continues to support a negotiated, sovereign, viable two-state solution alongside Israel, and after the October 2023 conflict began India condemned terrorism, called for humanitarian protection, release of hostages, dialogue and a two-state settlement while continuing relations with Israel and assistance to Palestinians; the owners require this to be presented as a single coherent position rather than as a contradiction, and they add the analytical warning that the conflict tests the corridor and minilateral frameworks by raising political, security and route-risk costs, so announced corridors and minilaterals must not be treated as insulated from regional war. C. The audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2018 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the depth and diversity of India's relations with Israel, a Discuss demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the printed word-limit tail was corrupted in the scan and that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, 2018 General Studies Paper II question 20 on the United States-Iran nuclear-pact controversy and India's national interest, an In what ways and How should demand of 15 marks and 250 words on the same superseding route, and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 19 on energy security and India's foreign policy in the Middle East, a Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words; four objective demands are also routed here and carried as coverage requirements only, namely 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 24 on the two-state solution in an international-affairs context, 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 37 on conflict-zone towns and their correct country matching, 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 94 on Israel, Arab states, diplomatic relations and the Arab Peace Initiative, for which the official 2018-2023 keys are not held locally, and 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 30 on the Strait of Hormuz and West Asian maritime access to the Indian Ocean, for which only a provisional 2026 Set-A key is present locally, and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for any of them. D. This topic owns India's Look West engagement with the Gulf and the Arab world, the Israel and Iran tracks, energy security as the organising interest, Gulf diaspora welfare as a foreign-policy obligation, the Palestine position and the connectivity and minilateral frameworks of I2U2 and the India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor, and its distinctive feature is that a single regional escalation can threaten energy supply, diaspora safety and connectivity viability at the same time; three verified General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2018 and 2025 and four objective demands from 2018, 2023 and 2026 are routed here, while oil-import-bill, pricing and tariff mechanics belong to the Economy owner, the minilateral classification of I2U2 belongs to topic 10, diaspora diplomacy in general belongs to topic 09, the Central Asian limb of Chabahar belongs to topic 05, and the humanitarian relief cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owners.

Answer: B. Explanation: India recognised the State of Palestine in 1988 and continues to support a negotiated, sovereign, viable two-state solution alongside Israel, and after the October 2023 conflict began India condemned terrorism, called for humanitarian protection, release of hostages, dialogue and a two-state settlement while continuing relations with Israel and assistance to Palestinians; the owners require this to be presented as a single coherent position rather than as a contradiction, and they add the analytical warning that the conflict tests the corridor and minilateral frameworks by raising political, security and route-risk costs, so announced corridors and minilaterals must not be treated as insulated from regional war. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q71. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of India's Palestine position and the balance it must hold?

A. Petroleum Planning and Analysis Cell data put India's crude-oil import dependence at eighty-eight point two per cent in the financial year 2024-25 and about eighty-eight point seven per cent provisional in the financial year 2025-26, while Sikri records the book-period figure at approximately seventy per cent; the owners require the current figure and its consumption-basis definition to be cited for any present-day claim and permit the book-period figure only as a historical baseline showing the direction of travel, so quoting approximately seventy per cent as a current number is treated as a factual error rather than a stylistic one. B. This topic owns India's Look West engagement with the Gulf and the Arab world, the Israel and Iran tracks, energy security as the organising interest, Gulf diaspora welfare as a foreign-policy obligation, the Palestine position and the connectivity and minilateral frameworks of I2U2 and the India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor, and its distinctive feature is that a single regional escalation can threaten energy supply, diaspora safety and connectivity viability at the same time; three verified General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2018 and 2025 and four objective demands from 2018, 2023 and 2026 are routed here, while oil-import-bill, pricing and tariff mechanics belong to the Economy owner, the minilateral classification of I2U2 belongs to topic 10, diaspora diplomacy in general belongs to topic 09, the Central Asian limb of Chabahar belongs to topic 05, and the humanitarian relief cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owners. C. India recognised the State of Palestine in 1988 and continues to support a negotiated, sovereign, viable two-state solution alongside Israel, and after the October 2023 conflict began India condemned terrorism, called for humanitarian protection, release of hostages, dialogue and a two-state settlement while continuing relations with Israel and assistance to Palestinians; the owners require this to be presented as a single coherent position rather than as a contradiction, and they add the analytical warning that the conflict tests the corridor and minilateral frameworks by raising political, security and route-risk costs, so announced corridors and minilaterals must not be treated as insulated from regional war. D. Tharoor records that as far as the Arab world is concerned India is proud that it has a Look West policy too, which the owners treat as an explicit parallel to the better-known Look East policy and therefore as a regionally targeted engagement doctrine rather than an undifferentiated foreign-policy stance; the examinable value of the phrase is that it establishes West Asia as a named policy theatre with its own instruments, so a candidate can open an answer by classifying the region correctly instead of treating Gulf engagement as an appendix to a general foreign-policy narrative.

Answer: C. Explanation: India recognised the State of Palestine in 1988 and continues to support a negotiated, sovereign, viable two-state solution alongside Israel, and after the October 2023 conflict began India condemned terrorism, called for humanitarian protection, release of hostages, dialogue and a two-state settlement while continuing relations with Israel and assistance to Palestinians; the owners require this to be presented as a single coherent position rather than as a contradiction, and they add the analytical warning

that the conflict tests the corridor and minilateral frameworks by raising political, security and route-risk costs, so announced corridors and minilaterals must not be treated as insulated from regional war. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q72. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about India's Palestine position and the balance it must hold?

A. Tharoor records that as far as the Arab world is concerned India is proud that it has a Look West policy too, which the owners treat as an explicit parallel to the better-known Look East policy and therefore as a regionally targeted engagement doctrine rather than an undifferentiated foreign-policy stance; the examinable value of the phrase is that it establishes West Asia as a named policy theatre with its own instruments, so a candidate can open an answer by classifying the region correctly instead of treating Gulf engagement as an appendix to a general foreign-policy narrative. B. Petroleum Planning and Analysis Cell data put India's crude-oil import dependence at eighty-eight point two per cent in the financial year 2024-25 and about eighty-eight point seven per cent provisional in the financial year 2025-26, while Sikri records the book-period figure at approximately seventy per cent; the owners require the current figure and its consumption-basis definition to be cited for any present-day claim and permit the book-period figure only as a historical baseline showing the direction of travel, so quoting approximately seventy per cent as a current number is treated as a factual error rather than a stylistic one. C. The Economic Survey 2025-26 records a notable increase in the diversity of countries from which India imports crude oil, with the United States share rising to eight point one per cent from four point six per cent and the United Arab Emirates share to eleven point one per cent from nine point four per cent in April to November of the financial year 2026, while Egypt, Nigeria and Libya also rose and Russia, Saudi Arabia, Iraq and Venezuela declined; the owners insist on the analytical separation that this is diversification of sources and not reduction of aggregate dependence, because equity stakes and a wider supplier base spread single-point-of-failure risk without lowering the share of consumption that must be imported. D. India recognised the State of Palestine in 1988 and continues to support a negotiated, sovereign, viable two-state solution alongside Israel, and after the October 2023 conflict began India condemned terrorism, called for humanitarian protection, release of hostages, dialogue and a two-state settlement while continuing relations with Israel and assistance to Palestinians; the owners require this to be presented as a single coherent position rather than as a contradiction, and they add the analytical warning that the conflict tests the corridor and minilateral frameworks by raising political, security and route-risk costs, so announced corridors and minilaterals must not be treated as insulated from regional war.

Answer: D. Explanation: India recognised the State of Palestine in 1988 and continues to support a negotiated, sovereign, viable two-state solution alongside Israel, and after the October 2023 conflict began India condemned terrorism, called for humanitarian protection, release of hostages, dialogue and a two-state settlement while continuing relations with Israel and assistance to Palestinians; the owners require this to be presented as a single coherent position rather than as a contradiction, and they add the analytical warning that the conflict tests the corridor and minilateral frameworks by raising political, security and route-risk costs, so announced corridors and minilaterals must not be treated as insulated from regional war. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies The energy trilemma as the correct evaluative frame?

A. The owners argue that India's West Asia policy is best evaluated through the energy trilemma of security, affordability and sustainability rather than through energy security alone, because supplier diversification, diaspora exposure and connectivity-framework design are all shaped by the same trade-offs between reliable supply, cost and long-term transition pressure; the practical consequence for a Mains answer is that a purely security-based frame misses affordability and transition considerations that can conflict with each other, and that triangular relationship management across the Gulf, Israel and Iran requires continuous diplomatic effort rather than a one-time policy declaration. B. Tharoor records that as far as the Arab world is concerned India is proud that it has a Look West policy too, which the owners treat as an explicit parallel to the better-known Look East policy and therefore as a regionally targeted engagement doctrine rather than an undifferentiated foreign-policy stance; the examinable value of the phrase is that it establishes West Asia as a named policy theatre with its own instruments, so a candidate can open an answer by classifying the region correctly instead of treating Gulf engagement as an appendix to a general foreign-policy narrative. C. This topic owns India's Look West engagement with the Gulf and the Arab world, the Israel and Iran tracks, energy security as the organising interest, Gulf diaspora welfare as a foreign-policy obligation, the Palestine position and the connectivity and minilateral frameworks of I2U2 and the India-Middle East-Europe

Economic Corridor, and its distinctive feature is that a single regional escalation can threaten energy supply, diaspora safety and connectivity viability at the same time; three verified General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2018 and 2025 and four objective demands from 2018, 2023 and 2026 are routed here, while oil-import-bill, pricing and tariff mechanics belong to the Economy owner, the minilateral classification of I2U2 belongs to topic 10, diaspora diplomacy in general belongs to topic 09, the Central Asian limb of Chabahar belongs to topic 05, and the humanitarian relief cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owners. D. The audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2018 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the depth and diversity of India's relations with Israel, a Discuss demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the printed word-limit tail was corrupted in the scan and that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, 2018 General Studies Paper II question 20 on the United States-Iran nuclear-pact controversy and India's national interest, an In what ways and How should demand of 15 marks and 250 words on the same superseding route, and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 19 on energy security and India's foreign policy in the Middle East, a Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words; four objective demands are also routed here and carried as coverage requirements only, namely 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 24 on the two-state solution in an international-affairs context, 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 37 on conflict-zone towns and their correct country matching, 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 94 on Israel, Arab states, diplomatic relations and the Arab Peace Initiative, for which the official 2018-2023 keys are not held locally, and 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 30 on the Strait of Hormuz and West Asian maritime access to the Indian Ocean, for which only a provisional 2026 Set-A key is present locally, and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for any of them.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners argue that India's West Asia policy is best evaluated through the energy trilemma of security, affordability and sustainability rather than through energy security alone, because supplier diversification, diaspora exposure and connectivity-framework design are all shaped by the same trade-offs between reliable supply, cost and long-term transition pressure; the practical consequence for a Mains answer is that a purely security-based frame misses affordability and transition considerations that can conflict with each other, and that triangular relationship management across the Gulf, Israel and Iran requires continuous diplomatic effort rather than a one-time policy declaration. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q74. Which card should be filed under The energy trilemma as the correct evaluative frame in an International Relations answer?

A. Tharoor records that as far as the Arab world is concerned India is proud that it has a Look West policy too, which the owners treat as an explicit parallel to the better-known Look East policy and therefore as a regionally targeted engagement doctrine rather than an undifferentiated foreign-policy stance; the examinable value of the phrase is that it establishes West Asia as a named policy theatre with its own instruments, so a candidate can open an answer by classifying the region correctly instead of treating Gulf engagement as an appendix to a general foreign-policy narrative. B. The owners argue that India's West Asia policy is best evaluated through the energy trilemma of security, affordability and sustainability rather than through energy security alone, because supplier diversification, diaspora exposure and connectivity-framework design are all shaped by the same trade-offs between reliable supply, cost and long-term transition pressure; the practical consequence for a Mains answer is that a purely security-based frame misses affordability and transition considerations that can conflict with each other, and that triangular relationship management across the Gulf, Israel and Iran requires continuous diplomatic effort rather than a one-time policy declaration. C. Petroleum Planning and Analysis Cell data put India's crude-oil import dependence at eighty-eight point two per cent in the financial year 2024-25 and about eighty-eight point seven per cent provisional in the financial year 2025-26, while Sikri records the book-period figure at approximately seventy per cent; the owners require the current figure and its consumption-basis definition to be cited for any present-day claim and permit the book-period figure only as a historical baseline showing the direction of travel, so quoting approximately seventy per cent as a current number is treated as a factual error rather than a stylistic one. D. This topic owns India's Look West engagement with the Gulf and the Arab world, the Israel and Iran tracks, energy security as the organising interest, Gulf diaspora welfare as a foreign-policy obligation, the Palestine position and the connectivity and minilateral frameworks of I2U2 and the India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor, and its distinctive feature is that a single regional escalation can threaten energy supply, diaspora safety and connectivity viability at the same time; three verified General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2018 and 2025 and four objective demands from 2018, 2023 and 2026 are routed here, while oil-import-bill, pricing and tariff mechanics belong to the Economy owner, the minilateral classification of I2U2 belongs to topic 10, diaspora diplomacy in general belongs to topic 09, the Central Asian limb of Chabahar belongs to topic 05, and the humanitarian relief cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owners.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners argue that India's West Asia policy is best evaluated through the energy trilemma of security, affordability and sustainability rather than through energy security alone, because supplier diversification, diaspora exposure and connectivity-framework design are all shaped by the same trade-offs between reliable supply, cost and long-term transition pressure; the practical consequence for a Mains answer is that a purely security-based frame misses affordability and transition considerations that can conflict with each other, and that triangular relationship management across the Gulf, Israel and Iran requires continuous diplomatic effort rather than a one-time policy declaration. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q75. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The energy trilemma as the correct evaluative frame?

A. Petroleum Planning and Analysis Cell data put India's crude-oil import dependence at eighty-eight point two per cent in the financial year 2024-25 and about eighty-eight point seven per cent provisional in the financial year 2025-26, while Sikri records the book-period figure at approximately seventy per cent; the owners require the current figure and its consumption-basis definition to be cited for any present-day claim and permit the book-period figure only as a historical baseline showing the direction of travel, so quoting approximately seventy per cent as a current number is treated as a factual error rather than a stylistic one. B. The Economic Survey 2025-26 records a notable increase in the diversity of countries from which India imports crude oil, with the United States share rising to eight point one per cent from four point six per cent and the United Arab Emirates share to eleven point one per cent from nine point four per cent in April to November of the financial year 2026, while Egypt, Nigeria and Libya also rose and Russia, Saudi Arabia, Iraq and Venezuela declined; the owners insist on the analytical separation that this is diversification of sources and not reduction of aggregate dependence, because equity stakes and a wider supplier base spread single-point-of-failure risk without lowering the share of consumption that must be imported. C. The owners argue that India's West Asia policy is best evaluated through the energy trilemma of security, affordability and sustainability rather than through energy security alone, because supplier diversification, diaspora exposure and connectivity-framework design are all shaped by the same trade-offs between reliable supply, cost and long-term transition pressure; the practical consequence for a Mains answer is that a purely security-based frame misses affordability and transition considerations that can conflict with each other, and that triangular relationship management across the Gulf, Israel and Iran requires continuous diplomatic effort rather than a one-time policy declaration. D. Tharoor records that as far as the Arab world is concerned India is proud that it has a Look West policy too, which the owners treat as an explicit parallel to the better-known Look East policy and therefore as a regionally targeted engagement doctrine rather than an undifferentiated foreign-policy stance; the examinable value of the phrase is that it establishes West Asia as a named policy theatre with its own instruments, so a candidate can open an answer by classifying the region correctly instead of treating Gulf engagement as an appendix to a general foreign-policy narrative.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners argue that India's West Asia policy is best evaluated through the energy trilemma of security, affordability and sustainability rather than through energy security alone, because supplier diversification, diaspora exposure and connectivity-framework design are all shaped by the same trade-offs between reliable supply, cost and long-term transition pressure; the practical consequence for a Mains answer is that a purely security-based frame misses affordability and transition considerations that can conflict with each other, and that triangular relationship management across the Gulf, Israel and Iran requires continuous diplomatic effort rather than a one-time policy declaration. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q76. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The energy trilemma as the correct evaluative frame?

A. Petroleum Planning and Analysis Cell data put India's crude-oil import dependence at eighty-eight point two per cent in the financial year 2024-25 and about eighty-eight point seven per cent provisional in the financial year 2025-26, while Sikri records the book-period figure at approximately seventy per cent; the owners require the current figure and its consumption-basis definition to be cited for any present-day claim and permit the book-period figure only as a historical baseline showing the direction of travel, so quoting approximately seventy per cent as a current number is treated as a factual error rather than a stylistic one. B. Tharoor notes that many Indian refineries are in fact devised to process the quality of crude oil that Iran supplies, and Sikri records the underlying policy response of making equity investments in oilfields abroad, so the owners treat configuration-specific refining capacity as a physical constraint on how quickly a supplier mix can actually change; the analytical payoff is that headline diversification percentages move slowly for engineering reasons rather than diplomatic ones, which is why a strategy answer must price switching cost instead of assuming that political intent translates immediately into a changed energy basket. C. The Economic Survey 2025-26 records a notable increase in the diversity of countries from which India imports crude oil, with the United States share rising to eight point one per cent from four point six per cent and the United Arab Emirates share to eleven point one per cent from nine point four per cent in April to November of the financial year 2026, while Egypt, Nigeria and Libya also rose and Russia, Saudi Arabia, Iraq and Venezuela declined; the owners insist on the analytical separation that this is diversification of sources and not reduction of aggregate dependence, because equity stakes and a wider supplier base spread single-point-of-failure risk without lowering the share of consumption that must be imported. D. The owners argue that India's West Asia policy is best evaluated through the energy trilemma of security, affordability and sustainability rather than through energy security alone, because supplier diversification, diaspora exposure and connectivity-framework design are all shaped by the same trade-offs between reliable supply, cost and long-term transition pressure; the practical consequence for a Mains answer is that a purely security-based frame misses affordability and transition considerations that can conflict with each other, and that triangular relationship management across the Gulf, Israel and Iran requires continuous diplomatic effort rather than a one-time policy declaration.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners argue that India's West Asia policy is best evaluated through the energy trilemma of security, affordability and sustainability rather than through energy security alone, because supplier diversification, diaspora exposure and connectivity-framework design are all shaped by the same trade-offs between reliable supply, cost and long-term transition pressure; the practical consequence for a Mains answer is that a purely security-based frame misses affordability and transition considerations that can conflict with each other, and that triangular relationship management across the Gulf, Israel and Iran requires continuous diplomatic effort rather than a one-time policy declaration. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Honest question ownership for this West Asian owner?

A. The audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2018 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the depth and diversity of India's relations with Israel, a Discuss demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the printed word-limit tail was corrupted in the scan and that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, 2018 General Studies Paper II question 20 on the United States-Iran nuclear-pact controversy and India's national interest, an In what ways and How should demand of 15 marks and 250 words on the same superseding route, and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 19 on energy security and India's foreign policy in the Middle East, a Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words; four objective demands are also routed here and carried as coverage requirements only, namely 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 24 on the two-state solution in an international-affairs context, 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 37 on conflict-zone towns and their correct country matching, 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 94 on Israel, Arab states, diplomatic relations and the Arab Peace Initiative, for which the official 2018-2023 keys are not held locally, and 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 30 on the Strait of Hormuz and West Asian maritime access to the Indian Ocean, for which only a provisional 2026 Set-A key is present locally, and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for any of them. B. Petroleum Planning and Analysis Cell data put India's crude-oil import dependence at eighty-eight point two per cent in the financial year 2024-25 and about eighty-eight point seven per cent provisional in the financial year 2025-26, while Sikri records the book-period figure at approximately seventy per cent; the owners require the current figure and its consumption-basis definition to be cited for any present-day claim and permit the book-period figure only as a historical baseline showing the direction of travel, so quoting approximately seventy per cent as a current number is treated as a factual error rather than a stylistic one. C. This topic owns India's Look West engagement with the Gulf and the Arab world, the Israel and Iran tracks, energy security as the organising interest, Gulf diaspora welfare as a foreign-policy obligation, the Palestine position and the connectivity and minilateral frameworks of I2U2 and the India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor, and its distinctive feature is that a single regional escalation can threaten energy supply, diaspora safety and connectivity viability at the same time; three verified General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2018 and 2025 and four objective demands from 2018, 2023 and 2026 are routed here, while oil-import-bill, pricing and tariff mechanics belong to the Economy owner, the minilateral classification of I2U2 belongs to topic 10, diaspora diplomacy in general belongs to topic 09, the Central Asian limb of Chabahar belongs to topic 05, and the humanitarian relief cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owners. D. Tharoor records that as far as the Arab world is concerned India is proud that it has a Look West policy too, which the owners treat as an explicit parallel to the better-known Look East policy and therefore as a regionally targeted engagement doctrine rather than an undifferentiated foreign-policy stance; the examinable value of the phrase is that it establishes West Asia as a named policy theatre with its own instruments, so a candidate can open an answer by classifying the region correctly instead of treating Gulf engagement as an appendix to a general foreign-policy narrative.

Answer: A. Explanation: The audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2018 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the depth and diversity of India's relations with Israel, a Discuss demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the printed word-limit tail was corrupted in the scan and that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, 2018 General Studies Paper II question 20 on the United States-Iran nuclear-pact controversy and India's national interest, an In what ways and How should demand of 15 marks and 250 words on the same superseding route, and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 19 on energy security and India's foreign policy in the Middle East, a Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words; four objective demands are also routed here and carried as coverage requirements only, namely 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 24 on the two-state solution in an international-affairs context, 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 37 on conflict-zone towns and their correct country matching, 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 94 on Israel, Arab states, diplomatic relations and the Arab Peace Initiative, for which the official 2018-2023 keys are not held locally, and 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 30 on the Strait of Hormuz and West Asian maritime access to the Indian Ocean, for which only a provisional 2026 Set-A key is present locally, and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for any of them. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q78. Which card should be filed under Honest question ownership for this West Asian owner in an International Relations answer?

A. The Economic Survey 2025-26 records a notable increase in the diversity of countries from which India imports crude oil, with the United States share rising to eight point one per cent from four point six per cent and the United Arab Emirates share to eleven point one per cent from nine point four per cent in April to November of the financial year 2026, while Egypt, Nigeria and Libya also rose and Russia, Saudi Arabia, Iraq and Venezuela declined; the owners insist on the analytical separation that this is diversification of sources and not reduction of aggregate dependence, because equity stakes and a wider supplier base spread single-point-of-failure risk without lowering the share of consumption that must be imported. B. The audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2018 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the depth and diversity of India's relations with Israel, a Discuss demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the printed word-limit tail was corrupted in the scan and that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, 2018 General Studies Paper II question 20 on the United States-Iran nuclear-pact controversy and India's national interest, an In what ways and How should demand of 15 marks and 250 words on the same superseding route, and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 19 on energy security and India's foreign policy in the Middle East, a Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words; four objective demands are also routed here and carried as coverage requirements only, namely 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 24 on the two-state solution in an international-affairs context, 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 37 on conflict-zone towns and their correct country matching, 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 94 on Israel, Arab states, diplomatic relations and the Arab Peace Initiative, for which the official 2018-2023 keys are not held locally, and 2026 Prelims

General Studies Paper I question 30 on the Strait of Hormuz and West Asian maritime access to the Indian Ocean, for which only a provisional 2026 Set-A key is present locally, and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for any of them. C. Tharoor records that as far as the Arab world is concerned India is proud that it has a Look West policy too, which the owners treat as an explicit parallel to the better-known Look East policy and therefore as a regionally targeted engagement doctrine rather than an undifferentiated foreign-policy stance; the examinable value of the phrase is that it establishes West Asia as a named policy theatre with its own instruments, so a candidate can open an answer by classifying the region correctly instead of treating Gulf engagement as an appendix to a general foreign-policy narrative. D. Petroleum Planning and Analysis Cell data put India's crude-oil import dependence at eighty-eight point two per cent in the financial year 2024-25 and about eighty-eight point seven per cent provisional in the financial year 2025-26, while Sikri records the book-period figure at approximately seventy per cent; the owners require the current figure and its consumption-basis definition to be cited for any present-day claim and permit the book-period figure only as a historical baseline showing the direction of travel, so quoting approximately seventy per cent as a current number is treated as a factual error rather than a stylistic one.

Answer: B. Explanation: The audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2018 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the depth and diversity of India's relations with Israel, a Discuss demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the printed word-limit tail was corrupted in the scan and that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, 2018 General Studies Paper II question 20 on the United States-Iran nuclear-pact controversy and India's national interest, an In what ways and How should demand of 15 marks and 250 words on the same superseding route, and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 19 on energy security and India's foreign policy in the Middle East, a Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words; four objective demands are also routed here and carried as coverage requirements only, namely 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 24 on the two-state solution in an international-affairs context, 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 37 on conflict-zone towns and their correct country matching, 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 94 on Israel, Arab states, diplomatic relations and the Arab Peace Initiative, for which the official 2018-2023 keys are not held locally, and 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 30 on the Strait of Hormuz and West Asian maritime access to the Indian Ocean, for which only a provisional 2026 Set-A key is present locally, and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for any of them. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Honest question ownership for this West Asian owner?

A. Tharoor notes that many Indian refineries are in fact devised to process the quality of crude oil that Iran supplies, and Sikri records the underlying policy response of making equity investments in oilfields abroad, so the owners treat configuration-specific refining capacity as a physical constraint on how quickly a supplier mix can actually change; the analytical payoff is that headline diversification percentages move slowly for engineering reasons rather than diplomatic ones, which is why a strategy answer must price switching cost instead of assuming that political intent translates immediately into a changed energy basket. B. The Economic Survey 2025-26 records a notable increase in the diversity of countries from which India imports crude oil, with the United States share rising to eight point one per cent from four point six per cent and the United Arab Emirates share to eleven point one per cent from nine point four per cent in April to November of the financial year 2026, while Egypt, Nigeria and Libya also rose and Russia, Saudi Arabia, Iraq and Venezuela declined; the owners insist on the analytical separation that this is diversification of sources and not reduction of aggregate dependence, because equity stakes and a wider supplier base spread single-point-of-failure risk without lowering the share of consumption that must be imported. C. The audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2018 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the depth and diversity of India's relations with Israel, a Discuss demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the printed word-limit tail was corrupted in the scan and that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, 2018 General Studies Paper II question 20 on the United States-Iran nuclear-pact controversy and India's national interest, an In what ways and How should demand of 15 marks and 250 words on the same superseding route, and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 19 on energy security and India's foreign policy in the Middle East, a Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words; four objective demands are also routed here and carried as coverage requirements only, namely 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 24 on the two-state solution in an international-affairs context, 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 37 on conflict-zone towns and their correct country matching, 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 94 on Israel, Arab states, diplomatic relations and the Arab Peace Initiative, for which the official 2018-2023 keys are not held locally, and 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 30 on the Strait of Hormuz and West Asian maritime access to the Indian Ocean, for which only a provisional 2026 Set-A key is present locally, and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for any of them. D. Petroleum Planning and Analysis Cell data put India's crude-oil import dependence at eighty-eight point two per cent in the financial year 2024-25 and about eighty-eight point seven per cent provisional in the financial year 2025-26, while Sikri records the book-period figure at approximately seventy per cent; the owners require the current figure and its consumption-basis definition to be cited for any present-day claim and permit the book-period figure only as a historical baseline showing the direction of travel, so quoting approximately seventy per cent as a current number is treated as a factual error rather than a stylistic one.

Answer: C. Explanation: The audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2018 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the depth and diversity of India's relations with Israel, a Discuss demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the printed word-limit tail was corrupted in the scan and that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, 2018 General Studies Paper II question 20 on the United States-Iran nuclear-pact controversy and India's national interest, an In what ways and How should demand of 15 marks and 250 words on the same superseding route, and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 19 on energy security and India's foreign policy in the Middle East, a Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words; four objective demands are also routed here and carried as coverage requirements only, namely 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 24 on the two-state solution in an international-affairs context, 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 37 on conflict-zone towns and their correct country matching, 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 94 on Israel, Arab states, diplomatic relations and the Arab Peace Initiative, for which the official 2018-2023 keys are not held locally, and 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 30 on the Strait of Hormuz and West Asian maritime access to the Indian Ocean, for which only a provisional 2026 Set-A key is present locally, and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for any of them. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Honest question ownership for this West Asian owner?

A. The Economic Survey 2025-26 records a notable increase in the diversity of countries from which India imports crude oil, with the United States share rising to eight point one per cent from four point six per cent and the United Arab Emirates share to eleven point one per cent from nine point four per cent in April to November of the financial year 2026, while Egypt, Nigeria and Libya also rose and Russia, Saudi Arabia, Iraq and Venezuela declined; the owners insist on the analytical separation that this is diversification of sources and not reduction of aggregate dependence, because equity stakes and a wider supplier base spread single-point-of-failure risk without lowering the share of consumption that must be imported. B. Sikri cites a diaspora of five million in the Gulf and Tharoor separately notes that the Arab world is home to nearly six million Indians, both period-specific, while the Ministry of External Affairs overseas-Indian population table as on January 2026 records four million three hundred and forty-four thousand and eight persons in the United Arab Emirates and two million seven hundred and fifty thousand five hundred and fifty-one in Saudi Arabia; the owners require these to be described as population-stock estimates rather than citizenship or Overseas Citizen of India counts, and they route remittance data to the Economy owner and general diaspora diplomacy to topic 09. C. Tharoor notes that many Indian refineries are in fact devised to process the quality of crude oil that Iran supplies, and Sikri records the underlying policy response of making equity investments in oilfields abroad, so the owners treat configuration-specific refining capacity as a physical constraint on how quickly a supplier mix can actually change; the analytical payoff is that headline diversification percentages move slowly for engineering reasons rather than diplomatic ones, which is why a strategy answer must price switching cost instead of assuming that political intent translates immediately into a changed energy basket. D. The audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2018 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the depth and diversity of India's relations with Israel, a Discuss demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the printed word-limit tail was corrupted in the scan and that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, 2018 General Studies Paper II question 20 on the United States-Iran nuclear-pact controversy and India's national interest, an In what ways and How should demand of 15 marks and 250 words on the same superseding route, and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 19 on energy security and India's foreign policy in the

Middle East, a Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words; four objective demands are also routed here and carried as coverage requirements only, namely 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 24 on the two-state solution in an international-affairs context, 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 37 on conflict-zone towns and their correct country matching, 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 94 on Israel, Arab states, diplomatic relations and the Arab Peace Initiative, for which the official 2018-2023 keys are not held locally, and 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 30 on the Strait of Hormuz and West Asian maritime access to the Indian Ocean, for which only a provisional 2026 Set-A key is present locally, and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for any of them.

Answer: D. Explanation: The audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2018 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the depth and diversity of India's relations with Israel, a Discuss demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the printed word-limit tail was corrupted in the scan and that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, 2018 General Studies Paper II question 20 on the United States-Iran nuclear-pact controversy and India's national interest, an In what ways and How should demand of 15 marks and 250 words on the same superseding route, and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 19 on energy security and India's foreign policy in the Middle East, a Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words; four objective demands are also routed here and carried as coverage requirements only, namely 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 24 on the two-state solution in an international-affairs context, 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 37 on conflict-zone towns and their correct country matching, 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 94 on Israel, Arab states, diplomatic relations and the Arab Peace Initiative, for which the official 2018-2023 keys are not held locally, and 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 30 on the Strait of Hormuz and West Asian maritime access to the Indian Ocean, for which only a provisional 2026 Set-A key is present locally, and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for any of them. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT

Three General Studies Paper II Mains demands are routed to this topic in the audited routing ledgers and each is reproduced below as a demand card with its printed year, paper, question number, directive, marks and word limit exactly as the ledger records them: 2018 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the depth and diversity of India's relations with Israel, a Discuss demand of 10 marks and 150 words, for which the ledger records that the printed word-limit tail was corrupted in the scan and that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership; 2018 General Studies Paper II question 20 on the United States-Iran nuclear-pact controversy and India's national interest, an In what ways and How should demand of 15 marks and 250 words on the same superseding route; and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 19 on energy security and India's foreign policy in the Middle East, a Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words. Four objective demands are also routed to this owner and are carried as coverage requirements only: 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 24 on the two-state solution in an international-affairs context, 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 37 on conflict-zone towns and their correct country matching, and 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 94 on Israel, Arab states, diplomatic relations and the Arab Peace Initiative, for which the official 2018-2023 Prelims keys are not held locally; and 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 30 on the Strait of Hormuz and West Asian maritime access to the Indian Ocean, for which only a provisional 2026 Set-A key is present locally and its provisional status is preserved exactly. No option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for any of the four objective demands. Where a printed word limit or stem tail is recorded as corrupted in the scan, that defect is reported rather than silently repaired by invented wording. The locally held OCR-searchable official General Studies papers were read only to confirm the printed wording of the routed Mains demands; no question was invented from them, no stem was paraphrased into an apparent routing, and no marking scheme or official answer key was imported.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

9. PYQ application

- FACT: **2022 GS-II I2U2 cross-route:** "How will I2U2 (India, Israel, UAE

and USA) grouping transform India's position in global politics?" Use this file for West-Asia, investment, food/energy and connectivity dimensions; topic `10` owns minilateral classification.

- FACT: **2025 Q19 (direct):** *"Energy security constitutes the dominant kingpin of

India's foreign policy, and is linked with India's overarching influence in Middle Eastern countries." How would you integrate energy security with India's foreign policy trajectories in the coming years?* Structure: (1) state the 88.2% FY2024-25 / roughly 88.7% provisional FY2025-26 baseline (PPAC) and the direction of travel since Sikri's ~70%; (2) cite the equity-investment and supplier-diversification strategy; (3) cite the India-GCC Joint Action Plan (2024-2028, adopted Riyadh, 9 September 2024) and I2U2/IMEEC as integration mechanisms; (4) balance this against the Israel-Arab-Iran triangular relationship and the diaspora- protection obligation (Operation Sindhu, June 2025); (5) avoid predicting specific future oil-price or corridor outcomes.

2026 PYQ Integration

> **Status:** 2026 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: `_PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2026.md`. **Answer-key rule:** The 2026 Prelims and CSAT Set-A keys held locally are **provisional**; no option or answer is recorded or inferred in this integration.

- **Year represented:** 2026
- **Paper(s):** Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2026	Prelims GS-I	30	Strait of Hormuz and West Asian maritime access to Indian Ocean	Objective question; provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally, answer not inferred	Provisional 2026 Set-A key present locally (`Ans-■2026-■GS1-■Provisional`); key is provisional - no answer letter recorded or inferred here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Strait of Hormuz and West Asian maritime access to Indian Ocean

> This block integrates the 2026 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 and 2024-2025 blocks and does not convert a provisionally-keyed, answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

> **Status:** 2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: `_PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2024-2025.md`.

- **Years represented:** 2025
- **Paper(s):** GS-II
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2025	GS-II	19	Energy security and India's foreign policy in the Middle East	Discuss · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Energy security and India's foreign policy in the Middle East

> This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

> **Status:** Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: `_PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md`, `_PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2018-2023.md`. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2018-2023 Prelims/CSAT keys are not held locally; no option or answer has been inferred.

- **Years represented:** 2018, 2023
- **Paper(s):** GS-II, Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 5

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	GS-II	9	Depth and diversity of India's relations with Israel	Discuss · 10 marks · 150 words	Core route supersedes older Advanced ownership	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2018	GS-II	20	US-Iran nuclear pact controversy and India's national interest	In what ways and How should · 15 marks · 250 words	Core route supersedes older Advanced ownership	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2018	Prelims GS-I	24	Two-state solution in international affairs context	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2018	Prelims GS-I	37	Conflict zone towns and their correct country matching	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2023	Prelims GS-I	94	Israel Arab states diplomatic relations Arab Peace Initiative	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Depth and diversity of India's relations with Israel
- US-Iran nuclear pact controversy and India's national interest
- Two-state solution in international affairs context
- Conflict zone towns and their correct country matching
- Israel Arab states diplomatic relations Arab Peace Initiative

> The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- FACT: **2022 I2U2 cross-route:** assess the minilateral's effect on India's

West-Asia position through capital, technology, food/energy projects and strategic-autonomy constraints; topic `10` owns the grouping comparison.

- FACT: **2025 Q19 (direct):** *"Energy security constitutes the dominant kingpin of
India's foreign policy, and is linked with India's overarching influence in Middle Eastern countries." How would you integrate energy security with India's foreign policy trajectories in the coming years?* An advanced answer should:

1. Apply the energy trilemma (security, affordability, sustainability)
rather than security alone.

2. Cite the 88.2% FY2024-25 / about 88.7% provisional FY2025-26 import-dependence baseline (PPAC) against Sikri's
book-period ~70%, and the equity-investment and supplier-diversification response documented in the Economic Survey 2025-26.

3. Unpack "overarching influence" into diaspora diplomacy (Operation Sindhu,
June 2025), Israel technology partnership, and connectivity frameworks (I2U2, IMEEC, GCC Joint Action Plan 2024-2028).

4. Flag regional-conflict spillover risk as a compounding factor requiring
continuous diplomatic management, without predicting a specific future event.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

> **Status:** Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: `_PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md`.

- **Years represented:** 2018
- **Paper(s):** GS-II
- **Routed question demands:** 2

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	GS-II	9	Depth and diversity of India's relations with Israel	Discuss · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic; printed word-limit tail OCR-corrupted in scan	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2018	GS-II	20	US-Iran nuclear pact controversy and India's national interest	In what ways and How should · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Depth and diversity of India's relations with Israel
- US-Iran nuclear pact controversy and India's national interest

> The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2018 General Studies Paper II Question 9

Demand: The depth and diversity of India's relations with Israel, a Discuss demand of 10 marks and 150 words, exactly as recorded in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger. The ledger records that the printed word-limit tail was corrupted in the scan, and that defect is reported here rather than repaired by invented wording.

Status: Routed to this owner in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger, where the Core route is recorded as superseding the older Advanced ownership. No official answer key exists for a Mains demand and none is claimed, and no reconstruction of the corrupted word-limit tail is attempted.

Model solution: Claim: the relationship is deep because it moved from limited, low-visibility contact to open political engagement, and diverse because it now runs simultaneously through defence, agriculture, innovation and minilateral channels rather than through arms transfer alone. Named evidence and example: the establishment of full diplomatic relations in 1992 and the first visit by an Indian Prime Minister to Israel in July 2017 as the political upgrade; defence procurement, counter-terrorism and co-development with the Barak-8 air-defence system as the named joint development; the Indo-Israel Agricultural Project operating Centres of Excellence for protected cultivation, irrigation and post-harvest practices; the India-Israel Industrial Research and Development and Technological Innovation Fund launched in 2017; and the extension of the relationship into I2U2 with the United Arab Emirates and the United States across food security, water, energy and technology. Analysis: each domain answers a different Indian need, since defence cooperation supplies specialised technology and rapid capability acquisition, the agricultural centres convert diplomacy into farm-level technology demonstration, the innovation fund diversifies the relationship into civilian industrial research, and the minilateral extension shows the bilateral tie operating inside a wider regional format; the diversity itself is the evidence of depth, because a single-domain relationship would not survive the political sensitivities that surround this one. Qualification: the discussion must not overstate any limb, because import dependence, cost and technology-transfer depth remain live issues, demonstration centres require local extension, affordability and scaling before they affect wider productivity, funded projects must be distinguished from announced cooperation, no four-party I2U2 meeting or outcome in 2024 to 2026 could be verified from official sources, and the whole relationship is pursued, in Tharoor's words, not at the expense of India's friendships with Arab and other Muslim states. Why this earns marks: it evidences both words of the directive with named, dated instruments across four domains and closes on the balancing principle that keeps the relationship politically sustainable.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2018 General Studies Paper II Question 9", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: the relationship is deep because it moved from limited, low-visibility contact to open political engagement, and diverse because it now runs simultaneously through defence, agriculture, innovation and minilateral channels rather than through arms transfer alone. Named evidence and example: the establishment of full diplomatic relations in 1992 and the first visit by an Indian Prime Minister to Israel in July 2017 as the political upgrade; defence procurement, counter-terrorism and co-development with the Barak-8 air-defence system as the named joint development; the Indo-Israel Agricultural Project operating Centres of Excellence for protected cultivation, irrigation and post-harvest practices; the India-Israel Industrial Research and Development and Technological Innovation Fund launched in 2017; and the extension of the relationship into I2U2 with the United Arab Emirates and the United States across food security, water, energy and technology. Analysis: each domain answers a different Indian need, since defence cooperation supplies specialised technology and rapid capability acquisition, the agricultural centres convert diplomacy into farm-level technology demonstration, the innovation fund diversifies the relationship into civilian industrial research, and the minilateral extension shows the bilateral tie operating inside a wider regional format; the diversity itself is the evidence of depth, because a single-domain relationship would not survive the political sensitivities that surround this one. Qualification: the discussion must not overstate any limb, because import dependence, cost and technology-transfer depth remain live issues, demonstration centres require local extension, affordability and scaling before they affect wider productivity, funded projects must be distinguished from announced cooperation, no four-party I2U2 meeting or outcome in 2024 to 2026 could be verified from official sources, and the whole relationship is pursued, in Tharoor's words, not at the expense of India's friendships with Arab and other Muslim states. Why this earns marks: it evidences both words of the directive with named, dated instruments across four domains and closes on the balancing principle that keeps the relationship politically sustainable.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2018 General Studies Paper II Question 9 **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: the relationship is deep because it moved from limited, low-visibility contact to open political engagement, and diverse because it now runs simultaneously through defence, agriculture, innovation and minilateral channels rather than through arms transfer alone. Named evidence and example: the establishment of full diplomatic relations in 1992 and the first visit by an Indian Prime Minister to Israel in July 2017 as the political upgrade; defence procurement, counter-terrorism and co-development with the Barak-8 air-defence system as the named joint development; the Indo-Israel Agricultural Project operating Centres of Excellence for protected cultivation, irrigation and post-harvest practices; the India-Israel Industrial Research and Development and Technological Innovation Fund launched in 2017; and the extension of the relationship into I2U2 with the United Arab Emirates and the United States across food security, water, energy and technology. Analysis: each domain answers a different Indian need, since defence cooperation supplies specialised technology and rapid capability acquisition, the agricultural centres convert diplomacy into farm-level technology demonstration, the innovation fund diversifies the relationship into civilian industrial research, and the minilateral extension shows the bilateral tie operating inside a wider regional format; the diversity itself is the evidence of depth, because a single-domain relationship would not survive the political sensitivities that surround this one. Qualification: the discussion must not overstate any limb, because import dependence, cost and technology-transfer depth remain live issues, demonstration centres require local extension, affordability and scaling before they affect wider productivity, funded projects must be distinguished from announced cooperation, no four-party I2U2 meeting or outcome in 2024 to 2026 could be verified from official sources, and the whole relationship is pursued, in Tharoor's words, not at the expense of India's friendships with Arab and other Muslim states. Why this earns marks: it evidences both words of the directive with named, dated instruments across four domains and closes on the balancing principle that keeps the relationship politically sustainable.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2018 General Studies Paper II Question 9", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2018 General Studies Paper II Question 20

Demand: The United States-Iran nuclear-pact controversy and India's national interest, an In what ways and How should demand of 15 marks and 250 words, exactly as recorded in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger.

Status: Routed to this owner in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger, where the Core route is recorded as superseding the older Advanced ownership. No official answer key exists for a Mains demand and none is claimed.

Model solution: Claim: the controversy reaches India through transmission rather than through obligation, so the ways in which it affects national interest are supply, finance and connectivity channels, and the response should be to protect specific carve-outs while treating every exception as reversible. Named evidence and example: the Joint Comprehensive Plan of Action concluded on 14 July 2015 between Iran and the E3 and European Union plus three grouping and endorsed by United Nations Security Council resolution 2231; the United States announcement of withdrawal on 8 May 2018 followed by sanctions restored in stages; the end of United States Significant Reduction Exceptions in May 2019, after which India ceased Iranian crude purchases and substituted other suppliers; Tharoor's observations that Iran's oil and natural gas have been increasingly important for India for decades, that many Indian refineries are in fact devised to process the quality of crude oil that Iran supplies, and that India is anxious to avoid Iran becoming an irritant in its strengthening relations with the United States; and the ten-year Chabahar contract of 13 May 2024 set against revocation of the 2018 exception with effect from 29 September 2025. Analysis: the transmission runs through three channels at once, since renewed sanctions exposed Indian oil, banking, insurance and project channels to third-country pressure, refinery configuration made substitution physically costly rather than merely inconvenient, and the connectivity investment that gave India a Pakistan-bypassing route became a financing and exposure question instead of a geographic one; the Chabahar sequence is therefore the clearest available demonstration both that India can pursue a national-interest carve-out amid confrontation and that such a carve-out sits at the pleasure of another state's executive. Qualification: the answer must not describe the Plan as normally functioning, because following the E3 snapback action in 2025 the status of restored United Nations measures is disputed by Iran, Russia and China; it must not convert third-country sanctions exposure into an international legal obligation on India; and it must record that supplier substitution reduced immediate exposure while narrowing the Iran relationship and leaving aggregate import dependence undiminished. Why this earns marks: it answers both limbs of the directive, traces a mechanism through three named channels with dates, and states the reversibility of a carve-out instead of presenting it as a settled Indian gain.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2018 General Studies Paper II Question 20", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: the controversy reaches India through transmission rather than through obligation, so the ways in which it affects national interest are supply, finance and connectivity channels, and the response should be to protect specific carve-outs while treating every exception as reversible. Named evidence and example: the Joint Comprehensive Plan of Action concluded on 14 July 2015 between Iran and the E3 and European Union plus three grouping and endorsed by United Nations Security Council resolution 2231; the United States announcement of withdrawal on 8 May 2018 followed by sanctions restored in stages; the end of United States Significant Reduction Exceptions in May 2019, after which India ceased Iranian crude purchases and substituted other suppliers; Tharoor's observations that Iran's oil and natural gas have been increasingly important for India for decades, that many Indian refineries are in fact devised to process the quality of crude oil that Iran supplies, and that India is anxious to avoid Iran becoming an irritant in its strengthening relations with the United States; and the ten-year Chabahar contract of 13 May 2024 set against revocation of the 2018 exception with effect from 29 September 2025. Analysis: the transmission runs through three channels at once, since renewed sanctions exposed Indian oil, banking, insurance and project channels to third-country pressure, refinery configuration made substitution physically costly rather than merely inconvenient, and the connectivity investment that gave India a Pakistan-bypassing route became a financing and exposure question instead of a geographic one; the Chabahar sequence is therefore the clearest available demonstration both that India can pursue a national-interest carve-out amid confrontation and that such a carve-out sits at the pleasure of another state's executive. Qualification: the answer must not describe the Plan as normally functioning, because following the E3 snapback action in 2025 the status of restored United Nations measures is disputed by Iran, Russia and China; it must not convert third-country sanctions exposure into an international legal obligation on India; and it must record that supplier substitution reduced immediate exposure while narrowing the Iran relationship and leaving aggregate import dependence undiminished. Why this earns marks: it answers both limbs of the directive, traces a mechanism through three named channels with dates, and states the reversibility of a carve-out instead of presenting it as a settled Indian gain.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2018 General Studies Paper II Question 20 **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: The United States-Iran nuclear-pact controversy and India's national interest, an In what ways and How should demand of 15 marks and 250 words, exactly as recorded in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: the controversy reaches India through transmission rather than through obligation, so the ways in which it affects national interest are supply, finance and connectivity channels, and the response should be to protect specific carve-outs while treating every exception as reversible. Named evidence and example: the Joint Comprehensive Plan of Action concluded on 14 July 2015 between Iran and the E3 and European Union plus three grouping and endorsed by United Nations Security Council resolution 2231; the United States announcement of withdrawal on 8 May 2018 followed by sanctions restored in stages; the end of United States Significant Reduction Exceptions in May 2019, after which India ceased Iranian crude purchases and substituted other suppliers; Tharoor's observations that Iran's oil and natural gas have been increasingly important for India for decades, that many Indian refineries are in fact devised to process the quality of crude oil that Iran supplies, and that India is anxious to avoid Iran becoming an irritant in its strengthening relations with the United States; and the ten-year Chabahar contract of 13 May 2024 set against revocation of the 2018 exception with effect from 29 September 2025. Analysis: the transmission runs through three channels at once, since renewed sanctions exposed Indian oil, banking, insurance and project channels to third-country pressure, refinery configuration made substitution physically costly rather than merely inconvenient, and the connectivity investment that gave India a Pakistan-bypassing route became a financing and exposure question instead of a geographic one; the Chabahar sequence is therefore the clearest available demonstration both that India can pursue a national-interest carve-out amid confrontation and that such a carve-out sits at the pleasure of another state's executive. Qualification: the answer must not describe the Plan as normally functioning, because following the E3 snapback action in 2025 the status of restored United Nations measures is disputed by Iran, Russia and China; it must not convert third-country sanctions exposure into an international legal obligation on India; and it must record that supplier substitution reduced immediate exposure while narrowing the Iran relationship and leaving aggregate import dependence undiminished. Why this earns marks: it answers both limbs of the directive, traces a mechanism through three named channels with dates, and states the reversibility of a carve-out instead of presenting it as a settled Indian gain.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2018 General Studies Paper II Question 20", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2025 General Studies Paper II Question 19

Demand: Energy security constitutes the dominant kingpin of India's foreign policy, and is linked with India's overarching influence in Middle Eastern countries. How would you integrate energy security with India's foreign policy trajectories in the coming years? A Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words, exactly as recorded in the audited 2024-2025 Mains routing ledger.

Status: Routed to this owner in the audited 2024-2025 Mains routing ledger and reproduced in the Basic owner as the anchor demand for this topic. No official answer key exists for a Mains demand and none is claimed.

Model solution: Claim: energy security is indeed the organising interest, but integrating it with foreign-policy trajectories requires the energy trilemma rather than a supply-only frame, and requires unpacking influence into diaspora, technology and connectivity limbs that a purchase relationship alone cannot deliver. Named evidence and example: Petroleum Planning and Analysis Cell figures of eighty-eight point two per cent crude-oil import dependence in the financial year 2024-25 and about eighty-eight point seven per cent provisional in the financial year 2025-26 against Sikri's book-period approximately seventy per cent; the equity-investment strategy in overseas oilfields together with the Economic Survey 2025-26 record of the United States share rising to eight point one per cent from four point six per cent and the United Arab Emirates share to eleven point one per cent from nine point four per cent in April to November of the financial year 2026; the India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Action Plan for 2024-2028 adopted at Riyadh on 9 September 2024, the second India-Saudi Arabia Strategic Partnership Council at Jeddah on 22 April 2025 and the India-Qatar Agreement on Establishment of a Bilateral Strategic Partnership of 18 February 2025; the India-United Arab Emirates Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement in force since 1 May 2022 with officially reported bilateral trade of approximately one hundred billion United States dollars in the financial year 2024-25 and the India-Oman agreement signed on 18 December 2025; the I2U2 framework and the India-Middle

East-Europe Economic Corridor memorandum of 9 September 2023; and Operation Sindhu, which evacuated four thousand four hundred and fifteen Indians from Iran and Israel by 27 June 2025. Analysis: integration works by matching each limb of the trilemma to an instrument, since diversification and equity stakes serve supply security, dated institutional frameworks convert transactional purchase into strategic dialogue that supports affordability and predictability, corridor and minilateral participation extends the relationship into logistics and technology so that energy is not the only currency of influence, and the standing consular obligation demonstrated by Operation Sindhu is what makes influence reciprocal rather than merely extractive; the Israel technology partnership and the Gulf energy relationship reinforce each other only because India pursues them in parallel under the balancing principle. Qualification: the answer must concede that diversification of sources is not reduction of aggregate dependence, that refinery configuration slows any basket change, that the corridor memorandum is a framework of intent with no completed or operating segment officially established, that no four-party I2U2 meeting or outcome in 2024 to 2026 could be verified from official sources, that a single escalation at the Strait of Hormuz can hit energy, diaspora and connectivity together, and that no specific future oil price, corridor completion or conflict outcome may be predicted. Why this earns marks: it answers the integration question with a named frame and matched instruments, dates every claim, and closes with disciplined refusals instead of forecasting.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2025 General Studies Paper II Question 19", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: energy security is indeed the organising interest, but integrating it with foreign-policy trajectories requires the energy trilemma rather than a supply-only frame, and requires unpacking influence into diaspora, technology and connectivity limbs that a purchase relationship alone cannot deliver. Named evidence and example: Petroleum Planning and Analysis Cell figures of eighty-eight point two per cent crude-oil import dependence in the financial year 2024-25 and about eighty-eight point seven per cent provisional in the financial year 2025-26 against Sikri's book-period approximately seventy per cent; the equity-investment strategy in overseas oilfields together with the Economic Survey 2025-26 record of the United States share rising to eight point one per cent from four point six per cent and the United Arab Emirates share to eleven point one per cent from nine point four per cent in April to November of the financial year 2026; the India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Action Plan for 2024-2028 adopted at Riyadh on 9 September 2024, the second India-Saudi Arabia Strategic Partnership Council at Jeddah on 22 April 2025 and the India-Qatar Agreement on Establishment of a Bilateral Strategic Partnership of 18 February 2025; the India-United Arab Emirates Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement in force since 1 May 2022 with officially reported bilateral trade of approximately one hundred billion United States dollars in the financial year 2024-25 and the India-Oman agreement signed on 18 December 2025; the I2U2 framework and the India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor memorandum of 9 September 2023; and Operation Sindhu, which evacuated four thousand four hundred and fifteen Indians from Iran and Israel by 27 June 2025. Analysis: integration works by matching each limb of the trilemma to an instrument, since diversification and equity stakes serve supply security, dated institutional frameworks convert transactional purchase into strategic dialogue that supports affordability and predictability, corridor and minilateral participation extends the relationship into logistics and technology so that energy is not the only currency of influence, and the standing consular obligation demonstrated by Operation Sindhu is what makes influence reciprocal rather than merely extractive; the Israel technology partnership and the Gulf energy relationship reinforce each other only because India pursues them in parallel under the balancing principle. Qualification: the answer must concede that diversification of sources is not reduction of aggregate dependence, that refinery configuration slows any basket change, that the corridor memorandum is a framework of intent with no completed or operating segment officially established, that no four-party I2U2 meeting or outcome in 2024 to 2026 could be verified from official sources, that a single escalation at the Strait of Hormuz can hit energy, diaspora and connectivity together, and that no specific future oil price, corridor completion or conflict outcome may be predicted. Why this earns marks: it answers the integration question with a named frame and matched instruments, dates every claim, and closes with disciplined refusals instead of forecasting.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2025 General Studies Paper II Question 19 **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument ->

implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

2. **Claim and named evidence:** Status: Routed to this owner in the audited 2024-2025 Mains routing ledger and reproduced in the Basic owner as the anchor demand for this topic. No official answer key exists for a Mains demand and none is claimed. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: energy security is indeed the organising interest, but integrating it with foreign-policy trajectories requires the energy trilemma rather than a supply-only frame, and requires unpacking influence into diaspora, technology and connectivity limbs that a purchase relationship alone cannot deliver. Named evidence and example: Petroleum Planning and Analysis Cell figures of eighty-eight point two per cent crude-oil import dependence in the financial year 2024-25 and about eighty-eight point seven per cent provisional in the financial year 2025-26 against Sikri's book-period approximately seventy per cent; the equity-investment strategy in overseas oilfields together with the Economic Survey 2025-26 record of the United States share rising to eight point one per cent from four point six per cent and the United Arab Emirates share to eleven point one per cent from nine point four per cent in April to November of the financial year 2026; the India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Action Plan for 2024-2028 adopted at Riyadh on 9 September 2024, the second India-Saudi Arabia Strategic Partnership Council at Jeddah on 22 April 2025 and the India-Qatar Agreement on Establishment of a Bilateral Strategic Partnership of 18 February 2025; the India-United Arab Emirates Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement in force since 1 May 2022 with officially reported bilateral trade of approximately one hundred billion United States dollars in the financial year 2024-25 and the India-Oman agreement signed on 18 December 2025; the I2U2 framework and the India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor memorandum of 9 September 2023; and Operation Sindhu, which evacuated four thousand four hundred and fifteen Indians from Iran and Israel by 27 June 2025. Analysis: integration works by matching each limb of the trilemma to an instrument, since diversification and equity stakes serve supply security, dated institutional frameworks convert transactional purchase into strategic dialogue that supports affordability and predictability, corridor and minilateral participation extends the relationship into logistics and technology so that energy is not the only currency of influence, and the standing consular obligation demonstrated by Operation Sindhu is what makes influence reciprocal rather than merely extractive; the Israel technology partnership and the Gulf energy relationship reinforce each other only because India pursues them in parallel under the balancing principle. Qualification: the answer must concede that diversification of sources is not reduction of aggregate dependence, that refinery configuration slows any basket change, that the corridor memorandum is a framework of intent with no completed or operating segment officially established, that no four-party I2U2 meeting or outcome in 2024 to 2026 could be verified from official sources, that a single escalation at the Strait of Hormuz can hit energy, diaspora and connectivity together, and that no specific future oil price, corridor completion or conflict outcome may be predicted. Why this earns marks: it answers the integration question with a named frame and matched instruments, dates every claim, and closes with disciplined refusals instead of forecasting.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2025 General Studies Paper II Question 19", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Explain why supplier diversification has not reduced India's aggregate crude-oil import dependence. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Diversification and dependence are different variables, so the answer must set the current dependence figure against the book-period baseline, use the recorded shifts in supplier shares as the evidence of diversification, and close on refinery configuration as the physical reason the basket changes slowly.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Petroleum Planning and Analysis Cell data put India's crude-oil import dependence at eighty-eight point two per cent in the financial year 2024-25 and about eighty-eight point seven per cent provisional in the financial year 2025-26, while Sikri records the book-period figure at approximately seventy per cent; the owners require the current figure and its consumption-basis definition to be cited for any present-day claim and permit the book-period figure only as a historical baseline showing the direction of travel, so quoting approximately seventy per cent as a current number is treated as a factual error rather than a stylistic one.
- The Economic Survey 2025-26 records a notable increase in the diversity of countries from which India imports crude oil, with the United States share rising to eight point one per cent from four point six per cent and the United Arab Emirates share to eleven point one per cent from nine point four per cent in April to November of the financial year 2026, while Egypt, Nigeria and Libya also rose and Russia, Saudi Arabia, Iraq and Venezuela declined; the owners insist on the analytical separation that this is diversification of sources and not reduction of aggregate dependence, because equity stakes and a wider supplier base spread single-point-of-failure risk without lowering the share of consumption that must be imported.
- Tharoor notes that many Indian refineries are in fact devised to process the quality of crude oil that Iran supplies, and Sikri records the underlying policy response of making equity investments in oilfields abroad, so the owners treat configuration-specific refining capacity as a physical constraint on how quickly a supplier mix can actually change; the analytical payoff is that headline diversification percentages move slowly for engineering reasons rather than diplomatic ones, which is why a strategy answer must price switching cost instead of assuming that political intent translates immediately into a changed energy basket.
- The Strait of Hormuz is the narrow outlet from the Persian Gulf to the Gulf of Oman and is the principal route-risk chokepoint for Gulf energy shipments, so disruption there can transmit immediately into freight, insurance and supply insecurity for India, and the owners add the qualification that supplier diversification does not eliminate common-route exposure while strategic reserves and alternative energy reduce but do not remove the risk; the wider structural point is that West Asian risk is compounding rather than isolated, because one escalation can threaten energy-supply continuity, diaspora physical safety and connectivity-project viability at the same time.

Qualified conclusion: Diversification and dependence are different variables, so the answer must set the current dependence figure against the book-period baseline, use the recorded shifts in supplier shares as the evidence of diversification, and close on refinery configuration as the physical reason the basket changes slowly.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on "Explain why supplier diversification has not reduced India's aggregate crude-oil import...", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Diversification and dependence are different variables, so the answer must set the current dependence figure against the book-period baseline, use the recorded shifts in supplier shares as the evidence of diversification, and close on refinery configuration as the physical reason the basket changes slowly.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Petroleum Planning and Analysis Cell data put India's crude-oil import dependence at eighty-eight point two per cent in the financial year 2024-25 and about eighty-eight point seven per cent provisional in the financial year 2025-26, while Sikri records the book-period figure at approximately seventy per cent; the owners require the current figure and its consumption-basis definition to be cited for any present-day claim and permit the book-period figure only as a historical baseline showing the direction of travel, so quoting approximately seventy per cent as a current number is treated as a factual error rather than a stylistic one.

Analysis: Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

2. **Claim and named evidence:** The Economic Survey 2025-26 records a notable increase in the diversity of countries from which India imports crude oil, with the United States share rising to eight point one per cent from four point six per cent and the United Arab Emirates share to eleven point one per cent from nine point four per cent in April to November of the financial year 2026, while Egypt, Nigeria and Libya also rose and Russia, Saudi Arabia, Iraq and Venezuela declined; the owners insist on the analytical separation that this is diversification of sources and not reduction of aggregate dependence, because equity stakes and a wider supplier base spread single-point-of-failure risk without lowering the share of consumption that must be imported. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Tharoor notes that many Indian refineries are in fact devised to process the quality of crude oil that Iran supplies, and Sikri records the underlying policy response of making equity investments in oilfields abroad, so the owners treat configuration-specific refining capacity as a physical constraint on how quickly a supplier mix can actually change; the analytical payoff is that headline diversification percentages move slowly for engineering reasons rather than diplomatic ones, which is why a strategy answer must price switching cost instead of assuming that political intent translates immediately into a changed energy basket. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The Strait of Hormuz is the narrow outlet from the Persian Gulf to the Gulf of Oman and is the principal route-risk chokepoint for Gulf energy shipments, so disruption there can transmit immediately into freight, insurance and supply insecurity for India, and the owners add the qualification that supplier diversification does not eliminate common-route exposure while strategic reserves and alternative energy reduce but do not remove the risk; the wider structural point is that West Asian risk is compounding rather than isolated, because one escalation can threaten energy-supply continuity, diaspora physical safety and connectivity-project viability at the same time. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Diversification and dependence are different variables, so the answer must set the current dependence figure against the book-period baseline, use the recorded shifts in supplier shares as the evidence of diversification, and close on refinery configuration as the physical reason the basket changes slowly.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains strategy and implementation rather than listing visits or groupings, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves institutional, status, level, causal and geopolitical distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Explain why supplier diversification has not reduced India's aggregate crude-oil import...", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Comment on the proposition that India's deepening partnership with Israel has come at the expense of its Gulf and Arab relationships. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: The proposition fails against the explicit source statement and against the dated Gulf architecture, so the comment must quote the balancing principle, evidence both tracks with dated instruments, and describe the posture as active balancing rather than equidistance or a choice.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Tharoor states that India values its relationship with Israel, but not at the expense of its friendships with Arab and other Muslim states, which is the explicit textual anchor for every balancing argument in this topic, and the owners sharpen it into active balancing rather than passive equidistance, because India deepens several ties simultaneously instead of avoiding commitment to any; the consequence for answer writing is that the Gulf, Israel and Iran tracks must be presented as parallel and non-exclusive rather than as a sequence of choices in which one relationship displaces another.
- India and Israel established full diplomatic relations in 1992 and the first visit by an Indian Prime Minister to Israel in July 2017 marked a major political upgrade, after which cooperation spans defence procurement, counter-terrorism and co-development with the Barak-8 air-defence system as the named joint development, the Indo-Israel Agricultural Project operating Centres of Excellence for protected cultivation, irrigation and post-harvest practices, and the India-Israel Industrial Research and Development and Technological Innovation Fund launched in 2017; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that import dependence, cost and technology-transfer depth remain relevant, that demonstration centres require local extension, affordability and scaling before they affect wider productivity, and that funded projects must be distinguished from announced cooperation.
- The India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Action Plan for 2024-2028 was adopted at the first India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Ministerial Meeting for Strategic Dialogue at Riyadh on 9 September 2024 and is the anchor current framework for India's strategic dialogue with the Council, while the India-Saudi Arabia Strategic Partnership Council held its second meeting at Jeddah on 22 April 2025, India and Qatar signed an Agreement on Establishment of a Bilateral Strategic Partnership on 18 February 2025, and India-United Arab Emirates relations were elevated to a Comprehensive Strategic Partnership on 25 January 2017; the owners require a dated instrument to be named rather than an undated assertion of strategic partnership, because the date and the forum are what make the claim checkable.
- India recognised the State of Palestine in 1988 and continues to support a negotiated, sovereign, viable two-state solution alongside Israel, and after the October 2023 conflict began India condemned terrorism, called for humanitarian protection, release of hostages, dialogue and a two-state settlement while continuing relations with Israel and assistance to Palestinians; the owners require this to be presented as a single coherent position rather than as a contradiction, and they add the analytical warning that the conflict tests the corridor and minilateral frameworks by raising political, security and route-risk costs, so announced corridors and minilaterals must not be treated as insulated from regional war.

Qualified conclusion: The proposition fails against the explicit source statement and against the dated Gulf architecture, so the comment must quote the balancing principle, evidence both tracks with dated instruments, and describe the posture as active balancing rather than equidistance or a choice.

Demand decoding: The directive **comment** requires a direct position on "Comment on the proposition that India's deepening partnership with Israel has come at the...", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The proposition fails against the explicit source statement and against the dated Gulf architecture, so the comment must quote the balancing principle, evidence both tracks with dated instruments, and describe the posture as active balancing rather than equidistance or a choice.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Tharoor states that India values its relationship with Israel, but not at the expense of its friendships with Arab and other Muslim states, which is the explicit textual anchor for every balancing

argument in this topic, and the owners sharpen it into active balancing rather than passive equidistance, because India deepens several ties simultaneously instead of avoiding commitment to any; the consequence for answer writing is that the Gulf, Israel and Iran tracks must be presented as parallel and non-exclusive rather than as a sequence of choices in which one relationship displaces another. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

2. **Claim and named evidence:** India and Israel established full diplomatic relations in 1992 and the first visit by an Indian Prime Minister to Israel in July 2017 marked a major political upgrade, after which cooperation spans defence procurement, counter-terrorism and co-development with the Barak-8 air-defence system as the named joint development, the Indo-Israel Agricultural Project operating Centres of Excellence for protected cultivation, irrigation and post-harvest practices, and the India-Israel Industrial Research and Development and Technological Innovation Fund launched in 2017; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that import dependence, cost and technology-transfer depth remain relevant, that demonstration centres require local extension, affordability and scaling before they affect wider productivity, and that funded projects must be distinguished from announced cooperation. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Action Plan for 2024-2028 was adopted at the first India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Ministerial Meeting for Strategic Dialogue at Riyadh on 9 September 2024 and is the anchor current framework for India's strategic dialogue with the Council, while the India-Saudi Arabia Strategic Partnership Council held its second meeting at Jeddah on 22 April 2025, India and Qatar signed an Agreement on Establishment of a Bilateral Strategic Partnership on 18 February 2025, and India-United Arab Emirates relations were elevated to a Comprehensive Strategic Partnership on 25 January 2017; the owners require a dated instrument to be named rather than an undated assertion of strategic partnership, because the date and the forum are what make the claim checkable. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** India recognised the State of Palestine in 1988 and continues to support a negotiated, sovereign, viable two-state solution alongside Israel, and after the October 2023 conflict began India condemned terrorism, called for humanitarian protection, release of hostages, dialogue and a two-state settlement while continuing relations with Israel and assistance to Palestinians; the owners require this to be presented as a single coherent position rather than as a contradiction, and they add the analytical warning that the conflict tests the corridor and minilateral frameworks by raising political, security and route-risk costs, so announced corridors and minilaterals must not be treated as insulated from regional war. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The proposition fails against the explicit source statement and against the dated Gulf architecture, so the comment must quote the balancing principle, evidence both tracks with dated instruments, and describe the posture as active balancing rather than equidistance or a choice.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains strategy and implementation rather than listing visits or groupings, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves institutional, status, level, causal and geopolitical distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Comment on the proposition that India's deepening partnership with Israel has come at the...", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Examine the depth and diversity of India's relations with Israel and state where the relationship's limits lie. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Depth and diversity must be shown across several distinct domains rather than asserted, so the examination must move from diplomatic normalisation through defence, agriculture and innovation to the minilateral extension, and must close with the technology-transfer, scaling and regional-conflict limits.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- India and Israel established full diplomatic relations in 1992 and the first visit by an Indian Prime Minister to Israel in July 2017 marked a major political upgrade, after which cooperation spans defence procurement, counter-terrorism and co-development with the Barak-8 air-defence system as the named joint development, the Indo-Israel Agricultural Project operating Centres of Excellence for protected cultivation, irrigation and post-harvest practices, and the India-Israel Industrial Research and Development and Technological Innovation Fund launched in 2017; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that import dependence, cost and technology-transfer depth remain relevant, that demonstration centres require local extension, affordability and scaling before they affect wider productivity, and that funded projects must be distinguished from announced cooperation.
- I2U2 groups India, Israel, the United Arab Emirates and the United States in a minilateral cooperation framework spanning food security, water, energy and technology, and it emerged in the environment widened by the Abraham Accords of 2020 which normalised Israel's relations with several Arab states without resolving the Palestinian question; the owners record an honest limitation that answers routinely omit, namely that no four-party I2U2 meeting or outcome in 2024 to 2026 could be verified from official sources and that the India-United States statement of 13 February 2025 recorded only an intention to convene partners, so continuous activity must not be assumed.
- India recognised the State of Palestine in 1988 and continues to support a negotiated, sovereign, viable two-state solution alongside Israel, and after the October 2023 conflict began India condemned terrorism, called for humanitarian protection, release of hostages, dialogue and a two-state settlement while continuing relations with Israel and assistance to Palestinians; the owners require this to be presented as a single coherent position rather than as a contradiction, and they add the analytical warning that the conflict tests the corridor and minilateral frameworks by raising political, security and route-risk costs, so announced corridors and minilaterals must not be treated as insulated from regional war.
- Tharoor states that India values its relationship with Israel, but not at the expense of its friendships with Arab and other Muslim states, which is the explicit textual anchor for every balancing argument in this topic, and the owners sharpen it into active balancing rather than passive equidistance, because India deepens several ties simultaneously instead of avoiding commitment to any; the consequence for answer writing is that the Gulf, Israel and Iran tracks must be presented as parallel and non-exclusive rather than as a sequence of choices in which one relationship displaces another.

Qualified conclusion: Depth and diversity must be shown across several distinct domains rather than asserted, so the examination must move from diplomatic normalisation through defence, agriculture and innovation to the minilateral extension, and must close with the technology-transfer, scaling and regional-conflict limits.

Demand decoding: The directive **examine** requires a direct position on "Examine the depth and diversity of India's relations with Israel and state where the...", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Depth and diversity must be shown across several distinct domains rather than asserted, so the examination must move from diplomatic normalisation through defence, agriculture and innovation to the minilateral extension, and must close with the technology-transfer, scaling and regional-conflict limits.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** India and Israel established full diplomatic relations in 1992 and the first visit by an Indian Prime Minister to Israel in July 2017 marked a major political upgrade, after which cooperation spans defence procurement, counter-terrorism and co-development with the Barak-8 air-defence system as the named joint development, the Indo-Israel Agricultural Project operating Centres of Excellence for protected cultivation, irrigation and post-harvest practices, and the India-Israel Industrial Research and Development and Technological Innovation Fund launched in 2017; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that import dependence, cost and technology-transfer depth remain relevant, that demonstration centres require local extension, affordability and scaling before they affect wider productivity, and that funded projects must be distinguished from announced cooperation. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** I2U2 groups India, Israel, the United Arab Emirates and the United States in a minilateral cooperation framework spanning food security, water, energy and technology, and it emerged in the environment widened by the Abraham Accords of 2020 which normalised Israel's relations with several Arab states without resolving the Palestinian question; the owners record an honest limitation that answers routinely omit, namely that no four-party I2U2 meeting or outcome in 2024 to 2026 could be verified from official sources and that the India-United States statement of 13 February 2025 recorded only an intention to convene partners, so continuous activity must not be assumed. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** India recognised the State of Palestine in 1988 and continues to support a negotiated, sovereign, viable two-state solution alongside Israel, and after the October 2023 conflict began India condemned terrorism, called for humanitarian protection, release of hostages, dialogue and a two-state settlement while continuing relations with Israel and assistance to Palestinians; the owners require this to be presented as a single coherent position rather than as a contradiction, and they add the analytical warning that the conflict tests the corridor and minilateral frameworks by raising political, security and route-risk costs, so announced corridors and minilaterals must not be treated as insulated from regional war. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Tharoor states that India values its relationship with Israel, but not at the expense of its friendships with Arab and other Muslim states, which is the explicit textual anchor for every balancing argument in this topic, and the owners sharpen it into active balancing rather than passive equidistance, because India deepens several ties simultaneously instead of avoiding commitment to any; the consequence for answer writing is that the Gulf, Israel and Iran tracks must be presented as parallel and non-exclusive rather than as a sequence of choices in which one relationship displaces another. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Depth and diversity must be shown across several distinct domains rather than asserted, so the examination must move from diplomatic normalisation through defence, agriculture and innovation to the minilateral extension, and must close with the technology-transfer, scaling and regional-conflict limits.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains strategy and implementation rather than listing visits or groupings, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves institutional, status, level, causal and geopolitical distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Examine the depth and diversity of India's relations with Israel and state where the...", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Examine how the United States-Iran nuclear dispute has affected India's national interest, and state how India should respond. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: The dispute reaches India through transmission rather than obligation, so the examination must date the instrument and the withdrawal, trace transmission through crude sourcing and the Chabahar carve-out, and recommend a response that preserves the carve-out logic while pricing reversibility honestly.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The Joint Comprehensive Plan of Action was concluded on 14 July 2015 between Iran and the E3 and European Union plus three grouping and was endorsed by United Nations Security Council resolution 2231, after which the United States announced withdrawal on 8 May 2018 and restored sanctions in stages, and the owners give an explicit status caution that the Plan must not be described as normally functioning because, following the E3 snapback action in 2025, the status of restored United Nations measures is disputed by Iran, Russia and China; the examinable consequence is that nuclear diplomacy initially widened the space for energy and connectivity ties while renewed sanctions exposed Indian oil, banking, insurance and project channels to third-country pressure.
- India ceased Iranian crude purchases after United States Significant Reduction Exceptions ended in May 2019 and substituted other suppliers, which the owners treat as the clearest single demonstration that external policy can directly change India's energy basket; the qualification is equally important, because supplier substitution reduced immediate sanctions exposure but narrowed the Iran relationship and did not reduce aggregate import dependence, so the episode is evidence of vulnerability transmission rather than of successful dependence reduction.
- The United States exception granted in 2018 for Chabahar and Afghanistan-related connectivity was revoked with effect from 29 September 2025, and the ten-year Chabahar contract had been signed on 13 May 2024, so the owners read the sequence as showing both that India may pursue a national-interest carve-out even amid United States-Iran confrontation and that an exception is a reversible foreign executive measure rather than a permanent legal guarantee; the connectivity link serves West Asia and Central Asia simultaneously, and the Central Asian limb of the same instrument is owned by topic 05.
- Tharoor notes that many Indian refineries are in fact devised to process the quality of crude oil that Iran supplies, and Sikri records the underlying policy response of making equity investments in oilfields abroad, so the owners treat configuration-specific refining capacity as a physical constraint on how quickly a supplier mix can actually change; the analytical payoff is that headline diversification percentages move slowly for engineering reasons rather than diplomatic ones, which is why a strategy answer must price switching cost instead of assuming that political intent translates immediately into a changed energy basket.

Qualified conclusion: The dispute reaches India through transmission rather than obligation, so the examination must date the instrument and the withdrawal, trace transmission through crude sourcing and the Chabahar carve-out, and recommend a response that preserves the carve-out logic while pricing reversibility honestly.

Demand decoding: The directive **examine** requires a direct position on "Examine how the United States-Iran nuclear dispute has affected India's national interest,...", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The dispute reaches India through transmission rather than obligation, so the examination must date the instrument and the withdrawal, trace transmission through crude sourcing and the Chabahar carve-out, and recommend a response that preserves the carve-out logic while pricing reversibility honestly.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The Joint Comprehensive Plan of Action was concluded on 14 July 2015 between Iran and the E3 and European Union plus three grouping and was endorsed by United Nations Security Council resolution 2231, after which the United States announced withdrawal on 8 May 2018 and restored sanctions in stages, and the owners give an explicit status caution that the Plan must not be described as normally functioning because, following the E3 snapback action in 2025, the status of restored United Nations measures is disputed by Iran, Russia and China; the examinable consequence is that nuclear diplomacy initially widened the space for energy and connectivity ties while renewed sanctions exposed Indian oil, banking, insurance and project channels to third-country pressure. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** India ceased Iranian crude purchases after United States Significant Reduction Exceptions ended in May 2019 and substituted other suppliers, which the owners treat as the clearest single demonstration that external policy can directly change India's energy basket; the qualification is equally important, because supplier substitution reduced immediate sanctions exposure but narrowed the Iran relationship and did not reduce aggregate import dependence, so the episode is evidence of vulnerability transmission rather than of successful dependence reduction. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The United States exception granted in 2018 for Chabahar and Afghanistan-related connectivity was revoked with effect from 29 September 2025, and the ten-year Chabahar contract had been signed on 13 May 2024, so the owners read the sequence as showing both that India may pursue a national-interest carve-out even amid United States-Iran confrontation and that an exception is a reversible foreign executive measure rather than a permanent legal guarantee; the connectivity link serves West Asia and Central Asia simultaneously, and the Central Asian limb of the same instrument is owned by topic 05. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Tharoor notes that many Indian refineries are in fact devised to process the quality of crude oil that Iran supplies, and Sikri records the underlying policy response of making equity investments in oilfields abroad, so the owners treat configuration-specific refining capacity as a physical constraint on how quickly a supplier mix can actually change; the analytical payoff is that headline diversification percentages move slowly for engineering reasons rather than diplomatic ones, which is why a strategy answer must price switching cost instead of assuming that political intent translates immediately into a changed energy basket. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The dispute reaches India through transmission rather than obligation, so the examination must date the instrument and the withdrawal, trace transmission through crude sourcing and the Chabahar carve-out, and recommend a response that preserves the carve-out logic while pricing reversibility honestly.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains strategy and implementation rather than listing visits or groupings, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves institutional, status, level, causal and geopolitical distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Examine how the United States-Iran nuclear dispute has affected India's national interest,...", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Assess how India should integrate energy security with its foreign-policy trajectories in West Asia in the coming years. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Integration requires the trilemma rather than a security-only frame, so the assessment must state the dependence baseline, evidence diversification and the dated Gulf and corridor architecture, unpack influence into diaspora, technology and connectivity limbs, and refuse any prediction of price, corridor or conflict outcomes.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Petroleum Planning and Analysis Cell data put India's crude-oil import dependence at eighty-eight point two per cent in the financial year 2024-25 and about eighty-eight point seven per cent provisional in the financial year 2025-26, while Sikri records the book-period figure at approximately seventy per cent; the owners require the current figure and its consumption-basis definition to be cited for any present-day claim and permit the book-period figure only as a historical baseline showing the direction of travel, so quoting approximately seventy per cent as a current number is treated as a factual error rather than a stylistic one.
- The India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Action Plan for 2024-2028 was adopted at the first India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Ministerial Meeting for Strategic Dialogue at Riyadh on 9 September 2024 and is the anchor current framework for India's strategic dialogue with the Council, while the India-Saudi Arabia Strategic Partnership Council held its second meeting at Jeddah on 22 April 2025, India and Qatar signed an Agreement on Establishment of a Bilateral Strategic Partnership on 18 February 2025, and India-United Arab Emirates relations were elevated to a Comprehensive Strategic Partnership on 25 January 2017; the owners require a dated instrument to be named rather than an undated assertion of strategic partnership, because the date and the forum are what make the claim checkable.
- The India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor memorandum of understanding was signed in New Delhi on 9 September 2023 by eight parties, namely India, the United States, Saudi Arabia, the United Arab Emirates, the European Union, France, Germany and Italy, on the margins of the Group of Twenty summit, and the Ministry of External Affairs India-United Arab Emirates readout of 24 June 2024 referred to commencement of work on the corridor; the owners are categorical that a memorandum among eight parties is a framework of intent and that no completed construction or operating segment is officially established, so connectivity diplomacy and connectivity infrastructure must never be conflated.
- The owners argue that India's West Asia policy is best evaluated through the energy trilemma of security, affordability and sustainability rather than through energy security alone, because supplier diversification, diaspora exposure and connectivity-framework design are all shaped by the same trade-offs between reliable supply, cost and long-term transition pressure; the practical consequence for a Mains answer is that a purely security-based frame misses affordability and transition considerations that can conflict with each other, and that triangular relationship management across the Gulf, Israel and Iran requires continuous diplomatic effort rather than a one-time policy declaration.

Qualified conclusion: Integration requires the trilemma rather than a security-only frame, so the assessment must state the dependence baseline, evidence diversification and the dated Gulf and corridor architecture, unpack influence into diaspora, technology and connectivity limbs, and refuse any prediction of price, corridor or conflict outcomes.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on "Assess how India should integrate energy security with its foreign-policy trajectories in...", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Integration requires the trilemma rather than a security-only frame, so the assessment must state the dependence baseline, evidence diversification and the dated Gulf and corridor architecture, unpack influence into diaspora, technology and connectivity limbs, and refuse any prediction of price, corridor or conflict outcomes.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Petroleum Planning and Analysis Cell data put India's crude-oil import dependence at eighty-eight point two per cent in the financial year 2024-25 and about eighty-eight point seven per cent provisional in the financial year 2025-26, while Sikri records the book-period figure at approximately seventy per cent; the owners require the current figure and its consumption-basis definition to be cited for any present-day claim and permit the book-period figure only as a historical baseline showing the direction of travel, so quoting approximately seventy per cent as a current number is treated as a factual error rather than a stylistic one. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Action Plan for 2024-2028 was adopted at the first India-Gulf Cooperation Council Joint Ministerial Meeting for Strategic Dialogue at Riyadh on 9 September 2024 and is the anchor current framework for India's strategic dialogue with the Council, while the India-Saudi Arabia Strategic Partnership Council held its second meeting at Jeddah on 22 April 2025, India and Qatar signed an Agreement on Establishment of a Bilateral Strategic Partnership on 18 February 2025, and India-United Arab Emirates relations were elevated to a Comprehensive Strategic Partnership on 25 January 2017; the owners require a dated instrument to be named rather than an undated assertion of strategic partnership, because the date and the forum are what make the claim checkable. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor memorandum of understanding was signed in New Delhi on 9 September 2023 by eight parties, namely India, the United States, Saudi Arabia, the United Arab Emirates, the European Union, France, Germany and Italy, on the margins of the Group of Twenty summit, and the Ministry of External Affairs India-United Arab Emirates readout of 24 June 2024 referred to commencement of work on the corridor; the owners are categorical that a memorandum among eight parties is a framework of intent and that no completed construction or operating segment is officially established, so connectivity diplomacy and connectivity infrastructure must never be conflated. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners argue that India's West Asia policy is best evaluated through the energy trilemma of security, affordability and sustainability rather than through energy security alone, because supplier diversification, diaspora exposure and connectivity-framework design are all shaped by the same trade-offs between reliable supply, cost and long-term transition pressure; the practical consequence for a Mains answer is that a purely security-based frame misses affordability and transition considerations that can conflict with each other, and that triangular relationship management across the Gulf, Israel and Iran requires continuous

diplomatic effort rather than a one-time policy declaration. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Integration requires the trilemma rather than a security-only frame, so the assessment must state the dependence baseline, evidence diversification and the dated Gulf and corridor architecture, unpack influence into diaspora, technology and connectivity limbs, and refuse any prediction of price, corridor or conflict outcomes.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains strategy and implementation rather than listing visits or groupings, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves institutional, status, level, causal and geopolitical distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Assess how India should integrate energy security with its foreign-policy trajectories in...", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Assess the proposition that West Asian risk to India is compounding rather than isolated. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Compounding risk is the distinctive feature of this region, so the assessment must show one escalation reaching energy, diaspora and connectivity at once, evidence each limb with a dated anchor, and close with a graded verdict on a non-exclusive portfolio rather than a single-dimension policy.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The Strait of Hormuz is the narrow outlet from the Persian Gulf to the Gulf of Oman and is the principal route-risk chokepoint for Gulf energy shipments, so disruption there can transmit immediately into freight, insurance and supply insecurity for India, and the owners add the qualification that supplier diversification does not eliminate common-route exposure while strategic reserves and alternative energy reduce but do not remove the risk; the wider structural point is that West Asian risk is compounding rather than isolated, because one escalation can threaten energy-supply continuity, diaspora physical safety and connectivity-project viability at the same time.
- Operation Sindhu evacuated four thousand four hundred and fifteen Indian nationals from Iran and Israel by 27 June 2025, comprising three thousand five hundred and ninety-seven from Iran and eight hundred and eighteen from Israel, which the owners treat as the concrete dated demonstration that West Asia policy carries a standing consular-protection obligation rather than a hypothetical risk; the boundary is stated in the same place, because the operational relief and logistics cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owner while the host-government negotiation and consular diplomacy that enable an evacuation belong to this folder and to topic 09.
- India recognised the State of Palestine in 1988 and continues to support a negotiated, sovereign, viable two-state solution alongside Israel, and after the October 2023 conflict began India condemned terrorism, called for humanitarian protection, release of hostages, dialogue and a two-state settlement while continuing relations with Israel and assistance to Palestinians; the owners require this to be presented as a single coherent position rather than as a contradiction, and they add the analytical warning that the conflict tests the corridor and minilateral frameworks by raising political, security and route-risk costs, so announced corridors and minilaterals must not be treated as insulated from regional war.
- The audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2018 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the depth and diversity of India's relations with Israel, a Discuss demand of 10

marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the printed word-limit tail was corrupted in the scan and that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, 2018 General Studies Paper II question 20 on the United States-Iran nuclear-pact controversy and India's national interest, an In what ways and How should demand of 15 marks and 250 words on the same superseding route, and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 19 on energy security and India's foreign policy in the Middle East, a Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words; four objective demands are also routed here and carried as coverage requirements only, namely 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 24 on the two-state solution in an international-affairs context, 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 37 on conflict-zone towns and their correct country matching, 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 94 on Israel, Arab states, diplomatic relations and the Arab Peace Initiative, for which the official 2018-2023 keys are not held locally, and 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 30 on the Strait of Hormuz and West Asian maritime access to the Indian Ocean, for which only a provisional 2026 Set-A key is present locally, and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for any of them.

Qualified conclusion: Compounding risk is the distinctive feature of this region, so the assessment must show one escalation reaching energy, diaspora and connectivity at once, evidence each limb with a dated anchor, and close with a graded verdict on a non-exclusive portfolio rather than a single-dimension policy.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on "Assess the proposition that West Asian risk to India is compounding rather than isolated....", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Compounding risk is the distinctive feature of this region, so the assessment must show one escalation reaching energy, diaspora and connectivity at once, evidence each limb with a dated anchor, and close with a graded verdict on a non-exclusive portfolio rather than a single-dimension policy.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The Strait of Hormuz is the narrow outlet from the Persian Gulf to the Gulf of Oman and is the principal route-risk chokepoint for Gulf energy shipments, so disruption there can transmit immediately into freight, insurance and supply insecurity for India, and the owners add the qualification that supplier diversification does not eliminate common-route exposure while strategic reserves and alternative energy reduce but do not remove the risk; the wider structural point is that West Asian risk is compounding rather than isolated, because one escalation can threaten energy-supply continuity, diaspora physical safety and connectivity-project viability at the same time. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Operation Sindhu evacuated four thousand four hundred and fifteen Indian nationals from Iran and Israel by 27 June 2025, comprising three thousand five hundred and ninety-seven from Iran and eight hundred and eighteen from Israel, which the owners treat as the concrete dated demonstration that West Asia policy carries a standing consular-protection obligation rather than a hypothetical risk; the boundary is stated in the same place, because the operational relief and logistics cycle belongs to the Disaster Management owner while the host-government negotiation and consular diplomacy that enable an evacuation belong to this folder and to topic 09. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** India recognised the State of Palestine in 1988 and continues to support a negotiated, sovereign, viable two-state solution alongside Israel, and after the October 2023 conflict began India condemned terrorism, called for humanitarian protection, release of hostages, dialogue and a two-state settlement while continuing relations with Israel and assistance to Palestinians; the owners require this to be presented as a single coherent position rather than as a contradiction, and they add the analytical warning that the conflict tests the corridor and minilateral frameworks by raising political, security and route-risk costs, so announced corridors and minilaterals must not be treated as insulated from regional war. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner

interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** The audited ledgers route three General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2018 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the depth and diversity of India's relations with Israel, a Discuss demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the printed word-limit tail was corrupted in the scan and that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, 2018 General Studies Paper II question 20 on the United States-Iran nuclear-pact controversy and India's national interest, an In what ways and How should demand of 15 marks and 250 words on the same superseding route, and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 19 on energy security and India's foreign policy in the Middle East, a Discuss demand of 15 marks and 250 words; four objective demands are also routed here and carried as coverage requirements only, namely 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 24 on the two-state solution in an international-affairs context, 2018 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 37 on conflict-zone towns and their correct country matching, 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 94 on Israel, Arab states, diplomatic relations and the Arab Peace Initiative, for which the official 2018-2023 keys are not held locally, and 2026 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 30 on the Strait of Hormuz and West Asian maritime access to the Indian Ocean, for which only a provisional 2026 Set-A key is present locally, and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for any of them. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Compounding risk is the distinctive feature of this region, so the assessment must show one escalation reaching energy, diaspora and connectivity at once, evidence each limb with a dated anchor, and close with a graded verdict on a non-exclusive portfolio rather than a single-dimension policy.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains strategy and implementation rather than listing visits or groupings, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves institutional, status, level, causal and geopolitical distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Assess the proposition that West Asian risk to India is compounding rather than isolated....", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.